

# *Romeo and Juliet*

William Shakespeare · 1597

Standard Ebooks edition (modern text drawing on the 1599 Second Quarto and the 1623 First Folio)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

**Cambridge International edition** (standards shown for this framework only)

27 scene lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 33 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 7 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
*Cover: Jean-Honoré Fragonard, A Young Girl Reading (c. 1770). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).*

# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–27), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** Romeo and Juliet was first printed in a short quarto in 1597 and in a fuller Second Quarto in 1599; modern texts are based mainly on the Second Quarto. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 24 scenes plus the two Choruses and the cast list. The year shown is the first printing; the play was probably written around 1595. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

**Content note for teachers:** Street violence and on-stage deaths, sexual wordplay, a father's verbal abuse, a teenage marriage, and suicide (the ending, plus an attempt and a threat); discuss early marriage and the lovers' deaths critically and with care. See the scene notes and the safe-messaging script.

**Grades:** Grades 9–10 (also 8 with support; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these plays are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 7. **Class days:** 33 × 90 minutes (27 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about love and desire?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about fate and choice?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about violence and the feud?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about youth and age?
- What does Romeo and Juliet suggest about time and haste?

## Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the play.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

## Standards: Cambridge International

CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5

Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)

**Assessments:** Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | *Introduction: author, context and reception*<br>Dramatis Personae<br>Prologue<br>Act I, Scene I<br>Act I, Scene II | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *love and desire*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Introduction: author, context and reception<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 2 | Act I, Scene III<br>*Socratic seminar on love and desire*<br>Act I, Scene IV<br>Act I, Scene V<br>Act II, Prologue | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *fate and choice*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on love and desire<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 3 | Act II, Scene I<br>Act II, Scene II<br>Act II, Scene III<br>Act II, Scene IV<br>Act II, Scene V | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *violence and the feud*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 4 | Act II, Scene VI<br>Act III, Scene I<br>*Socratic seminar on fate and choice*<br>Act III, Scene II<br>Act III, Scene III | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *youth and age*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on fate and choice<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 5 | Act III, Scene IV<br>Act III, Scene V<br>Act IV, Scene I<br>Act IV, Scene II<br>Act IV, Scene III | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *time and haste*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 6 | | | | |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Act IV, Scene IV<br>Act IV, Scene V<br>Act V, Scene I<br>*Socratic seminar on violence and the feud*<br>Act V, Scene II | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *love and desire*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on violence and the feud<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 7 | Act V, Scene III<br>*Whole-book test (90 minutes)*<br>*Final essay workshop and submission* | 3 × 90 min (270 min) | *fate and choice*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Whole-book test (90 minutes)<br>• Final essay workshop and submission<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Whole-book test and final essay |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

# Lesson 1: Introduction to Romeo and Juliet

### *Author biography*

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623).

### *Historical and cultural context*

Romeo and Juliet was probably written around 1595, in the same years as A Midsummer Night's Dream, when Shakespeare was writing for the Lord Chamberlain's Men. The story was already well known in English: Arthur Brooke's long poem The Tragicall Historye of Romeus and Juliet (1562), based on a French version by Pierre Boaistuau of an Italian playla by Matteo Bandello (who drew on Luigi da Porto), was Shakespeare's main source. Shakespeare compressed Brooke's nine months into about four days, made Juliet younger (thirteen, "not fourteen"; Brooke's Juliet is sixteen) and greatly expanded Mercutio. In Elizabethan England fathers usually arranged the marriages of propertied daughters, and duelling and street brawls between rival retinues were a real worry to authorities. The play's love poetry draws on the fashion for sonnets in the 1590s: the lovers' first exchange is itself a sonnet.

### *Publication and reception, then and now*

The play was printed in 1597 in a short First Quarto (sometimes called a "bad quarto") and in 1599 in a fuller Second Quarto "newly corrected, augmented, and amended," which is the basis of most modern texts; it was reprinted in the First Folio (1623). Modern editions, including the reading text here, combine readings from these early printings.

**Then:** The play was popular in Shakespeare's lifetime, judging by its four quarto printings before the Folio. After the Restoration it fared less well: Samuel Pepys saw it in 1662 and called it "the worst that ever I heard in my life," and Thomas Otway turned it into a Roman play, Caius Marius (1679). David Garrick's version (1748) let Juliet wake before Romeo dies and held the stage for about a century.

**Now:** It is one of the most performed and adapted of all plays and has been taught in American high schools for generations. Adaptations include Leonard Bernstein and Arthur Laurents's musical West Side Story (1957), Franco Zeffirelli's film (1968) and Baz Luhrmann's Romeo + Juliet (1996). Modern readers debate whether the play is about fate, about youthful impulsiveness, or about a violent society that destroys its children.

### *Overview (spoiler-free)*

In Verona two great families, the Montagues and the Capulets, are locked in a feud so old that no one remembers its cause. Romeo, a Montague, slips into a Capulet party and meets Juliet, the Capulets' only daughter. The Prologue tells us at once how their story ends; the play shows how it gets there, in about four days.

### *Main themes*

- love and desire: love at first sight, infatuation (Rosaline) and the love that makes Juliet "boundless"; ask what kind of love the play actually shows.
- fate and choice: "star-cross'd" lovers; are they doomed, or do people make choices that doom them?
- violence and the feud: a city where young men fight over a bitten thumb; who is responsible for the deaths?
- youth and age: parents, the Nurse and the Friar advise, command and fail the young.
- time and haste: a story compressed into four days; watch how speed shapes every decision.

### *Why it matters*

Romeo and Juliet is the story of first love that the English-speaking world tells itself, and it is also a study of how a community's hatreds land on its young people. Students meet questions about loyalty to family, impulsive decisions, adults who fail to listen, and violence that escalates from words, all in some of the most famous poetry in English.

Spoilers · teacher only

Romeo and Juliet marry secretly with the help of Friar Laurence and the Nurse. The next day Tybalt kills Mercutio and Romeo kills Tybalt, and the Prince banishes Romeo to Mantua. Capulet, not knowing of the marriage, insists Juliet marry Paris. The Friar gives her a potion that makes her seem dead; his letter to Romeo is stopped by a plague quarantine. Romeo hears she is dead, buys poison, kills Paris at the tomb and dies beside Juliet; she wakes, finds him dead and stabs herself. The families are reconciled over their children's bodies.

### *Lesson plan (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open Romeo and Juliet: Have you ever been told you could not be friends with someone because of a family or group rivalry? Write for five minutes about where such rivalries come from and whether they are fair.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Romeo and Juliet: Have you ever been told you could not be friends with someone because of a family or group rivalry? Write for five minutes about where such rivalries come from and whether they are fair.

**8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**

*tragedy (a play in which the main characters are destroyed, often through choices and circumstances); prologue (an opening speech that introduces the story); sonnet (a fourteen-line poem; the Prologue is a Shakespearean sonnet); foil (a character who contrasts with another); dramatic irony (the audience knows what characters do not); pun (a play on two meanings of a word); feud (a long, bitter quarrel between families).*

**18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)**

*About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623). The world of the book. Romeo and Juliet was probably written around 1595, in the same years as A Midsummer Night's Dream, when Shakespeare was writing for the Lord Chamberlain's Men. The story was already well known in English: Arthur Brooke's long poem The Tragicall Historye of Romeus and Juliet (1562), based on a French version by Pierre Boaistuau of an Italian playla by Matteo Bandello (who drew on Luigi da Porto), was Shakespeare's main source. Shakespeare compressed Brooke's nine months into about four days, made Juliet younger (thirteen, "not fourteen"; Brooke's Juliet is sixteen) and greatly expanded Mercutio. In Elizabethan England fathers usually arranged the marriages of propertied daughters, and duelling and street brawls between rival retinues were a real worry to authorities. The play's love poetry draws on the fashion for sonnets in the 1590s: the lovers' first exchange is itself a sonnet. Publication and reception. The play was printed in 1597 in a short First Quarto (sometimes called a "bad quarto") and in 1599 in a fuller Second Quarto "newly corrected, augmented, and amended," which is the basis of most modern texts; it was reprinted in the First Folio (1623). Modern editions, including the reading text here, combine readings from these early printings. Then: The play was popular in Shakespeare's lifetime, judging by its four quarto printings before the Folio. After the Restoration it fared less well: Samuel Pepys saw it in 1662 and called it "the worst that ever I heard in my life," and Thomas Otway turned it into a Roman play, Caius Marius (1679). David Garrick's version (1748) let Juliet wake before Romeo dies and held the stage for about a century. Now: It is one of the most performed and adapted of all plays and has been taught in American high schools for generations. Adaptations include Leonard Bernstein and Arthur Laurents's musical West Side Story (1957), Franco Zeffirelli's film (1968) and Baz Luhrmann's Romeo + Juliet (1996). Modern readers debate whether the play is about fate, about youthful impulsiveness, or about a violent society that destroys its children.*

**28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)**

*“A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)). The Prologue gives away the ending in its sixth line. Ask students why Shakespeare tells us the ending first and what "star-cross'd" (thwarted by the stars) suggests about who is to blame.*

> *A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life* *(Prologue, speech (speech 0))*

**Think-aloud:** “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)). The Prologue gives away the ending in its sixth line. Ask students why Shakespeare tells us the ending first and what "star-cross'd" (thwarted by the stars) suggests about who is to blame.

**40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)**

*What the book is about (no spoilers): In Verona two great families, the Montagues and the Capulets, are locked in a feud so old that no one remembers its cause. Romeo, a Montague, slips into a Capulet party and meets Juliet, the Capulets' only daughter. The Prologue tells us at once how their story ends; the play shows how it gets there, in about four days. Themes to track: love and desire: love at first sight, infatuation (Rosaline) and the love that makes Juliet "boundless"; ask what kind of love the play actually shows. fate and choice: "star-cross'd" lovers; are they doomed, or do people make choices that doom them? violence and the feud: a city where young men fight over a bitten thumb; who is responsible for the deaths? youth and age: parents, the Nurse and the Friar advise, command and fail the young. time and haste: a story compressed into four days; watch how speed shapes every decision.*

**55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)**

*Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "fate and choice": Prediction: something will go wrong because the lovers act too quickly. Question: if the Prologue says they are "star-cross'd," can they be blamed for what happens?*
**Task:** Set up a reading journal for Romeo and Juliet: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
**Exemplar:** Theme page "fate and choice": Prediction: something will go wrong because the lovers act too quickly. Question: if the Prologue says they are "star-cross'd," can they be blamed for what happens?

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

*Why does Romeo and Juliet still matter? Romeo and Juliet is the story of first love that the English-speaking world tells itself, and it is also a study of how a community's hatreds land on its young people. Students meet questions about loyalty to family, impulsive decisions, adults who fail to listen, and violence that escalates from words, all in some of the most famous poetry in English.*
**Anchor question:** Why might Romeo and Juliet still be taught today?
**Facilitation:** Romeo and Juliet is the story of first love that the English-speaking world tells itself, and it is also a study of how a community's hatreds land on its young people. Students meet questions about loyalty to family, impulsive decisions, adults who fail to listen, and violence that escalates from words, all in some of the most famous poetry in English.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)**

*Name one way Shakespeare changed his source story, and suggest why. Answer: Examples: he shortened nine months to about four days (to build speed and pressure); he made Juliet thirteen, younger than in Brooke (to stress youth and haste); he expanded Mercutio (to add wit and make his death a turning point).*
**Exit ticket:** Name one way Shakespeare changed his source story, and suggest why.
**Answer:** Examples: he shortened nine months to about four days (to build speed and pressure); he made Juliet thirteen, younger than in Brooke (to stress youth and haste); he expanded Mercutio (to add wit and make his death a turning point).

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**

*Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.*

**Teacher notes · sources:** Folger Shakespeare Library, "Shakespeare's life" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-life/); Shakespeare Birthplace Trust, "William Shakespeare" (https://www.shakespeare.org.uk/explore-shakespeare/shakespedia/william-shakespeare/); Folger Shakespeare Library, "Romeo and Juliet" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/romeo-and-juliet/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Romeo and Juliet: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/romeo-and-juliet/about-the-play); British Library, "Romeo and Juliet: the First Quarto (1597)" (https://www.bl.uk/collection-items/the-first-quarto-of-romeo-and-juliet-1597); Arthur Brooke, The Tragicall Historye of Romeus and Juliet (1562) (https://www.gutenberg.org/); Samuel Pepys, Diary, 1 March 1662 (https://www.pepysdiary.com/diary/1662/03/01/)

**Flags (verify before teaching):**

- The date "around 1595" is a scholarly inference (style, the 1597 quarto, the Nurse's "'tis since the earthquake now eleven years"); no record fixes it.
- Pepys's verdict is from his diary entry for 1 March 1661/2; check the wording against the edition you cite.
- Juliet's age ("she's not fourteen") is stated in Act I, Scene III; Brooke's Juliet is sixteen. Discuss early marriage in its historical context: most Elizabethan women married in their twenties.

## Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

**Focus:** the divided world of Verona

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list divides Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, his kinsmen Paris and Mercutio), the house of Montague (Montague, Lady Montague, Romeo, Benvolio and servants) and the house of Capulet (Capulet, Lady Capulet, Juliet, Tybalt, the Nurse and servants), with two Franciscan friars and an apothecary outside both. The scenes are Verona and Mantua.

**Background:** Verona and Mantua were real cities in northern Italy; Italy was, for English audiences of the 1590s, a place of passion, feuds and fashionable duelling. The story came to Shakespeare through Arthur Brooke's English poem of 1562.

**Significance:** Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because....*
**Prompt:** Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: maskers — people in masks and costume who join a party; nobleman — a man of noble rank; kinsman — a male relative; attendants — servants who wait on a person of rank; overthrows — downfalls; ruinous defeats.*
**Words:** maskers: people in masks and costume who join a party · nobleman: a man of noble rank · kinsman: a male relative · attendants: servants who wait on a person of rank · overthrows: downfalls; ruinous defeats

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Verona and Mantua were real cities in northern Italy; Italy was, for English audiences of the 1590s, a place of passion, feuds and fashionable duelling. The story came to Shakespeare through Arthur Brooke's English poem of 1562. Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide. Characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Setting: "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile. Conflict: "heads of houses at variance with each other": the feud is in the cast list before any line is spoken. Watch for the two houses: "Montague" and "Capulet" are names before they are people; the play will test whether a name can be set aside (names and identity).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). The conflict is built into the cast list. That is characterization at work: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts.*

> *Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). The conflict is built into the cast list. That is characterization at work: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Mercutio is related to the Prince but is Romeo's friend, so he belongs to neither house. Expected link: violence and the feud: even outsiders get drawn in. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: Servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. (Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.)*

> *Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Mercutio is related to the Prince but is Romeo's friend, so he belongs to neither house. Expected link: violence and the feud: even outsiders get drawn in.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
**Expected answer:** Servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. (Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the divided world of Verona? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the divided world of Verona. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. When the text says "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the divided world of Verona? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the divided world of Verona. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. When the text says "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships? Have students sort the characters into Montague, Capulet, the Prince's family and the Church, then predict who will cross the lines.*

**Anchor question:** Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?

**Facilitation:** Have students sort the characters into Montague, Capulet, the Prince's family and the Church, then predict who will cross the lines.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the divided world of Verona? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. ("Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other", Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the divided world of Verona? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. ("Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other", Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the divided world of Verona. Key takeaway: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts.
- **Setting:** "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile.
- **Conflict:** "heads of houses at variance with each other": the feud is in the cast list before any line is spoken.

### Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the two houses:** "Montague" and "Capulet" are names before they are people; the play will test whether a name can be set aside (names and identity).
- **Verona and Mantua:** the city of the feud and the city of exile; leaving Verona will feel like leaving the world.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) The conflict is built into the cast list.
- "Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues.
- "Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud.
**Evidence:** "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))
**Reasoning:** "Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance" are paired as enemies, while Mercutio is "kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo": a neutral who will be pulled into the fight.

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **maskers** (noun) | people in masks and costume who join a party | *Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **nobleman** (noun) | a man of noble rank | *Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **attendants** (noun) | servants who wait on a person of rank | *Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **overthrows** (noun) | downfalls; ruinous defeats | *From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents' strife.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **households** (noun) | families, including their servants and dependents | *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dignity** (noun) | high rank and standing in society | *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **colliers** (noun) | | *No, for then we should be colliers.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Which characters belong to neither the Montague nor the Capulet house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Escalus, Paris, Mercutio, the two friars, the apothecary and the citizens.
2. Who is the prince of Verona? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Escalus
3. Whose son is Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Montague's
4. Whose nephew is Tybalt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Lady Capulet's
5. In which two places is the play set? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Verona and Mantua
6. What is Mercutio's relation to the Prince? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Kinsman
7. Retell the three most important events of “Dramatis Personae” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The cast list divides Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, his kinsmen Paris and Mercutio), the house of Montague (Montague, Lady Montague, Romeo, Benvolio and servants) and the house of Capulet (Capulet, Lady Capulet, Juliet, Tybalt, the Nurse and servants), with two Franciscan friars and an apothecary outside both. The scenes are Verona and Mantua.
8. Who is on stage in “Dramatis Personae”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Dramatis Personae” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants” What does “maskers” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: maskers: people in masks and costume who join a party.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why might it matter that Mercutio and Paris are related to the Prince? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: They are outsiders to the feud, so their deaths implicate the Prince's family and the city.
2. What does “Dramatis Personae” suggest about the divided world of Verona? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the setting in this scene shape what we understand about the divided world of Verona? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The conflict is built into the cast list. On setting: "Verona; Mantua": the city of the feud and the city of exile. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Escalus, prince of Verona”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The cast list divides Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, his kinsmen Paris and Mercutio), the house of Montague (Montague, Lady Montague, Romeo, Benvolio and servants) and the house of Capulet (Capulet, Lady Capulet, Juliet, Tybalt, the Nurse and servants), with two Franciscan friars and an…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Romeo and Juliet will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. On characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting

starts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever belonged to a group that had a rival group? How did that rivalry affect friendships?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The conflict is built into the cast list. On conflict: "heads of houses at variance with each other": the feud is in the cast list before any line is spoken. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is it fair that servants are drawn into their masters' feud? What does the cast list suggest about loyalty? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Servants are defined by 'servant to'; their loyalty is assigned, not chosen.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Reading the cast first lets students see the feud's structure: two houses 'at variance', each with servants who fight for them, and a few figures (the Prince's kin, the Friar) who might bridge or break the divide.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The conflict is built into the cast list. On characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues

and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the divided world of Verona. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The conflict is built into the cast list. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. On characterization: The list sorts Verona into the Prince's family (Escalus, Paris, Mercutio), the Montagues and the Capulets. Mercutio and Paris belong to neither house, which matters when the fighting starts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the divided world of Verona with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Tybalt, nephew to Lady Capulet” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Tybalt's tie to Lady Capulet explains her later grief and demand for revenge. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Prologue” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Montague and Capulet, heads of houses at variance with each other” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The conflict is built into the cast list. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the divided world of Verona? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a city divided into camps, with only the Prince's kin standing outside the feud. Useful evidence: “Mercutio, kinsman to the prince, and friend to Romeo” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Mercutio stands between the Prince's family and the Montagues. Theme link: servants are listed by house; the quarrel reaches down to every household member. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who is the prince of Verona?
   A. Capulet
   B. Mercutio
   C. Paris
   D. Escalus
2. Whose son is Romeo?
   A. Friar Laurence's
   B. Montague's
   C. The Prince's
   D. Capulet's

3. Whose nephew is Tybalt?
   A. Lady Capulet's
   B. Lady Montague's
   C. The Prince's
   D. Montague's
4. In which two places is the play set?
   A. Verona and Mantua
   B. Venice and Rome
   C. Padua and Milan
   D. Verona and Florence
5. What is Mercutio's relation to the Prince?
   A. Son
   B. Enemy
   C. Servant
   D. Kinsman
6. In the line "Citizens of Verona; several men and women, relations to both houses; maskers, guards, watchmen, and attendants", what does "maskers" most nearly mean?
   A. a male relative
   B. people in masks and costume who join a party
   C. a man of noble rank
   D. servants who wait on a person of rank
7. In the line "Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince", what does "nobleman" most nearly mean?
   A. servants who wait on a person of rank
   B. people in masks and costume who join a party
   C. a male relative
   D. a man of noble rank

**Answer key:** 1. D (Escalus); 2. B (Montague's); 3. A (Lady Capulet's); 4. A (Verona and Mantua); 5. D (Kinsman); 6. B (people in masks and costume who join a party); 7. D (a man of noble rank)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Dramatis Personae," how does Shakespeare show the divided world of Verona? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the divided world of Verona? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the divided world of Verona. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the divided world of Verona. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the divided world of Verona. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the divided world of Verona. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the divided world of Verona responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the divided world of Verona follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of the divided world of Verona. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the divided world of Verona in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the divided world of Verona. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Paris, a young nobleman, kinsman to the prince*

   As used in the text, what does the word "kinsman" most nearly mean?

   A. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men

   B. a male relative

   C. families, including their servants and dependents

   D. high rank and standing in society

2. *Escalus, prince of Verona*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

   A. The second Chorus

   B. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

   C. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

   D. The divided world of Verona

**SAT key:** 1. B (a male relative); 2. D (The divided world of Verona)

## Lesson 3: Prologue

**Focus:** the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus speaks a sonnet: two households of equal rank in Verona break out in new violence from an old grudge; from them come a pair of 'star-cross'd lovers' whose deaths end their parents' strife. The play, the Chorus says, will show 'the two hours' traffic of our stage.'

**Background:** Elizabethan plays sometimes opened with a Chorus or Prologue. The sonnet was the fashionable love-poem form of the 1590s; Shakespeare's own sonnets were circulating among friends by 1598.

**Significance:** Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because....*
> **Prompt:** If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: overthrows — downfalls; ruinous defeats; households — families, including their servants and dependents; dignity — high rank and standing in society; colliers — coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men; assailing — attacking, here with admiring looks.*
> **Words:** overthrows: downfalls; ruinous defeats · households: families, including their servants and dependents · dignity: high rank and standing in society · colliers: coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men · assailing: attacking, here with admiring looks

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Elizabethan plays sometimes opened with a Chorus or Prologue. The sonnet was the fashionable love-poem form of the 1590s; Shakespeare's own sonnets were circulating among friends by 1598. Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic. Structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Foreshadowing: It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife." Diction / vocabulary: "civil blood makes civil hands unclean": the repeated word turns "civil" (of citizens; polite) against itself. Watch for haste and time: Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: "their children's end, nought could remove, / Is now the two hours' traffic of our stage; / The which if you with patient ears" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)). Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. That is structure at work: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death.*

> *Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean (Prologue, speech (speech 0))*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)). Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. That is structure at work: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Star-cross'd" means thwarted by the stars (fate). "Take their life" can mean get their life from these parents or kill themselves. Expected link: fate and choice. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. (The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves.")*

> *A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life (Prologue, speech (speech 0))*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** "Star-cross'd" means thwarted by the stars (fate). "Take their life" can mean get their life from these parents or kill themselves. Expected link: fate and choice.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to fate and choice?
**Expected answer:** "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. (The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves.")

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for structure, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue develops the idea of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. When the text says “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. The Chorus announces that the "star-cross'd lovers take their life" and that their deaths "bury their parents' strife," so suspense comes from watching choices we know are fatal.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for structure, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue develops the idea of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. When the text says “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. The Chorus announces that the "star-cross'd lovers take their life" and that their deaths "bury their parents' strife," so suspense comes from watching choices we know are fatal.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why? Ask: does knowing the ending make the play less interesting or more? Why might a playwright choose this?*

**Anchor question:** If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?

**Facilitation:** Ask: does knowing the ending make the play less interesting or more? Why might a playwright choose this?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. (“A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life”, Prologue, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. (“A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life”, Prologue, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how structure shapes the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Key takeaway: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Structure:** The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death.
- **Foreshadowing:** It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife."
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "civil blood makes civil hands unclean": the repeated word turns "civil" (of citizens; polite) against itself.

### Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

### Symbols and motifs

- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “their children’s end, nought could remove, / Is now the two hours’ traffic of our stage; / The which if you with patient ears” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)).
- **death as bridegroom:** Death is repeatedly imagined as Juliet's husband or lover, long before she lies in the tomb. In this scene: “take their life; / Whose misadventured piteous overthrows / Do with their

death bury their parents' strife. / The fearful passage of their death-mark'd love" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)) Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens.
- "A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)) The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves."
- "Do with their death bury their parents' strife" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)) The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how.
**Evidence:** "A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life" (Prologue, speech (speech 0))
**Reasoning:** The Chorus announces that the "star-cross'd lovers take their life" and that their deaths "bury their parents' strife," so suspense comes from watching choices we know are fatal.

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **overthrows** (noun) | downfalls; ruinous defeats | *From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents' strife.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **households** (noun) | families, including their servants and dependents | *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dignity** (noun) | high rank and standing in society | *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **colliers** (noun) | coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men | *No, for then we should be colliers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **assailing** (adjective) | attacking, here with admiring looks | *She will not stay the siege of loving terms, Nor bide the encounter of assailing eyes, Nor ope her lap to saint-seducing gold: O, she is rich in beauty, only poor, That when she dies with beauty dies her store.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **propagate** (verb) | increase; make (grief) multiply | *Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| | | *Clubs, bills, and partisans! strike! beat them down!* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **partisans** (noun) | long-handled spears with broad blades | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bucklers** (noun) | small round shields | *Enter Sampson and Gregory, of the house of Capulet, armed with swords and bucklers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What does 'star-cross'd' mean? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Thwarted or opposed by the stars, that is, by fate.
2. What form does the Prologue take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A sonnet
3. Where is the play set? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Fair Verona
4. What does the Prologue say will end the parents' strife? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The lovers' death
5. How does the Prologue describe the two households? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Both alike in dignity
6. How long does the Chorus say the play will last? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Two hours
7. Retell the three most important events of “Prologue” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Chorus speaks a sonnet: two households of equal rank in Verona break out in new violence from an old grudge; from them come a pair of 'star-cross'd lovers' whose deaths end their parents' strife. The play, the Chorus says, will show 'the two hours' traffic of our stage.'
8. Who is on stage in “Prologue”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Prologue” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents’ strife.” What does “overthrows”

mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: overthrows: downfalls; ruinous defeats.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Prologue repeat the word 'civil'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Citizens kill citizens; 'civil' also means polite, so violence makes the civilized unclean.
2. What does “Prologue” suggest about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. On foreshadowing: It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Prologue”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The Chorus speaks a sonnet: two households of equal rank in Verona break out in new violence from an old grudge; from them come a pair of 'star-cross'd lovers' whose deaths end their parents' strife. The play, the Chorus says, will show 'the two hours' traffic of our stage.'
7. How does “Prologue” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." On structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “If you knew how a story would end, would you still want to read it? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. On diction / vocabulary: "civil blood makes civil hands unclean": the repeated word turns "civil" (of citizens; polite) against itself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Does the Prologue make the lovers victims of fate or of their families? Argue from its wording. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A reasoned reading of 'star-cross'd' and 'parents' rage' and 'strife'.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Telling the ending first turns the play from a story of what happens into a study of how and why, and makes every hopeful moment dramatically ironic.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Prologue”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." On structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Prologue”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury their parents’ strife” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life” (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." On structure: The Prologue is a sonnet (fourteen lines, abab cdcd efef gg) spoken by the Chorus: the play opens with a love poem about death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Prologue” treats the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: “Do with their death bury

their parents' strife" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The deaths end the feud: the tragedy has a purpose. Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: "Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): Citizens stain their hands with the blood of fellow citizens. On foreshadowing: It tells the whole ending: the lovers "take their life" and their deaths "bury their parents' strife." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: By revealing the ending at the start, the Prologue shifts the audience's attention from what happens to why and how. Useful evidence: "A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life" (Prologue, speech (speech 0)): The lovers are thwarted by the stars; "take their life" means both "are born" and "kill themselves." Theme link: "star-cross'd" and "death-mark'd" suggest fate; ask whether the rest of the play agrees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What form does the Prologue take?
   A. A song in prose
   B. A ballad
   C. A sonnet
   D. A letter
2. Where is the play set?
   A. Rome
   B. Fair Verona
   C. London
   D. Mantua alone

3. What does the Prologue say will end the parents' strife?
   A. A marriage treaty
   B. A duel
   C. The lovers' death
   D. The Prince's law
4. How does the Prologue describe the two households?
   A. One rich, one poor
   B. Newly arrived
   C. Old friends
   D. Both alike in dignity
5. How long does the Chorus say the play will last?
   A. One day
   B. Three hours
   C. An evening and a morning
   D. Two hours
6. In the line “From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross’d lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents’ strife.”, what does “overthrows” most nearly mean?
   A. high rank and standing in society
   B. downfalls; ruinous defeats
   C. families, including their servants and dependents
   D. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men
7. In the line “Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.”, what does “households” most nearly mean?
   A. downfalls; ruinous defeats
   B. high rank and standing in society
   C. families, including their servants and dependents
   D. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men

**Answer key:** 1. C (A sonnet); 2. B (Fair Verona); 3. C (The lovers' death); 4. D (Both alike in dignity); 5. D (Two hours); 6. B (downfalls; ruinous defeats); 7. C (families, including their servants and dependents)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Prologue,” how does Shakespeare show the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Prologue, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Prologue develops the idea of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Prologue suggests about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Prologue to complicate the reader's understanding of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Prologue within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Prologue alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Prologue and its treatment of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Prologue as evidence for a larger claim about the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Prologue as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold.

Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "dignity" most nearly mean?

   A. small round shields

   B. increase; make (grief) multiply

   C. long-handled spears with broad blades

   D. high rank and standing in society

2. *Two households, both alike in dignity, In fair Verona, where we lay our scene, From ancient grudge break to new mutiny, Where civil blood makes civil hands unclean. From forth the fatal loins of these two foes A pair of star-cross'd lovers take their life; Whose misadventured piteous overthrows Do with their death bury their parents' strife. The fearful passage of their death-mark'd love, And the continuance of their parents' rage, Which, but their children's end, nought could remove, Is now the two hours' traffic of our stage; The which if you with patient ears attend, What here shall miss, our toil shall strive to mend.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue"?

   A. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

   B. Wedding preparations

   C. The divided world of Verona

   D. The undelivered letter

**SAT key:** 1. D (high rank and standing in society); 2. A (The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold)

## Lesson 4: Act I, Scene I

**Focus:** the street brawl and lovesick Romeo

Teacher only · spoilers

Capulet servants Sampson and Gregory provoke Montague servants; Benvolio tries to part them, Tybalt attacks him, and a general brawl draws in citizens and the old heads of both houses. Prince Escalus stops it and decrees death for the next disturbance. Benvolio then finds Romeo moping: he loves Rosaline, who has sworn to stay chaste.

**Background:** Elizabethan London had laws against brawling and carrying weapons in the streets; 'biting the thumb' was an insulting gesture. Petrarchan love poetry (after the Italian poet Petrarch) described a lover suffering for a cold, unattainable lady, exactly Romeo's pose.

**Significance:** The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because....*
**Prompt:** What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: colliers — coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men; assailing — attacking, here with admiring looks; propagate — increase; make (grief) multiply; partisans — long-handled spears with broad blades; bucklers — small round shields.*
**Words:** colliers: coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men · assailing: attacking, here with admiring looks · propagate: increase; make (grief) multiply · partisans: long-handled spears with broad blades · bucklers: small round shields

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Elizabethan London had laws against brawling and carrying weapons in the streets; 'biting the thumb' was an insulting gesture. Petrarchan love poetry (after the Italian poet Petrarch) described a lover suffering for a cold, unattainable lady, exactly Romeo's pose. The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person. Conflict: A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince. Characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Diction / vocabulary: Romeo's oxymorons ("O brawling love! O loving hate!") show a lover in love with the language of love. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Madam, an hour before the worshipp'd sun / Peer'd forth the golden window of the east, / A troubled mind" (Act I, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 55)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)). Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. That is conflict at work: A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince.*

> *I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee* (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)). Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. That is conflict at work: A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: An oxymoron joins opposites ("loving hate"). Romeo's love for Rosaline is confused and showy, and the opposites echo the brawl he has just missed. Expected link: love and desire. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: The Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. (Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.)*

> *O brawling love! O loving hate* (Act I, Scene I, Romeo (speech 74))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** An oxymoron joins opposites ("loving hate"). Romeo's love for Rosaline is confused and showy, and the opposites echo the brawl he has just missed. Expected link: love and desire.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
**Expected answer:** The Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. (Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. When the text says "If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace" (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)), it shows this directly. The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. When the text says "If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace" (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)), it shows this directly. The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news. Ask: who is most responsible for the brawl? Have students rank the participants and defend their order.*

**Anchor question:** What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.

**Facilitation:** Ask: who is most responsible for the brawl? Have students rank the participants and defend their order.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. (“If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace”, Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. (“If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace”, Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Key takeaway: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Conflict:** A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince.
- **Characterization:** Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Romeo's oxymorons ("O brawling love! O loving hate!") show a lover in love with the language of love.

### Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter.

### Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Madam, an hour before the worshipp’d sun / Peer’d forth the golden window of the east, / A troubled mind” (Act I, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 55)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “Madam, an

hour before the worshipp'd sun / Peer'd forth the golden window of the" (Act I, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 55)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee" (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)) Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake.
- "If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace" (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)) The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives.
- "O brawling love! O loving hate" (Act I, Scene I, Romeo (speech 74)) Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause.
**Evidence:** "If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace" (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51))
**Reasoning:** The fight begins with a bitten thumb, and Tybalt says he hates "peace" "As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee," while the Prince warns that "Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **colliers** (noun) | coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men | *No, for then we should be colliers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **assailing** (adjective) | attacking, here with admiring looks | *She will not stay the siege of loving terms, Nor bide the encounter of assailing eyes, Nor ope her lap to saint-seducing gold: O, she is rich in beauty, only poor, That when she dies with beauty dies her store.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **propagate** (verb) | increase; make (grief) multiply | *Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **partisans** (noun) | long-handled spears with broad blades | *Clubs, bills, and partisans! strike! beat them down!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bucklers** (noun) | small round shields | *Enter Sampson and Gregory, of the house of Capulet, armed with swords and bucklers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **flourishes** (verb) | waves (a weapon) about in a showy way | *Old Montague is come, And flourishes his blade in spite of me.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **grievance** (noun) | the cause of his complaint or sorrow | *See, where he comes: so please you, step aside; I'll know his grievance, or be much denied.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **valiant** (adjective) | brave; courageous | *To move is to stir; and to be valiant is to stand: therefore, if thou art moved, thou runn'st away.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who first draws on Benvolio? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Tybalt, who says he hates peace as he hates hell.
2. Which house do Sampson and Gregory serve? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Capulet
3. What insulting gesture starts the quarrel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Biting the thumb
4. What does the Prince decree for the next brawl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Death
5. Who tries to keep the peace? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Benvolio
6. Whom does Romeo love at the start? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Rosaline
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Capulet servants Sampson and Gregory provoke Montague servants; Benvolio tries to part them, Tybalt attacks him, and a general brawl draws in citizens and the old heads of both houses. Prince Escalus stops it and decrees death for the next disturbance. Benvolio then finds Romeo moping: he loves Rosaline, who has sworn to stay chaste.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “No, for then we should be colliers.” What does “colliers” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: colliers: coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Shakespeare open with servants and puns before the masters appear? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: To show the feud filtering down to every level and to mix comedy with menace.
2. What does “Act I, Scene I” suggest about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. On characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Why, such is love’s transgression.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Capulet servants Sampson and Gregory provoke Montague servants; Benvolio tries to part them, Tybalt attacks him, and a general brawl draws in citizens and the old heads of both houses. Prince Escalus stops it and decrees death for the next disturbance. Benvolio then finds Romeo moping: he loves…
7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Prologue”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo (speech 74)): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. On characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee";

Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What makes small insults turn into big fights? Think of an example from school or the news.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. On diction / vocabulary: Romeo's oxymorons ("O brawling love! O loving hate!") show a lover in love with the language of love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Romeo's love for Rosaline real love? Use his oxymorons as evidence. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment on Petrarchan posing versus feeling.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene establishes the feud's absurd energy, the Prince's death sentence that will make Romeo's later fight fatal, and Romeo's habit of falling in love with language as much as with a person.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo (speech 74)): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. On characterization: Benvolio tries to keep the peace; Tybalt, asked to keep the peace, says "I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee"; Romeo is lovesick for Rosaline. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo (speech 74)): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. On conflict: A servants' quarrel over a bitten thumb becomes a street brawl involving the masters, the citizens and finally the Prince. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene I” treats the street brawl and lovesick Romeo with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “O brawling love! O loving hate” (Act I, Scene I, Romeo (speech 74)): Romeo's oxymorons link love and the feud in one phrase. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment

justified with textual clues.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee” (Act I, Scene I, Tybalt (speech 44)): Tybalt's first speech: hatred for its own sake. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows the feud as so deep that it no longer needs a cause. Useful evidence: “If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace” (Act I, Scene I, Prince (speech 51)): The Prince's law: the next fight will cost lives. Theme link: the Prince's death threat makes the next brawl a capital matter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Which house do Sampson and Gregory serve?
    A. Paris
    B. Montague
    C. Capulet
    D. The Prince
2. What insulting gesture starts the quarrel?
    A. Spitting
    B. Drawing a sword
    C. Throwing a glove
    D. Biting the thumb
3. What does the Prince decree for the next brawl?
    A. Death
    B. A fine
    C. Imprisonment
    D. Banishment
4. Who tries to keep the peace?
    A. Capulet
    B. Sampson
    C. Benvolio

D. Tybalt

5. Whom does Romeo love at the start?
   A. Helena
   B. Rosaline
   C. Livia
   D. Juliet
6. In the line “No, for then we should be colliers.”, what does “colliers” most nearly mean?
   A. increase; make (grief) multiply
   B. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men
   C. attacking, here with admiring looks
   D. long-handled spears with broad blades
7. In the line “She will not stay the siege of loving terms, Nor bide the encounter of assailing eyes, Nor ope her lap to saint-seducing gold: O, she is rich in beauty, only poor, That when she dies with beauty dies her store.”, what does “assailing” most nearly mean?
   A. attacking, here with admiring looks
   B. long-handled spears with broad blades
   C. increase; make (grief) multiply
   D. coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men

**Answer key:** 1. C (Capulet); 2. D (Biting the thumb); 3. A (Death); 4. C (Benvolio); 5. B (Rosaline); 6. B (coal-sellers, a byword for dirty, insulted men); 7. A (attacking, here with admiring looks)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the street brawl and lovesick Romeo in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the street brawl and lovesick Romeo. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “propagate” most nearly mean?

   A. increase; make (grief) multiply

   B. brave; courageous

   C. the cause of his complaint or sorrow

   D. waves (a weapon) about in a showy way

2. *Why, such is love's transgression. Griefs of mine own lie heavy in my breast, Which thou wilt propagate, to have it prest With more of thine: this love that thou hast shown Doth add more grief to too much of mine own. Love is a smoke raised with the fume of sighs; Being purged, a fire sparkling in lovers' eyes; Being vex'd, a sea nourish'd with lovers' tears: What is it else? a madness most discreet, A choking gall and a preserving sweet. Farewell, my coz.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

A. The Friar's desperate plan

B. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

C. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

D. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

**SAT key:** 1. A (increase; make (grief) multiply); 2. B (The street brawl and lovesick Romeo)

# Lesson 5: Act I, Scene II

**Focus:** Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

Teacher only · spoilers

Capulet tells Paris that Juliet is too young to marry but invites him to woo her at that night's feast; her consent will count. A servant who cannot read the guest list asks Romeo for help, and Romeo learns Rosaline will attend. Benvolio urges him to go and compare her with other beauties.

**Background:** In the 1590s aristocratic marriages were often arranged for property and alliance; legally, girls could marry at twelve, but most English women married in their mid-twenties. Literacy among servants was limited.

**Significance:** Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because....*
> **Prompt:** Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: plantain — a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts; heretics — people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love; falsehood — lying; being untrue; parlous — dangerous; alarming; cockerel — a young rooster.*
> **Words:** plantain: a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts · heretics: people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love · falsehood: lying; being untrue · parlous: dangerous; alarming · cockerel: a young rooster

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*In the 1590s aristocratic marriages were often arranged for property and alliance; legally, girls could marry at twelve, but most English women married in their mid-twenties. Literacy among servants was limited. Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal. Characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Irony: The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast. Foreshadowing: Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "of choice / Lies my consent and fair according voice. / This night I hold an old accustom'd feast, / Whereto I have invited many" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)). Capulet asks Paris to wait. That is characterization at work: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent.*

> *My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3))*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)). Capulet asks Paris to wait. That is characterization at work: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Capulet means his wish is only part of the decision; Juliet's consent matters. Expected link: youth and age; students should predict whether he keeps this promise. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. (Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.)*

> *My will to her consent is but a part (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5))*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Capulet means his wish is only part of the decision; Juliet's consent matters. Expected link: youth and age; students should predict whether he keeps this promise.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to youth and age?
**Expected answer:** Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. (Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. When the text says "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)), it shows this directly. Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. When the text says "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)), it shows this directly. Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much? Ask: is it chance or choice that brings Romeo to the Capulet feast?*

**Anchor question:** Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?

**Facilitation:** Ask: is it chance or choice that brings Romeo to the Capulet feast?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. ("My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years", Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. ("My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years", Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Key takeaway: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent.
- **Irony:** The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast.
- **Foreshadowing:** Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **youth and age:** Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “of choice / Lies my consent and fair according voice. / This night I hold an old accustom’d feast, / Whereto I have invited many” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “At my poor house look to behold this night / Earth-treading stars that make dark heaven light: / Such comfort as do lusty young” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)) Capulet asks Paris to wait.
- “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)) Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V.
- “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio (speech 26)) Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking.
**Evidence:** "My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years" (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3))
**Reasoning:** Here he insists Juliet "hath not seen the change of fourteen years" and that "My will to her consent is but a part," words that set a standard he will later break.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **plantain** (noun) | a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts | *Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **heretics** (noun) | people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love | *When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **falsehood** (noun) | lying; being untrue | *When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **parlous** (adjective) | dangerous; alarming | *And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cockerel** (noun) | a young rooster | *And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **stinted** (verb) | stopped (crying) | *I warrant, an I should live a thousand years, I never should forget it: "Wilt thou not, Jule?" quoth he; And, pretty fool, it stinted and said "Ay."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | beg; ask earnestly | *I must hence to wait; I beseech you, follow straight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **valiant** (adjective) | brave; courageous | *Thus then in brief: The valiant Paris seeks you for his love.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

## *Discussion questions*

1. Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Capulet tell Paris to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Woo Juliet and gain her heart; his will is only part of her consent.
2. What does Capulet say about Juliet's age? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: She is not yet fourteen
3. What does Paris want? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: To marry Juliet
4. Why does the servant ask Romeo for help? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: He cannot read
5. Why does Romeo decide to go to the feast? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Rosaline will be there
6. What does Benvolio promise to show Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Women who will make Rosaline seem a crow
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Capulet tells Paris that Juliet is too young to marry but invites him to woo her at that night's feast; her consent will count. A servant who cannot read the guest list asks Romeo for help, and Romeo learns Rosaline will attend. Benvolio urges him to go and compare her with other beauties.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that." What does "plantain" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: plantain: a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. What is ironic about Romeo reading the Capulet guest list? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A Montague is invited by the enemy's own servant.
2. What does "Act I, Scene II" suggest about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On irony: The illiterate servant asks Romeo, a Montague, to read the Capulet guest list, and invites him to the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown’d could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Capulet tells Paris that Juliet is too young to marry but invites him to woo her at that night's feast; her consent will count. A servant who cannot read the guest list asks Romeo for help, and Romeo learns Rosaline will attend. Benvolio urges him to go and compare her with other beauties.
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio (speech 26)): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. On characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Should parents have a say in whom their children marry? How much?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of

fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On foreshadowing: Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the meeting of Romeo and Juliet caused by fate or chance? Debate using this scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Arguments about the servant, Benvolio's choice and Romeo's.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chance (an illiterate servant) brings Romeo to the Capulet house; Capulet's stated respect for Juliet's consent sets up his later betrayal.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio (speech 26)): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio (speech 26)): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)): Capulet asks Paris to wait. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. On characterization: Capulet first seems a gentle father: Juliet is "the hopeful lady of my earth," and Paris must "woo her" and win her consent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “And I will make thee think thy swan a crow” (Act I, Scene II, Benvolio (speech 26)): Benvolio predicts Romeo will find someone more beautiful than Rosaline. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My child is yet a stranger in the world; / She hath not seen the change of fourteen years” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 3)): Capulet asks Paris to wait. On foreshadowing: Benvolio promises to show Romeo a beauty who will make him think "thy swan a crow." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's early patience makes his later anger more shocking. Useful evidence: “My will to her consent is but a part” (Act I, Scene II, Capulet (speech 5)): Capulet says Juliet's consent matters; compare Act III, Scene V. Theme link: Capulet says Juliet is too young ("She hath not seen the change of fourteen years"), a view he will abandon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Capulet say about Juliet's age?
    A. She is twelve
    B. She is eighteen
    C. She is sixteen
    D. She is not yet fourteen
2. What does Paris want?
    A. To end the feud
    B. A place at court
    C. To fight Romeo
    D. To marry Juliet
3. Why does the servant ask Romeo for help?
    A. He is afraid
    B. He is lost
    C. He cannot read
    D. He needs money
4. Why does Romeo decide to go to the feast?
    A. Tybalt challenges him
    B. Juliet invited him
    C. Rosaline will be there
    D. Mercutio dares him
5. What does Benvolio promise to show Romeo?
    A. A new sword
    B. Women who will make Rosaline seem a crow
    C. Friar Laurence

D. A way into the Prince's court

6. In the line “Your plantain-leaf is excellent for that.”, what does “plantain” most nearly mean?

A. dangerous; alarming

B. people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love

C. lying; being untrue

D. a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts

7. In the line “When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown’d could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!”, what does “heretics” most nearly mean?

A. lying; being untrue

B. people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love

C. dangerous; alarming

D. a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts

**Answer key:** 1. D (She is not yet fourteen); 2. D (To marry Juliet); 3. C (He cannot read); 4. C (Rosaline will be there); 5. B (Women who will make Rosaline seem a crow); 6. D (a common weed whose leaf was used to treat cuts); 7. B (people who abandon the true faith; here, eyes that betray their first love)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II and its treatment of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "falsehood" most nearly mean?

   A. brave; courageous

   B. beg; ask earnestly

   C. stopped (crying)

   D. lying; being untrue

2. *When the devout religion of mine eye Maintains such falsehood, then turn tears to fires; And these, who often drown'd could never die, Transparent heretics, be burnt for liars! One fairer than my love! the all-seeing sun Ne'er saw her match since first the world begun.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene II"?

   A. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

B. Juliet waits for the Nurse

C. Juliet's feigned obedience

D. Juliet hears the news

**SAT key:** 1. D (lying; being untrue); 2. A (Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation)

## Lesson 6: Act I, Scene III

**Focus:** Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Capulet calls Juliet to discuss marriage; the Nurse interrupts with a long, bawdy story of Juliet's weaning and her late husband's joke. Lady Capulet describes Paris as a fine book that needs only a cover and asks if Juliet can love him. Juliet agrees to look at him, but no more than her mother allows.

**Background:** Wealthy families commonly employed a wet-nurse to breastfeed infants; the Nurse lost her own daughter, Susan, and nursed Juliet. The 'earthquake' she mentions has been linked by some scholars to a 1580 English earthquake.

**Significance:** The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because....*
> **Prompt:** Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: parlous — dangerous; alarming; cockerel — a young rooster; stinted — stopped (crying); beseech — beg; ask earnestly; valiant — brave; courageous.*
> **Words:** parlous: dangerous; alarming · cockerel: a young rooster · stinted: stopped (crying) · beseech: beg; ask earnestly · valiant: brave; courageous

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Wealthy families commonly employed a wet-nurse to breastfeed infants; the Nurse lost her own daughter, Susan, and nursed Juliet. The 'earthquake' she mentions has been linked by some scholars to a 1580 English earthquake. The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her. Characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Metaphor: Lady Capulet's extended metaphor makes Paris a book that lacks only "a cover." Setting: The Nurse's earthquake memory places Juliet's childhood in a world of household intimacy. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "odd, of all days in the year, / Come Lammas-eve at night shall she be fourteen. / Susan and she—God rest all Christian souls" (Act I, Scene III, Nurse (speech 11)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "She's not fourteen" (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)). The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. That is characterization at work: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded.*

> *She's not fourteen* (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "She's not fourteen" (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)). The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. That is characterization at work: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: She means she will look at Paris to see if she likes him, but no more than her mother permits. Expected link: youth and age; her obedience will soon change. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. (Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.)*

> *Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face* (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** She means she will look at Paris to see if she likes him, but no more than her mother permits. Expected link: youth and age; her obedience will soon change.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to youth and age?
**Expected answer:** Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. (Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for characterization, metaphor (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. When the text says "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face" (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)), it shows this directly. Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, metaphor (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. When the text says "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face" (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)), it shows this directly. Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person? Compare how the Nurse and Lady Capulet speak to Juliet. Who seems closer to her, and why?*

**Anchor question:** Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?

**Facilitation:** Compare how the Nurse and Lady Capulet speak to Juliet. Who seems closer to her, and why?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. ("Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face", Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. ("Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face", Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Key takeaway: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded.
- **Metaphor:** Lady Capulet's extended metaphor makes Paris a book that lacks only "a cover."
- **Setting:** The Nurse's earthquake memory places Juliet's childhood in a world of household intimacy.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **youth and age:** Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “odd, of all days in the year, / Come Lammas-eve at night shall she be fourteen. / Susan and she—God rest all Christian souls” (Act I, Scene III, Nurse (speech 11)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “Faith, I can tell her age unto an hour” (Act I, Scene III, Nurse (speech 7)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)) The Nurse establishes Juliet's age.
- “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)) Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband.
- “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet (speech 26)) Juliet's careful, obedient answer.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows.
**Evidence:** “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23))
**Reasoning:** Asked to "Read o'er the volume of young Paris' face," she answers only "I'll look to like, if looking liking move," limiting herself to her mother's consent.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **parlous** (adjective) | dangerous; alarming | *And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cockerel** (noun) | a young rooster | *And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **stinted** (verb) | stopped (crying) | *I warrant, an I should live a thousand years, I never should forget it: "Wilt thou not, Jule?" quoth he; And, pretty fool, it stinted and said "Ay."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | beg; ask earnestly | *I must hence to wait; I beseech you, follow straight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **valiant** (adjective) | brave; courageous | *Thus then in brief: The valiant Paris seeks you for his love.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **misgives** (verb) | fills with doubt and foreboding | *I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **boisterous** (adjective) | violently rough | *Is love a tender thing? it is too rough, Too rude, too boisterous, and it pricks like thorn.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **constable** (noun) | a parish officer who keeps the peace | *Tut, dun's the mouse, the constable's own word: If thou art dun, we'll draw thee from the mire Of this sir-reverence love, wherein thou stick'st Up to the ears.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. How old was Lady Capulet when she became a mother? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: About Juliet's age; she says she was a mother at Juliet's years.
2. How old is Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Not yet fourteen
3. What did the Nurse do for Juliet as a baby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Breastfed her
4. What does Lady Capulet compare Paris to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A book
5. What is Juliet's answer about Paris? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: She will look to like him if looking moves liking
6. What event does the Nurse use to date Juliet's weaning? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: An earthquake
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Lady Capulet calls Juliet to discuss marriage; the Nurse interrupts with a long, bawdy story of Juliet's weaning and her late husband's joke. Lady Capulet describes Paris as a fine book that needs only a cover and asks if Juliet can love him. Juliet agrees to look at him, but no more than her mother allows.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?" What does "parlous" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: parlous: dangerous; alarming.

### Inferential / analytical

1. What does the Nurse's story reveal about her relationship with Juliet? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: She loves her like her own daughter; their bond is intimate and earthy.
2. What does "Act I, Scene III" suggest about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: "She's not fourteen" (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and

expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Yes, madam: yet I cannot choose but laugh, To think it should leave crying and say “Ay.””, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Lady Capulet calls Juliet to discuss marriage; the Nurse interrupts with a long, bawdy story of Juliet's weaning and her late husband's joke. Lady Capulet describes Paris as a fine book that needs only a cover and asks if Juliet can love him. Juliet agrees to look at him, but no more than her…
7. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. On characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Who do you go to for advice: a parent, a friend or someone else? Why that person?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. On setting: The Nurse's earthquake memory places Juliet's childhood in a world of household intimacy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Juliet's answer obedient or cleverly noncommittal? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A reading of 'I'll look to like, if looking liking move.'
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's

mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The scene introduces the Nurse as Juliet's real confidante and Lady Capulet as distant; Juliet's careful answer shows her before love changes her.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. On characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and

expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. On characterization: The Nurse rambles bawdily about Juliet's weaning; Lady Capulet is formal and distant; Juliet is obedient and guarded. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats Juliet, her mother and the Nurse with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “I’ll look to like, if looking liking move” (Act I, Scene III, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's careful, obedient answer. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “She’s not fourteen” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 8)): The Nurse establishes Juliet's age. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet enters as a dutiful daughter who promises nothing beyond what her mother allows. Useful evidence: “Read o’er the volume of young Paris’ face” (Act I, Scene III, Lady Capulet (speech 23)): Lady Capulet's book metaphor for a husband. Theme link: Juliet's mother married young and expects Juliet to do the same. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

### *Chapter quiz*

1. How old is Juliet?
   A. Sixteen
   B. Not yet fourteen
   C. Eighteen
   D. Twelve
2. What did the Nurse do for Juliet as a baby?
   A. Breastfed her
   B. Hid her from Montagues
   C. Named her
   D. Taught her to read
3. What does Lady Capulet compare Paris to?
   A. A book
   B. A rose
   C. A ship
   D. A star
4. What is Juliet's answer about Paris?
   A. She asks for time to pray
   B. She refuses
   C. She will look to like him if looking moves liking
   D. She loves him already
5. What event does the Nurse use to date Juliet's weaning?
   A. A plague
   B. A wedding
   C. An earthquake
   D. A war
6. In the line "And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?", what does "parlous" most nearly mean?
   A. stopped (crying)
   B. a young rooster
   C. dangerous; alarming
   D. beg; ask earnestly
7. In the line "And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face?", what does "cockerel" most nearly mean?
   A. a young rooster
   B. stopped (crying)
   C. dangerous; alarming

D. beg; ask earnestly

**Answer key:** 1. B (Not yet fourteen); 2. A (Breastfed her); 3. A (A book); 4. C (She will look to like him if looking moves liking); 5. C (An earthquake); 6. C (dangerous; alarming); 7. A (a young rooster)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet, her mother and the Nurse in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet, her mother and the Nurse. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *I warrant, an I should live a thousand years, I never should forget it: "Wilt thou not, Jule?" quoth he; And, pretty fool, it stinted and said "Ay."*

   As used in the text, what does the word "stinted" most nearly mean?

   A. violently rough

   B. fills with doubt and foreboding

   C. a parish officer who keeps the peace

   D. stopped (crying)

2. *Yes, madam: yet I cannot choose but laugh, To think it should leave crying and say "Ay." And yet, I warrant, it had upon its brow A bump as big as a young cockerel's stone; A parlous knock; and it cried bitterly: "Yea," quoth my husband, "fall'st upon thy face? Thou wilt fall backward when thou comest to age; Wilt thou not, Jule?" it stinted and said "Ay."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

   A. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

   B. The Friar's desperate plan

   C. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

   D. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

**SAT key:** 1. D (stopped (crying)); 2. D (Juliet, her mother and the Nurse)

## Lesson 7: Act I, Scene IV

**Focus:** Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

Teacher only · spoilers

Masked and carrying torches, Romeo, Mercutio and Benvolio head to the Capulet feast. Romeo, heavy-hearted, says he dreamed a dream; Mercutio answers with the Queen Mab speech about a fairy who drives through sleepers' brains and gives them dreams, ending in darker images. Romeo fears a consequence 'hanging in the stars' will begin tonight, but goes on.

**Background:** Masked uninvited guests at a feast were a known custom. Mab was a figure of English folklore; belief in dreams as omens was widespread.

**Significance:** Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because....*
> **Prompt:** Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: misgives — fills with doubt and foreboding; boisterous — violently rough; constable — a parish officer who keeps the peace; proverb — an old saying; fearful — full of fear; dreadful.*
> **Words:** misgives: fills with doubt and foreboding · boisterous: violently rough · constable: a parish officer who keeps the peace · proverb: an old saying · fearful: full of fear; dreadful

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Masked uninvited guests at a feast were a known custom. Mab was a figure of English folklore; belief in dreams as omens was widespread. Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold. Characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Foreshadowing: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Imagery: Mab drives "Athwart men's noses as they lie asleep": tiny, precise images that grow darker. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Give me a torch: I am not for this ambling; / Being but heavy, I will" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 3)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)). Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. That is characterization at work: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare.*

> *O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23))*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)). Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. That is characterization at work: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo's premonition. Look at the craft: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." (Romeo's premonition.)*

> *Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27))*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Romeo's premonition. Look at the craft: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death."
**Ask:** How does this line connect to fate and choice?
**Expected answer:** Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." (Romeo's premonition.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. When the text says “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)), it shows this directly. He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. When the text says “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)), it shows this directly. He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not? Ask: what does the Queen Mab speech reveal about Mercutio? Is he joking, or is something darker under the wit?*

**Anchor question:** Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?

**Facilitation:** Ask: what does the Queen Mab speech reveal about Mercutio? Is he joking, or is something darker under the wit?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. ("Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels", Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. ("Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels", Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Key takeaway: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare.
- **Foreshadowing:** Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death."
- **Imagery:** Mab drives "Athwart men's noses as they lie asleep": tiny, precise images that grow darker.

### Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course."

### Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Give me a torch: I am not for this ambling; / Being but heavy, I will" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 3)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "for my mind misgives / Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels and" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)) Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy.
- "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)) Romeo's premonition.
- "But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)) Romeo hands his course to God or fate.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on.
**Evidence:** "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27))
**Reasoning:** He fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin "With this night's revels," yet he says "He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" and follows his friends.

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **misgives** (verb) | fills with doubt and foreboding | *I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **boisterous** (adjective) | violently rough | *Is love a tender thing? it is too rough, Too rude, too boisterous, and it pricks like thorn.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **constable** (noun) | a parish officer who keeps the peace | *Tut, dun's the mouse, the constable's own word: If thou art dun, we'll draw thee from the mire Of this sir-reverence love, wherein thou stick'st Up to the ears.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **proverb** (noun) | an old saying | *A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **fearful** (adjective) | full of fear; dreadful | *I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **marchpane** (noun) | marzipan, a sweet almond paste | *Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **forswear** (verb) | deny under oath; take back | *Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight!* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **palmers** (noun) | pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land | *Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What does Romeo say about his dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: He dreamed a dream tonight; he says dreamers often lie.
2. What are the friends going to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Capulet feast
3. Who is Queen Mab? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A fairy who brings dreams
4. What does Romeo fear? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A consequence hanging in the stars
5. What do the friends carry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Torches
6. Who delivers the Queen Mab speech? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Mercutio
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Masked and carrying torches, Romeo, Mercutio and Benvolio head to the Capulet feast. Romeo, heavy-hearted, says he dreamed a dream; Mercutio answers with the Queen Mab speech about a fairy who drives through sleepers' brains and gives them dreams, ending in darker images. Romeo fears a consequence 'hanging in the stars' will begin tonight, but goes on.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night's revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By

some vile…" What does "misgives" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: misgives: fills with doubt and foreboding.

### Inferential / analytical

1. How does the Queen Mab speech change as it goes on? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: It moves from playful fairy detail to violence, nightmares and a soldier dreaming of cutting throats.
2. What does "Act I, Scene IV" suggest about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: "O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you" (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On imagery: Mab drives "Athwart men's noses as they lie asleep": tiny, precise images that grow darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act I, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Masked and carrying torches, Romeo, Mercutio and Benvolio head to the Capulet feast. Romeo, heavy-hearted, says he dreamed a dream; Mercutio answers with the Queen Mab speech about a fairy who drives through sleepers' brains and gives them dreams, ending in darker images. Romeo fears a consequence…
7. How does "Act I, Scene IV" build on "Act I, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night's revels" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: "But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail" (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. On characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do you believe dreams can predict anything? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On foreshadowing: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Does Romeo's premonition make him more or less responsible for what follows? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment weighing foreknowledge and choice.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Mercutio's speech shows wit sliding into darkness; Romeo's premonition ties the feast to the tragedy foretold.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but

chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 23)): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo's premonition. On characterization: Mercutio's Queen Mab speech spirals from fairy fancy into images of war and nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene IV” treats Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “But He, that hath the steerage of my course, / Direct my sail” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo hands his course to God or fate. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “O, then, I see Queen Mab hath been with you” (Act I, Scene IV,

Mercutio (speech 23)): Mercutio mocks dreams as the work of a fairy. On foreshadowing: Romeo fears "Some consequence yet hanging in the stars" will begin this night and end in "untimely death." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo enters the Capulet house expecting disaster but chooses to go on. Useful evidence: “Some consequence yet hanging in the stars / Shall bitterly begin his fearful date / With this night’s revels” (Act I, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 27)): Romeo's premonition. Theme link: Romeo senses fate but goes anyway, trusting "He, that hath the steerage of my course." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What are the friends going to?
    A. Mantua
    B. The Capulet feast
    C. A duel
    D. Church
2. Who is Queen Mab?
    A. A fairy who brings dreams
    B. A queen of Verona
    C. Rosaline's mother
    D. Juliet's nurse
3. What does Romeo fear?
    A. Being caught by the Prince
    B. A consequence hanging in the stars
    C. Losing Rosaline
    D. Tybalt's sword
4. What do the friends carry?
    A. Torches
    B. Lanterns
    C. Swords only

D. Flowers

5. Who delivers the Queen Mab speech?
   A. Tybalt
   B. Mercutio
   C. Romeo
   D. Benvolio
6. In the line “I fear, too early: for my mind misgives Some consequence yet hanging in the stars Shall bitterly begin his fearful date With this night’s revels and expire the term Of a despised life closed in my breast By some vile forfeit of untimely death.”, what does “misgives” most nearly mean?
   A. a parish officer who keeps the peace
   B. fills with doubt and foreboding
   C. violently rough
   D. an old saying
7. In the line “Is love a tender thing? it is too rough, Too rude, too boisterous, and it pricks like thorn.”, what does “boisterous” most nearly mean?
   A. fills with doubt and foreboding
   B. an old saying
   C. a parish officer who keeps the peace
   D. violently rough

**Answer key:** 1. B (The Capulet feast); 2. A (A fairy who brings dreams); 3. B (A consequence hanging in the stars); 4. A (Torches); 5. B (Mercutio); 6. B (fills with doubt and foreboding); 7. D (violently rough)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act I, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's

understanding of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene IV suggests about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene IV and its treatment of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Tut, dun's the mouse, the constable's own word: If thou art dun, we'll draw thee from the mire Of this sir-reverence love, wherein thou stick'st Up to the ears.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "constable" most nearly mean?

   A. a parish officer who keeps the peace

   B. deny under oath; take back

C. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

D. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

2. *A torch for me: let wantons light of heart Tickle the senseless rushes with their heels, For I am proverb'd with a grandsire phrase; I'll be a candle-holder, and look on. The game was ne'er so fair, and I am done.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene IV"?

A. Juliet's feigned obedience

B. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

C. The divided world of Verona

D. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

**SAT key:** 1. A (a parish officer who keeps the peace); 2. B (Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition)

## Lesson 8: Act I, Scene V

**Focus:** love at first sight at the Capulet feast

Teacher only · spoilers

At the feast Romeo sees Juliet and forgets Rosaline. Tybalt recognizes Romeo's voice and wants to fight; Capulet forbids it. Romeo and Juliet speak a shared sonnet and kiss twice. Each learns from the Nurse who the other is.

**Background:** Feasts with dancing and masks were grand social occasions. The lovers' sonnet uses the language of pilgrims and saints; religious imagery in love poetry was a convention.

**Significance:** The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....*
**Prompt:** What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: marchpane — marzipan, a sweet almond paste; forswear — deny under oath; take back; palmers — pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land; trooping — going along with a crowd; loathed — hated.*
**Words:** marchpane: marzipan, a sweet almond paste · forswear: deny under oath; take back · palmers: pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land · trooping: going along with a crowd · loathed: hated

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Feasts with dancing and masks were grand social occasions. The lovers' sonnet uses the language of pilgrims and saints; religious imagery in love poetry was a convention. The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene. Structure: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses. Imagery: Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!" Dramatic irony: Each learns the other's name only after falling in love; Tybalt has already recognized Romeo. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "come near ye now? / Welcome, gentlemen! I have seen the day / That I have worn a visor and could tell / A whispering" (Act I, Scene V, Capulet (speech 7)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)). Juliet as light in darkness. That is structure at work: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses.*

> *O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright* (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)). Juliet as light in darkness. That is structure at work: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet's line balances "only love" against "only hate": the one person she loves is from the one family she must hate. Expected link: love and the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: Love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. (Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.)*

> *My only love sprung from my only hate* (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 51))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Juliet's line balances "only love" against "only hate": the one person she loves is from the one family she must hate. Expected link: love and the feud.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to love and desire?
**Expected answer:** Love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. (Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. When the text says "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)), it shows this directly. Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for structure, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. When the text says "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)), it shows this directly. Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted? Have students find the shared sonnet and mark who speaks each quatrain. What does sharing a sonnet suggest about the two?*

**Anchor question:** What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?

**Facilitation:** Have students find the shared sonnet and mark who speaks each quatrain. What does sharing a sonnet suggest about the two?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. ("O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright", Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. ("O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright", Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Key takeaway: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Structure:** Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses.
- **Imagery:** Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!"
- **Dramatic irony:** Each learns the other's name only after falling in love; Tybalt has already recognized Romeo.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **love and desire:** love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “come near ye now? / Welcome, gentlemen! I have seen the day / That I have worn a visor and could tell / A whispering” (Act I, Scene V, Capulet (speech 7)).
- **death as bridegroom:** Death is repeatedly imagined as Juliet's husband or lover, long before she lies in the tomb. In this scene: “Go ask his name: if he be married, / My grave is like to be my wedding bed” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 49)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)) Juliet as light in darkness.
- “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)) Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line.
- “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 51)) Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start.
**Evidence:** “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14))
**Reasoning:** Romeo's "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" is followed at once by Tybalt's rage, and Juliet's discovery ends the scene with "My only love sprung from my only hate."

### Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **marchpane** (noun) | marzipan, a sweet almond paste | *Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **forswear** (verb) | deny under oath; take back | *Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **palmers** (noun) | pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land | *Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **trooping** (verb) | going along with a crowd | *So shows a snowy dove trooping with crows, As yonder lady o'er her fellows shows.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **loathed** (adjective) | hated | *Prodigious birth of love it is to me, That I must love a loathed enemy.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **solemnity** (noun) | a trait of dignified seriousness | *What dares the slave, Come hither, cover'd with an antic face, To fleer and scorn at our solemnity?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *Why, how now, kinsman! wherefore storm you so?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **demesnes** (noun) | lands; domains | *I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### Discussion questions

1. What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

### Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Tybalt vow when Capulet stops him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: That this intrusion shall convert to bitter gall.
2. What does Romeo compare Juliet to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches
3. Who recognizes Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Tybalt
4. Why does Capulet stop Tybalt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: He does not want a fight at his feast and Romeo is well spoken of
5. What form does the lovers' first conversation take? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A sonnet
6. How does Juliet learn Romeo's identity? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: From the Nurse
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At the feast Romeo sees Juliet and forgets Rosaline. Tybalt recognizes Romeo's voice and wants to fight; Capulet forbids it. Romeo and Juliet speak a shared sonnet and kiss twice. Each learns from the Nurse who the other is.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell." What does "marchpane" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: marchpane: marzipan, a sweet almond paste.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the lovers use religious words (saints, pilgrims, sin)? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: They make love sacred and make the kiss a prayer.
2. What does "Act I, Scene V" suggest about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright" (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech

14)): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: At the feast Romeo sees Juliet and forgets Rosaline. Tybalt recognizes Romeo's voice and wants to fight; Capulet forbids it. Romeo and Juliet speak a shared sonnet and kiss twice. Each learns from the Nurse who the other is.
7. How does “Act I, Scene V” build on “Act I, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. On structure: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 51)): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What makes a first impression powerful? Can it be trusted?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is love at first sight believable in this scene? Defend your view with lines. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment using the sonnet and Romeo's light images.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that

makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The meeting fuses love and hate: Tybalt's vow of revenge and the lovers' discovery of each other's names come in the same scene.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 51)): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. On structure: Romeo and Juliet's first fourteen lines together form a shared sonnet about pilgrims, saints and kisses. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 51)): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. On imagery: Romeo's first sight of Juliet is all light: "O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene V” treats love at first sight at the Capulet feast with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “My only love sprung from my only hate” (Act I, Scene V, Juliet (speech 51)): Juliet discovers Romeo is a Montague. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Prologue” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Juliet as light in darkness. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about love at first sight at the Capulet feast? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The lovers' first meeting ties their love to the feud from the start. Useful evidence: “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight” (Act I, Scene V, Romeo (speech 14)): Romeo forgets Rosaline in a line. Theme link: love at first sight, expressed in religious language that makes the kiss a prayer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Romeo compare Juliet to?
   A. A red rose
   B. A song

C. A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches

D. The moon

2. Who recognizes Romeo?

A. Capulet

B. The Nurse

C. Tybalt

D. Paris

3. Why does Capulet stop Tybalt?

A. He is afraid of Romeo

B. He does not want a fight at his feast and Romeo is well spoken of

C. He likes Montagues

D. He wants Juliet to dance

4. What form does the lovers' first conversation take?

A. A riddle

B. A song

C. A sonnet

D. A letter

5. How does Juliet learn Romeo's identity?

A. From her mother

B. From the Nurse

C. From Tybalt

D. From Romeo

6. In the line “Good thou, save me a piece of marchpane; and, as thou lovest me, let the porter let in Susan Grindstone and Nell.”, what does “marchpane” most nearly mean?

A. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

B. deny under oath; take back

C. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

D. going along with a crowd

7. In the line “Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight!”, what does “forswear” most nearly mean?

A. deny under oath; take back

B. going along with a crowd

C. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

D. marzipan, a sweet almond paste

**Answer key:** 1. C (A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches); 2. C (Tybalt); 3. B (He does not want a fight at his feast and Romeo is well spoken of); 4. C (A sonnet); 5. B (From the Nurse); 6. A (marzipan, a sweet almond paste); 7. A (deny under oath; take back)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show love at first sight at the Capulet feast? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act I, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene V suggests about love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of love at first sight at the Capulet feast responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of love at first sight at the Capulet feast follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene V and its treatment of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about love at first sight at the Capulet feast in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of love at first sight at the Capulet feast. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Good pilgrim, you do wrong your hand too much, Which mannerly devotion shows in this; For saints have hands that pilgrims' hands do touch, And palm to palm is holy palmers' kiss.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "palmers" most nearly mean?

   A. a trait of dignified seriousness

   B. a male relative

   C. pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land

   D. lands; domains

2. *O, she doth teach the torches to burn bright! It seems she hangs upon the cheek of night Like a rich jewel in an Ethiope's ear; Beauty too rich for use, for earth too dear! So shows a snowy dove trooping with crows, As yonder lady o'er her fellows shows. The measure done, I'll watch her place of stand, And, touching hers, make blessed my rude hand. Did my heart love till now? forswear it, sight! For I ne'er saw true beauty till this night.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene V"?

   A. The secret wedding

   B. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

   C. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

   D. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

**SAT key:** 1. C (pilgrims who carried a palm leaf from the Holy Land); 2. D (Love at first sight at the Capulet feast)

# Lesson 9: Act II, Prologue

**Focus:** the second Chorus

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus reports that Romeo's old love has died and a new one replaced it; both lovers are bewitched by looks. As enemies they cannot meet freely, but passion gives them the power and time the means.

**Background:** Choruses between acts were less common in English plays than in classical drama; this is the only one between acts in the play.

**Significance:** It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....*
**Prompt:** How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: demesnes — lands; domains; truckle — a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one; consorted — kept company; conjure — call up (a spirit) by a magic spell; falconer — a person who trains and flies hawks.*
**Words:** demesnes: lands; domains · truckle: a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one · consorted: kept company · conjure: call up (a spirit) by a magic spell · falconer: a person who trains and flies hawks

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Choruses between acts were less common in English plays than in classical drama; this is the only one between acts in the play. It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change. Structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Diction / vocabulary: Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet"). Irony: The Chorus notes that Rosaline, once Romeo's all, "is now not fair." Watch for bait and hooks: "love's sweet bait from fearful hooks": love as fishing, sweet but dangerous to the one who takes it.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)). Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. That is structure at work: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead.*

> *Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir* *(Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1))*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)). Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. That is structure at work: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Chorus says both lovers fell for each other's looks, like a spell. Expected link: love and desire: is this love or infatuation? Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: The Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. (Both are bewitched by appearance.)*

> *Alike betwitched by the charm of looks* *(Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1))*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The Chorus says both lovers fell for each other's looks, like a spell. Expected link: love and desire: is this love or infatuation?
**Ask:** How does this line connect to love and desire?
**Expected answer:** The Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. (Both are bewitched by appearance.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for structure, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the second Chorus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Prologue develops the idea of the second Chorus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. When the text says "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)), it shows this directly. "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir," and both lovers are "betwitched by the charm of looks."*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for structure, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the second Chorus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Prologue develops the idea of the second Chorus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. When the text says "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)), it shows this directly. "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir," and both lovers are "betwitched by the charm of looks."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one? Why might this Chorus be cut in many productions? What does keeping it add?*

**Anchor question:** How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?

**Facilitation:** Why might this Chorus be cut in many productions? What does keeping it add?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the second Chorus? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. ("Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir", Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the second Chorus? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. ("Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir", Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes the second Chorus. Key takeaway: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Structure:** A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet").
- **Irony:** The Chorus notes that Rosaline, once Romeo's all, "is now not fair."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **love and desire:** the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **bait and hooks:** "love's sweet bait from fearful hooks": love as fishing, sweet but dangerous to the one who takes it.
- **the deathbed:** Romeo's old love lies dying; the image of a deathbed already joins love and death (death as bridegroom).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)) Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place.
- “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)) Both are bewitched by appearance.
- “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)) Passion overcomes obstacles.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts.
**Evidence:** “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1))
**Reasoning:** "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir," and both lovers are "betwitched by the charm of looks."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | | In context | |
|---|---|---|---|

| | Definition (in this sentence) | | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **demesnes** (noun) | lands; domains | *I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **truckle** (noun) | a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one | *Romeo, good night: I'll to my truckle-bed; This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep: Come, shall we go?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **consorted** (verb) | kept company | *Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conjure** (verb) | call up (a spirit) by a magic spell | *He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not; The ape is dead, and I must conjure him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **falconer** (noun) | a person who trains and flies hawks | *O, for a falconer's voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ripening** (adjective) | bringing to fullness | *This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath, May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **idolatry** (noun) | worship of an idol | *Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I'll believe thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **merchandise** (noun) | goods to be traded; a precious cargo | *I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash'd with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. Who is Romeo's 'old desire'? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Rosaline.
2. What does the Chorus say has died? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Old desire
3. What has bewitched the lovers? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The charm of looks
4. What stops them meeting freely? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: They are enemies by family
5. What gives them power to meet? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Passion
6. Who speaks this passage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Chorus
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Prologue" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Chorus reports that Romeo's old love has died and a new one replaced it; both lovers are bewitched by looks. As enemies they cannot meet freely, but passion gives them the power and time the means.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Prologue", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Prologue" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!" What does "demesnes" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: demesnes: lands; domains.

### Inferential / analytical

1. What tone does the Chorus take toward the lovers? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Sympathetic but slightly ironic about how quickly love shifted.
2. What does "Act II, Prologue" suggest about the second Chorus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about the second Chorus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir" (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. On diction / vocabulary: Balanced antitheses ("old desire" and "young affection"; "extremities" and "extreme sweet"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, And young affection gapes to be his heir; That fair for which love groan’d for and would die, With tender Juliet match’d, is now not fair.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Prologue”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The Chorus reports that Romeo's old love has died and a new one replaced it; both lovers are bewitched by looks. As enemies they cannot meet freely, but passion gives them the power and time the means.
7. How does “Act II, Prologue” build on “Act I, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Both are bewitched by appearance. On structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How fast can someone fall out of love and into a new one?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. On irony: The Chorus notes that Rosaline, once Romeo's all, "is now not fair." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the second Chorus needed? Argue for keeping or cutting it. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An argument about structure and audience guidance.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Both are bewitched by appearance. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “It frames the next act and invites the audience to judge the speed of Romeo's change.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Prologue”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the second Chorus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Both are bewitched by appearance. On structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Prologue”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Both are bewitched by appearance. On structure: A second sonnet-Chorus summarizes the change in Romeo and the obstacles ahead. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Prologue” treats the second Chorus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “But passion lends them power, time means, to meet” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Passion overcomes obstacles. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, / And young affection gapes to be his heir” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Romeo's love for Rosaline dies; a new one takes its place. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the second Chorus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The second Chorus invites the audience to judge how quickly Romeo's affection shifts. Useful evidence: “Alike betwitched by the charm of looks” (Act II, Prologue, Chorus (speech 1)): Both are bewitched by appearance. Theme link: the Chorus questions how fast Romeo's love moved from Rosaline to Juliet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does the Chorus say has died?

   A. Old desire

B. Tybalt

C. Romeo's father

D. The feud

2. What has bewitched the lovers?

A. A potion

B. Letters

C. The charm of looks

D. Music

3. What stops them meeting freely?

A. Juliet is married

B. Romeo is banished

C. The plague

D. They are enemies by family

4. What gives them power to meet?

A. The Prince

B. Mercutio

C. Money

D. Passion

5. Who speaks this passage?

A. Friar Laurence

B. The Chorus

C. Romeo

D. The Prince

6. In the line "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!", what does "demesnes" most nearly mean?

A. kept company

B. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

C. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

D. lands; domains

7. In the line "Romeo, good night: I'll to my truckle-bed; This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep: Come, shall we go?", what does "truckle" most nearly mean?

A. kept company

B. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

C. lands; domains

D. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

**Answer key:** 1. A (Old desire); 2. C (The charm of looks); 3. D (They are enemies by family); 4. D (Passion); 5. B (The Chorus); 6. D (lands; domains); 7. B (a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Prologue,” how does Shakespeare show the second Chorus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Prologue, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the second Chorus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Prologue develops the idea of the second Chorus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Prologue (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the second Chorus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Prologue suggests about the second Chorus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act II, Prologue to complicate the reader's understanding of the second Chorus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Prologue within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the second Chorus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Prologue alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the second Chorus follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Prologue and its treatment of the second Chorus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Prologue as evidence for a larger claim about the second Chorus in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Prologue as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the second Chorus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “consorted” most nearly mean?

   A. kept company

   B. bringing to fullness

   C. worship of an idol

   D. goods to be traded; a precious cargo

2. *Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie, And young affection gapes to be his heir; That fair for which love groan’d for and would die, With tender Juliet match’d, is now not fair. Now Romeo is beloved and loves again, Alike betwitched by the charm of looks, But to his foe supposed he must complain, And she steal love’s sweet bait from fearful hooks: Being held a foe, he may not have access To breathe such vows as lovers use to swear; And she as much in love, her means much less To meet her new-beloved any where: But passion lends them power, time means, to meet, Tempering extremities with extreme sweet. Exit.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Prologue”?

   A. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

   B. The tomb

   C. The second Chorus

   D. Juliet's feigned obedience

**SAT key:** 1. A (kept company); 2. C (The second Chorus)

# Lesson 10: Act II, Scene I

**Focus:** Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

Teacher only · spoilers

After the feast Romeo hides in the Capulet orchard. Mercutio and Benvolio call for him; Mercutio mockingly conjures him by Rosaline's body parts. Benvolio says love is blind; they go home.

**Background:** Mercutio's bawdy jokes were part of Elizabethan comedy and appealed to all parts of the audience.

**Significance:** The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....*
**Prompt:** How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: demesnes — lands; domains; truckle — a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one; consorted — kept company; conjure — call up (a spirit) by a magic spell; falconer — a person who trains and flies hawks.*
**Words:** demesnes: lands; domains · truckle: a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one · consorted: kept company · conjure: call up (a spirit) by a magic spell · falconer: a person who trains and flies hawks

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Mercutio's bawdy jokes were part of Elizabethan comedy and appealed to all parts of the audience. The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene. Characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Irony: Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters. Diction / vocabulary: "He jests at scars that never felt a wound" (the first line of the next scene) answers Mercutio's mockery. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "himself among these trees, / To be consorted with the humorous night: / Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes" (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)). Mercutio's mock spell. That is characterization at work: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness.*

> *I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes* (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes" (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)). Mercutio's mock spell. That is characterization at work: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Mercutio mocks love as blind and fit for darkness; ironically, Romeo's real love will live in the dark. Expected link: love and desire. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. (Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.)*

> *Blind is his love and best befits the dark* (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Mercutio mocks love as blind and fit for darkness; ironically, Romeo's real love will live in the dark. Expected link: love and desire.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to love and desire?
**Expected answer:** Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. (Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. When the text says "Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)), it shows this directly. He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. When the text says "Blind is his love and best befits the dark" (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)), it shows this directly. He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why? Ask: is Mercutio a good friend to Romeo? What does he understand, and what does he miss?*

**Anchor question:** How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?

**Facilitation:** Ask: is Mercutio a good friend to Romeo? What does he understand, and what does he miss?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. ("Blind is his love and best befits the dark", Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. ("Blind is his love and best befits the dark", Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Key takeaway: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness.
- **Irony:** Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "He jests at scars that never felt a wound" (the first line of the next scene) answers Mercutio's mockery.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **love and desire:** Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “himself among these trees, / To be consorted with the humorous night: / Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)).
- **names and identity:** Names carry the feud ("Montague," "Capulet"); Juliet wishes a name were only a word. In this scene: “my invocation / Is fair and honest, and in his mistress’ name / I conjure only but to raise up him” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 7)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)) Mercutio's mock spell.
- “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)) Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night.
- “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 9)) Mercutio gives up and goes home.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge.
**Evidence:** “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8))
**Reasoning:** He conjures Romeo "by Rosaline's bright eyes" and jokes that "Blind is his love and best befits the dark," not knowing Romeo has already left Rosaline behind.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **demesnes** (noun) | lands; domains | *I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **truckle** (noun) | a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one | *Romeo, good night: I'll to my truckle-bed; This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep: Come, shall we go?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **consorted** (verb) | kept company | *Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conjure** (verb) | call up (a spirit) by a magic spell | *He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not; The ape is dead, and I must conjure him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **falconer** (noun) | a person who trains and flies hawks | *O, for a falconer's voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ripening** (adjective) | bringing to fullness | *This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath, May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **idolatry** (noun) | worship of an idol | *Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I'll believe thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **merchandise** (noun) | goods to be traded; a precious cargo | *I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash'd with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. Why can't Mercutio find Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo has leaped the orchard wall to be near Juliet.
2. Where does Romeo hide? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: In the Capulet orchard
3. Whose name does Mercutio use to conjure Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Rosaline's
4. What does Mercutio say about love? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: It is blind
5. Who goes home with Mercutio? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Benvolio
6. What tone does Mercutio's speech have? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Mocking and bawdy
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act II, Scene I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: After the feast Romeo hides in the Capulet orchard. Mercutio and Benvolio call for him; Mercutio mockingly conjures him by Rosaline's body parts. Benvolio says love is blind; they go home.
8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!” What does “demesnes” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: demesnes: lands; domains.

### Inferential / analytical

1. What does the irony of Mercutio invoking Rosaline reveal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: His friends don't know Romeo has changed; Romeo now hides his life from them.
2. What does “Act II, Scene I” suggest about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)): Mercutio's mock spell. On irony: Mercutio calls for Romeo by Rosaline's name, not knowing she no longer matters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Nay, I’ll conjure too.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: After the feast Romeo hides in the Capulet orchard. Mercutio and Benvolio call for him; Mercutio mockingly conjures him by Rosaline's body parts. Benvolio says love is blind; they go home.
7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act II, Prologue”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 9)): Mercutio gives up and goes home. On characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do friends react when someone falls in love? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)): Mercutio's mock spell. On diction / vocabulary: "He jests at scars that never felt a wound" (the first line of the next scene) answers Mercutio's mockery. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Mercutio's mockery cruel or affectionate? Support your view. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An argument using his tone and Benvolio's response.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The scene contrasts friends' cynical view of love with the devotion that follows in the balcony scene.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one

counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 9)): Mercutio gives up and goes home. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)): Mercutio's mock spell. On characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 9)): Mercutio gives up and goes home. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)): Mercutio's mock spell. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I,

Benvolio (speech 8)): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. On characterization: Mercutio's bawdy conjuring of Rosaline contrasts with Romeo's new seriousness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 9)): Mercutio gives up and goes home. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes” (Act II, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 5)): Mercutio's mock spell. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Mercutio's mockery shows that Romeo's friends see love as a joke or a bodily urge. Useful evidence: “Blind is his love and best befits the dark” (Act II, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 8)): Mercutio's joke: love is blind, so it suits the night. Theme link: Mercutio reduces love to the body; the next scene will lift it to the stars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where does Romeo hide?
   A. In Mantua
   B. In the Capulet orchard
   C. At home
   D. In church
2. Whose name does Mercutio use to conjure Romeo?
   A. Juliet's

B. Tybalt's

C. The Nurse's

D. Rosaline's

3. What does Mercutio say about love?

A. It is blind

B. It is eternal

C. It is holy

D. It is dangerous

4. Who goes home with Mercutio?

A. Balthasar

B. Benvolio

C. Tybalt

D. Paris

5. What tone does Mercutio's speech have?

A. Fearful

B. Grieving

C. Formal

D. Mocking and bawdy

6. In the line “I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!”, what does “demesnes” most nearly mean?

A. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

B. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

C. lands; domains

D. kept company

7. In the line “Romeo, good night: I’ll to my truckle-bed; This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep: Come, shall we go?”, what does “truckle” most nearly mean?

A. kept company

B. a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one

C. call up (a spirit) by a magic spell

D. lands; domains

**Answer key:** 1. B (In the Capulet orchard); 2. D (Rosaline's); 3. A (It is blind); 4. B (Benvolio); 5. D (Mocking and bawdy); 6. C (lands; domains); 7. B (a low bed on wheels kept under a larger one)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? Write a

paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Come, he hath hid himself among these trees, To be consorted with the humorous night: Blind is his love and best befits the dark.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “consorted” most nearly mean?

   A. goods to be traded; a precious cargo

   B. bringing to fullness

   C. kept company

   D. worship of an idol

2. *Nay, I’ll conjure too. Romeo! humours! madman! passion! lover! Appear thou in the likeness of a sigh: Speak but one rhyme, and I am satisfied; Cry but “Ay me!” pronounce but “love” and “dove;” Speak to my gossip Venus one fair word, One nick-name for her purblind son and heir, Young Adam Cupid, he that shot so trim, When King Cophetua loved the beggar-maid! He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not; The ape is dead, and I must conjure him. I conjure thee by Rosaline’s bright eyes, By her high forehead and her scarlet lip, By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh And the demesnes that there adjacent lie, That in thy likeness thou appear to us!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene I”?

   A. The household mourns

   B. The divided world of Verona

   C. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

   D. Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard

**SAT key:** 1. C (kept company); 2. D (Mercutio's mockery outside the orchard)

# Lesson 11: Act II, Scene II

**Focus:** the balcony scene

Teacher only · spoilers

From the orchard Romeo sees Juliet at her window and calls her the sun. Unaware of him, she wishes he were not a Montague. He speaks; she fears for his life, worries he will think her too forward, and asks him not to swear by the inconstant moon. They exchange vows; Juliet proposes he send word tomorrow of when and where they will marry.

**Background:** Elizabethan noble daughters had little freedom; a secret engagement without parental consent was serious but could be binding. Falconry gave Juliet her image of calling back a tassel-gentle.

**Significance:** The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....*
> **Prompt:** What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: falconer — a person who trains and flies hawks; ripening — bringing to fullness; idolatry — worship of an idol; merchandise — goods to be traded; a precious cargo; ghostly — resembling or characteristic of a phantom.*
>
> **Words:** falconer: a person who trains and flies hawks · ripening: bringing to fullness · idolatry: worship of an idol · merchandise: goods to be traded; a precious cargo · ghostly: resembling or characteristic of a phantom

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Elizabethan noble daughters had little freedom; a secret engagement without parental consent was serious but could be binding. Falconry gave Juliet her image of calling back a tassel-gentle. The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture. Imagery: Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract. Characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Symbolism: The name "Montague" stands for the feud; Juliet argues a name is only a word. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "wound. Juliet appears above at a window. / But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)). Juliet as the sun. That is imagery at work: Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract.*

> *But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun* (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)). Juliet as the sun. That is imagery at work: Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet means a rose's scent does not depend on its name, so Romeo would be the same without "Montague." Expected link: names and identity. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: The lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. (Names do not change essence.)*

> *What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet* (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Juliet means a rose's scent does not depend on its name, so Romeo would be the same without "Montague." Expected link: names and identity.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to love and desire?
**Expected answer:** The lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. (Names do not change essence.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the balcony scene. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. When the text says "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)), it shows this directly. She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the balcony scene. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. When the text says "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)), it shows this directly. She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening? Ask: who leads in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Use two lines for each side.*

**Anchor question:** What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?

**Facilitation:** Ask: who leads in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Use two lines for each side.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. ("What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet", Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the balcony scene? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. ("What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet", Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes the balcony scene. Key takeaway: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Imagery:** Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract.
- **Characterization:** Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage.
- **Symbolism:** The name "Montague" stands for the feud; Juliet argues a name is only a word.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **love and desire:** the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “wound. Juliet appears above at a window. / But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “tis not to me she speaks: / Two of the fairest stars in all the heaven, / Having some business, do entreat her eyes” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)) Juliet as the sun.
- “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)) Names do not change essence.
- “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 26)) Juliet's warning about haste.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene.
**Evidence:** “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6))

**Reasoning:** She sees that their vow "is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning," and she reasons that "that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet," while Romeo speaks in raptures.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **falconer** (noun) | a person who trains and flies hawks | *O, for a falconer's voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ripening** (adjective) | bringing to fullness | *This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath, May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **idolatry** (noun) | worship of an idol | *Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I'll believe thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **merchandise** (noun) | goods to be traded; a precious cargo | *I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash'd with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *Hence will I to my ghostly father's cell, His help to crave, and my dear hap to tell.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entreat** (verb) | ask earnestly | *I am too bold, 'tis not to me she speaks: Two of the fairest stars in all the heaven, Having some business, do entreat her eyes To twinkle in their spheres till they return.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | beg; ask earnestly | *I come, anon.—But if thou mean'st not well, I do beseech thee—* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **predominant** (adjective) | dominant; ruling (an astrological term) | *Two such opposed kings encamp them still In man as well as herbs, grace and rude will; And where the worser is predominant, Full soon the canker death eats up that plant.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

## *Discussion questions*

1. What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

## *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. At what hour does Juliet say she will send to Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: By nine o'clock in the morning.
2. What does Romeo call Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The sun
3. What does Juliet wish? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: That Romeo had a different name
4. Why does Juliet tell Romeo not to swear by the moon? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: It is inconstant
5. Who first speaks of marriage? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Juliet
6. What does Juliet fear about the vow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: It is too rash and sudden
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: From the orchard Romeo sees Juliet at her window and calls her the sun. Unaware of him, she wishes he were not a Montague. He speaks; she fears for his life, worries he will think her too forward, and asks him not to swear by the inconstant moon. They exchange vows; Juliet proposes he send word tomorrow of when and where they will marry.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "O, for a falconer's voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!" What does "falconer" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: falconer: a person who trains and flies hawks.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Juliet say a rose would smell as sweet by any other name? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Names are labels; Romeo is himself apart from 'Montague'.
2. What does "Act II, Scene II" suggest about the balcony scene? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the balcony scene? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is

the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)): Juliet as the sun. On characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins "By love, who first did prompt me to inquire; He lent me counsel and I lent him eyes.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act II, Scene II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: From the orchard Romeo sees Juliet at her window and calls her the sun. Unaware of him, she wishes he were not a Montague. He speaks; she fears for his life, worries he will think her too forward, and asks him not to swear by the inconstant moon. They exchange vows; Juliet proposes he send word…
7. How does "Act II, Scene II" build on "Act II, Scene I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's warning about haste. On characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "What does it mean to really know someone? Can you know someone after one evening?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun" (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)): Juliet as the sun. On symbolism: The name "Montague" stands for the feud; Juliet argues a name is only a word. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Who is wiser in this scene, Romeo or Juliet? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A reasoned comparison of their lines.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet" (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from

secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The scene sets the lovers' language of light and their speed; Juliet's practicality balances Romeo's rapture.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's warning about haste. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)): Juliet as the sun. On characterization: Juliet is the practical one: she asks how Romeo got in, warns him of danger and proposes marriage. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the balcony scene. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's warning about haste. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)): Juliet as the sun. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)): Names do not change essence. On imagery: Light imagery: Juliet is the sun, her eyes stars; she fears the "lightning" speed of their contract. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene II” treats the balcony scene with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden; / Too like the lightning” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 26)): Juliet's warning about haste. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks? / It is the east, and Juliet is the sun” (Act II, Scene II, Romeo (speech 1)): Juliet as the sun. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the balcony scene? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet is the more clear-sighted lover in the balcony scene. Useful evidence: “What’s in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet” (Act II, Scene II, Juliet (speech 6)): Names do not change essence. Theme link: the lovers move from secret confession to a marriage plan in one night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Romeo call Juliet?

   A. A rose

   B. The moon

C. The sun

D. A star

2. What does Juliet wish?

A. That she were a man

B. That Romeo had a different name

C. That the feud would grow

D. That Paris would come

3. Why does Juliet tell Romeo not to swear by the moon?

A. It is pagan

B. It is too far

C. It is inconstant

D. It is cold

4. Who first speaks of marriage?

A. Friar Laurence

B. Juliet

C. The Nurse

D. Romeo

5. What does Juliet fear about the vow?

A. It is dishonest

B. It is too slow

C. It is too rash and sudden

D. It is a joke

6. In the line "O, for a falconer's voice, To lure this tassel-gentle back again!", what does "falconer" most nearly mean?

A. a person who trains and flies hawks

B. worship of an idol

C. bringing to fullness

D. goods to be traded; a precious cargo

7. In the line "This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath, May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.", what does "ripening" most nearly mean?

A. bringing to fullness

B. a person who trains and flies hawks

C. goods to be traded; a precious cargo

D. worship of an idol

**Answer key:** 1. C (The sun); 2. B (That Romeo had a different name); 3. C (It is inconstant); 4. B (Juliet); 5. C (It is too rash and sudden); 6. A (a person who trains and flies hawks); 7. A (bringing to fullness)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the balcony scene? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the balcony scene? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the balcony scene. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the balcony scene. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about the balcony scene. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the balcony scene. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the balcony scene responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the balcony scene follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of the balcony scene. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the balcony scene in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the balcony scene. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Do not swear at all; Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self, Which is the god of my idolatry, And I'll believe thee.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "idolatry" most nearly mean?

   A. dominant; ruling (an astrological term)

   B. ask earnestly

   C. beg; ask earnestly

   D. worship of an idol

2. *By love, who first did prompt me to inquire; He lent me counsel and I lent him eyes. I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far As that vast shore wash'd with the farthest sea, I would adventure for such merchandise.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

   A. Juliet's feigned obedience

   B. Juliet hears the news

   C. Wedding preparations

   D. The balcony scene

**SAT key:** 1. D (worship of an idol); 2. D (The balcony scene)

## Lesson 12: Act II, Scene III

**Focus:** Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

Teacher only · spoilers

At dawn Friar Laurence gathers herbs and reflects that every plant can heal or poison. Romeo arrives and asks him to marry him to Juliet. The Friar scolds his fickleness about Rosaline but agrees, hoping the marriage will end the feud.

**Background:** Friars were members of mendicant religious orders; Franciscans were known for herb lore and practical care. Secret marriages were legal but irregular in canon law.

**Significance:** The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is it right to do something risky for a good cause? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....*
> **Prompt:** Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: predominant — dominant; ruling (an astrological term); stumble — trip; make a mistake; alliance — a union, here by marriage; households — families, including their servants and dependents; ghostly — resembling or characteristic of a phantom.*
> **Words:** predominant: dominant; ruling (an astrological term) · stumble: trip; make a mistake · alliance: a union, here by marriage · households: families, including their servants and dependents · ghostly: resembling or characteristic of a phantom

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Friars were members of mendicant religious orders; Franciscans were known for herb lore and practical care. Secret marriages were legal but irregular in canon law. The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help. Characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Foreshadowing: His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion. Irony: He scolds Romeo's fickleness yet agrees to marry him, hoping to end the feud. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "The grey-eyed morn smiles on the frowning night, / Chequering the eastern clouds with streaks of light, / And flecked darkness" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)). The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. That is characterization at work: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use.*

> *young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes* (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)). The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. That is characterization at work: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A small flower contains both poison and medicine; good and harm come from how something is used. Expected link: poison and medicine, and the Friar's role. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: The Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. (One thing can heal or kill.)*

> *Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power* (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** A small flower contains both poison and medicine; good and harm come from how something is used. Expected link: poison and medicine, and the Friar's role.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to time and haste?
**Expected answer:** The Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. (One thing can heal or kill.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. When the text says "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)), it shows this directly. He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. When the text says "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)), it shows this directly. He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Is it right to do something risky for a good cause? Ask: is the Friar wise or reckless? Is his reason for marrying them a good one?*
**Anchor question:** Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is the Friar wise or reckless? Is his reason for marrying them a good one?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. ("Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast", Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. ("Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast", Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Key takeaway: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use.
- **Foreshadowing:** His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion.
- **Irony:** He scolds Romeo's fickleness yet agrees to marry him, hoping to end the feud.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **time and haste:** the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “The grey-eyed morn smiles on the frowning night, / Chequering the eastern clouds with streaks of light, / And flecked darkness” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “doth not taste! / The sun not yet thy sighs from heaven clears, / Thy old groans ring yet in my ancient ears; / Lo” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)) One thing can heal or kill.
- “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)) The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love.
- “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)) The Friar's warning about haste.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons.
**Evidence:** “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19))

**Reasoning:** He warns "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" and mocks love that lies "in their eyes," yet agrees to the marriage hoping it will turn the households' "rancour to pure love."

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **predominant** (adjective) | dominant; ruling (an astrological term) | *Two such opposed kings encamp them still In man as well as herbs, grace and rude will; And where the worser is predominant, Full soon the canker death eats up that plant.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **stumble** (verb) | trip; make a mistake | *Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **alliance** (noun) | a union, here by marriage | *But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I'll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households' rancour to pure love.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **households** (noun) | families, including their servants and dependents | *But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I'll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households' rancour to pure love.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *With Rosaline, my ghostly father? no; I have forgot that name, and that name's woe.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **constrains** (verb) | forces | *That's as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **rosemary** (noun) | an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals | *Doth not rosemary and Romeo begin both with a letter?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **prating** (adjective) | chattering | *Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when 'twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very toad, as see him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Where has Romeo been all night? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Not in bed; he has been feasting with his enemy, the Capulets.
2. What is the Friar gathering? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Herbs and flowers
3. What does the Friar say plants contain? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Both poison and medicine
4. Why is the Friar surprised? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo has forgotten Rosaline so quickly
5. Why does the Friar agree to help? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: He hopes to end the feud
6. What does he warn about speed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: They stumble that run fast
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At dawn Friar Laurence gathers herbs and reflects that every plant can heal or poison. Romeo arrives and asks him to marry him to Juliet. The Friar scolds his fickleness about Rosaline but agrees, hoping the marriage will end the feud.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Two such opposed kings encamp them still In man as well as herbs, grace and rude will; And where the worser is predominant, Full soon the canker death eats up that plant." What does "predominant" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: predominant: dominant; ruling (an astrological term).

#### Inferential / analytical

1. How does the Friar's speech on herbs relate to the plot? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: One thing can heal or kill; love and the potion will do both.
2. What does "Act II, Scene III" suggest about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)): One thing can heal or kill. On foreshadowing: His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “O, she knew well Thy love did read by rote and could not spell.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: At dawn Friar Laurence gathers herbs and reflects that every plant can heal or poison. Romeo arrives and asks him to marry him to Juliet. The Friar scolds his fickleness about Rosaline but agrees, hoping the marriage will end the feud.
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)): The Friar's warning about haste. On characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it right to do something risky for a good cause?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison

hath residence and medicine power" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)): One thing can heal or kill. On irony: He scolds Romeo's fickleness yet agrees to marry him, hoping to end the feud. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the Friar's reason for agreeing good judgment or gamble? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment weighing peace against risk.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The Friar's speech on plants foreshadows the potion; his political hope explains his risky help." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)): The Friar's warning about haste. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)): One thing can heal or kill. On characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act II, Scene III". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: "young men's love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes" (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)): The Friar's warning about haste. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)): One thing can heal or kill. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. On characterization: Friar Laurence, gathering herbs, reflects that everything can heal or harm depending on use. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats Friar Laurence agrees to marry them with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 19)): The Friar's warning about haste. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “Within the infant rind of this small flower / Poison hath residence and medicine power” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 1)): One thing can heal or kill. On foreshadowing: His knowledge of plants ("Poison hath residence and medicine power") prepares the potion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Friar Laurence sees the danger of haste but helps the lovers anyway, for political reasons. Useful evidence: “young men’s love then lies / Not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes” (Act II, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 11)): The Friar's doubt about Romeo's love. Theme link: the Friar warns "they stumble that run fast" and then acts quickly himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What is the Friar gathering?
    A. Letters
    B. Firewood
    C. Money
    D. Herbs and flowers
2. What does the Friar say plants contain?
    A. Both poison and medicine
    B. Prophecies
    C. Only food
    D. Only beauty
3. Why is the Friar surprised?
    A. Romeo is drunk
    B. Romeo is up early
    C. Romeo has forgotten Rosaline so quickly
    D. Romeo is wounded
4. Why does the Friar agree to help?
    A. The Prince orders it
    B. Juliet threatens him
    C. He hopes to end the feud
    D. He is paid
5. What does he warn about speed?
    A. Haste makes money
    B. They stumble that run fast

C. Time heals all

D. Slow lovers lose

6. In the line “Two such opposed kings encamp them still In man as well as herbs, grace and rude will; And where the worser is predominant, Full soon the canker death eats up that plant.”, what does “predominant” most nearly mean?

A. trip; make a mistake

B. families, including their servants and dependents

C. dominant; ruling (an astrological term)

D. a union, here by marriage

7. In the line “Wisely and slow; they stumble that run fast.”, what does “stumble” most nearly mean?

A. a union, here by marriage

B. families, including their servants and dependents

C. dominant; ruling (an astrological term)

D. trip; make a mistake

**Answer key:** 1. D (Herbs and flowers); 2. A (Both poison and medicine); 3. C (Romeo has forgotten Rosaline so quickly); 4. C (He hopes to end the feud); 5. B (They stumble that run fast); 6. C (dominant; ruling (an astrological term)); 7. D (trip; make a mistake)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Lay out two plausible

interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Friar Laurence agrees to marry them in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Friar Laurence agrees to marry them. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I'll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households' rancour to pure love.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "alliance" most nearly mean?

   A. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals

   B. forces

   C. chattering

   D. a union, here by marriage

2. *O, she knew well Thy love did read by rote and could not spell. But come, young waverer, come, go with me, In one respect I'll thy assistant be; For this alliance may so happy prove, To turn your households' rancour to pure love.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

A. The divided world of Verona

B. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

C. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

D. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

**SAT key:** 1. D (a union, here by marriage); 2. B (Friar Laurence agrees to marry them)

# Lesson 13: Act II, Scene IV

**Focus:** wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

Teacher only · spoilers

Benvolio and Mercutio learn that Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; Mercutio mocks Tybalt's fencing. Romeo joins them and wins a battle of puns. The Nurse arrives, is mocked by Mercutio, and receives Romeo's message: Juliet should come to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.

**Background:** Fencing manuals from Italy and Spain introduced strict rules (passado, punto reverso); Mercutio mocks their fashionable vocabulary. Shrift (confession) gave young women a respectable reason to visit a friar.

**Significance:** The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How can humor hide tension? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because....*
**Prompt:** How can humor hide tension?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: constrains — forces; rosemary — an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals; prating — chattering; lisping — speaking affectedly; commend — send greetings; recommend.*
**Words:** constrains: forces · rosemary: an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals · prating: chattering · lisping: speaking affectedly · commend: send greetings; recommend

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Fencing manuals from Italy and Spain introduced strict rules (passado, punto reverso); Mercutio mocks their fashionable vocabulary. Shrift (confession) gave young women a respectable reason to visit a friar. The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline. Characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Diction / vocabulary: The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes. Plot: Romeo tells the Nurse to bring Juliet to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "your French slop. You gave us the counterfeit fairly last night" (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 15)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)). Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. That is characterization at work: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns.*

> *Why, is not this better now than groaning for love* (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)). Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. That is characterization at work: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Tybalt shares his name with the cat in old fables, so Mercutio calls him "prince of cats." Expected link: violence and the feud: the joke is about a man with a sword. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. (Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).)*

> *More than prince of cats, I can tell you* (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Tybalt shares his name with the cat in old fables, so Mercutio calls him "prince of cats." Expected link: violence and the feud: the joke is about a man with a sword.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
**Expected answer:** Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. (Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. When the text says "Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon" (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)), it shows this directly. Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. When the text says "Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon" (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)), it shows this directly. Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How can humor hide tension? Ask: how does the Nurse handle Mercutio's insults? What does this show about class and gender in Verona?*
**Anchor question:** How can humor hide tension?
**Facilitation:** Ask: how does the Nurse handle Mercutio's insults? What does this show about class and gender in Verona?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. ("Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon", Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. ("Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon", Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Key takeaway: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** The scene is a contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes.
- **Plot:** Romeo tells the Nurse to bring Juliet to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **violence and the feud:** Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “your French slop. You gave us the counterfeit fairly last night” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 15)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Now God in heaven bless thee! Hark you, sir” (Act II, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 82)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11)) Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables).
- “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)) Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again.
- “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)) Romeo sets the wedding plan.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it.
**Evidence:** “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77))
**Reasoning:** Mercutio's mockery of Tybalt as "prince of cats" follows news of Tybalt's challenge, and Romeo plans the marriage ("Some means to come to shrift this afternoon") without knowing the challenge waits for him.

### Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **constrains** (verb) | forces | *That's as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **rosemary** (noun) | an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals | *Doth not rosemary and Romeo begin both with a letter?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **prating** (adjective) | chattering | *Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when 'twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very toad, as see him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **lisping** (adjective) | speaking affectedly | *The pox of such antic, lisping, affecting fantasticoes; these new tuners of accents!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **commend** (verb) | send greetings; recommend | *Nurse, commend me to thy lady and mistress.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **gentlewoman** (noun) | a woman of good family and manners | *God ye good den, fair gentlewoman.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **nobleman** (noun) | a man of noble rank | *Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when 'twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very toad, as see him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *Tybalt, the kinsman of old Capulet, Hath sent a letter to his father's house.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### Discussion questions

1. How can humor hide tension?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

### Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23,

24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What will Romeo's man bring the Nurse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A rope ladder so Romeo can climb to Juliet that night.
2. What has Tybalt sent Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A challenge
3. What does Mercutio call Tybalt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Prince of cats
4. Who carries Juliet's message? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Nurse
5. Where are Romeo and Juliet to marry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At Friar Laurence's cell
6. When are they to marry? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: That afternoon
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Benvolio and Mercutio learn that Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; Mercutio mocks Tybalt's fencing. Romeo joins them and wins a battle of puns. The Nurse arrives, is mocked by Mercutio, and receives Romeo's message: Juliet should come to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "That's as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams." What does "constrains" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: constrains: forces.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Mercutio pleased with Romeo in this scene? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Romeo is sociable and witty again, not groaning for love.
2. What does "Act II, Scene IV" suggest about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: "More than prince of cats, I can tell you" (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11)): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). On diction / vocabulary: The scene is a

contest of wit; Romeo is himself again, "sociable" in his friends' eyes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “The pox of such antic, lisping, affecting fantasticoes; these new tuners of accents!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Benvolio and Mercutio learn that Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; Mercutio mocks Tybalt's fencing. Romeo joins them and wins a battle of puns. The Nurse arrives, is mocked by Mercutio, and receives Romeo's message: Juliet should come to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married.
7. How does “Act II, Scene IV” build on “Act II, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)): Romeo sets the wedding plan. On characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can humor hide tension?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11)): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). On plot: Romeo tells the Nurse to bring Juliet to Friar Laurence's cell that afternoon to be married. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. How does the Nurse's behavior in this scene complicate her role as Juliet's protector? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Her bawdy delight and warnings to Romeo show both care and foolishness.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the

comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The comic surface hides the challenge that will lead to deaths; the marriage plan fixes the timeline.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)): Romeo sets the wedding plan. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11)): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). On characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)): Romeo sets the wedding plan. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11)): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a

challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. On characterization: Mercutio mocks Tybalt as "prince of cats" and a master of duelling rules; he and Romeo trade puns. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Bid her devise / Some means to come to shrift this afternoon” (Act II, Scene IV, Romeo (speech 77)): Romeo sets the wedding plan. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “More than prince of cats, I can tell you” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 11)): Mercutio's nickname for Tybalt (Tybalt is a cat's name in fables). Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene's comedy hides the threat that will end it. Useful evidence: “Why, is not this better now than groaning for love” (Act II, Scene IV, Mercutio (speech 39)): Mercutio is pleased Romeo is witty again. Theme link: Tybalt has sent Romeo a challenge; the comedy is shadowed by the coming duel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What has Tybalt sent Romeo?
   A. A challenge
   B. A gift
   C. An apology
   D. A warning from the Prince
2. What does Mercutio call Tybalt?
   A. Prince of cats
   B. Lord of swords
   C. A rat
   D. King of dogs
3. Who carries Juliet's message?
   A. Friar John
   B. Peter only
   C. Balthasar
   D. The Nurse
4. Where are Romeo and Juliet to marry?
   A. At Friar Laurence's cell
   B. At the Capulet house
   C. At St. Peter's Church
   D. In Mantua
5. When are they to marry?
   A. Next week
   B. That afternoon
   C. At midnight
   D. Thursday
6. In the line “That’s as much as to say, such a case as yours constrains a man to bow in the hams.”, what does “constrains” most nearly mean?
   A. chattering
   B. speaking affectedly
   C. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals
   D. forces
7. In the line “Doth not rosemary and Romeo begin both with a letter?”, what does “rosemary” most nearly mean?
   A. speaking affectedly
   B. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals
   C. chattering
   D. forces

**Answer key:** 1. A (A challenge); 2. A (Prince of cats); 3. D (The Nurse); 4. A (At Friar Laurence's cell); 5. B (That afternoon); 6. D (forces); 7. B (an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Well, sir; my mistress is the sweetest lady—Lord, Lord! when 'twas a little prating thing:—O, there is a nobleman in town, one Paris, that would fain lay knife aboard; but she, good soul, had as lief see a toad, a very toad, as see him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "prating" most nearly mean?

   A. a woman of good family and manners

   B. a man of noble rank

   C. a male relative

   D. chattering

2. *The pox of such antic, lisping, affecting fantasticoes; these new tuners of accents! "By Jesu, a very good blade! a very tall man! a very good whore!" Why, is not this a lamentable thing, grandsire, that we should be thus afflicted with these strange flies, these fashion-mongers, these perdona-mi's, who stand so much on the new form, that they cannot sit at ease on the old bench? O, their bones, their bones!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

   A. The divided world of Verona

   B. The household mourns

   C. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

   D. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

**SAT key:** 1. D (chattering); 2. D (Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan)

# Lesson 14: Act II, Scene V

**Focus:** Juliet waits for the Nurse

Teacher only · spoilers

Juliet waits impatiently for the Nurse, who left at nine and returns at noon. The Nurse delays, complaining of aches, before telling her to go to Friar Laurence's cell, where a husband waits.

**Background:** Hours were marked by church bells; Juliet's counting of hours shows how slowly time moves for her.

**Significance:** Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What is waiting for important news like? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....*
**Prompt:** What is waiting for important news like?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: louring — dark and threatening; poultice — a soft dressing applied to soothe pain; heralds — messengers who announce news; circumstance — details; the full particulars; bestride — stand or walk astride.*
**Words:** louring: dark and threatening · poultice: a soft dressing applied to soothe pain · heralds: messengers who announce news · circumstance: details; the full particulars · bestride: stand or walk astride

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Hours were marked by church bells; Juliet's counting of hours shows how slowly time moves for her. Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency. Characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Structure: The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Imagery: Juliet wishes love's heralds were thoughts that "glide than the sun's beams." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, / Driving back shadows over louring hills: / Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves" (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)). Love wants instant messages. That is characterization at work: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching.*

> *love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams* (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)). Love wants instant messages. That is characterization at work: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Heralds are messengers; Juliet wants news to move as fast as thought. Expected link: time and haste. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). (Juliet's impatience.)*

> *Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that* (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Heralds are messengers; Juliet wants news to move as fast as thought. Expected link: time and haste.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to time and haste?
**Expected answer:** Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). (Juliet's impatience.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene V develops the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. When the text says “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)), it shows this directly. She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene V develops the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. When the text says “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)), it shows this directly. She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What is waiting for important news like? Ask: why does the Nurse delay? Is it teasing, tiredness or something else?*
**Anchor question:** What is waiting for important news like?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does the Nurse delay? Is it teasing, tiredness or something else?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. (“Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that”, Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. (“Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that”, Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Juliet waits for the Nurse. Key takeaway: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching.
- **Structure:** The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense.
- **Imagery:** Juliet wishes love's heralds were thoughts that "glide than the sun's beams."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **time and haste:** Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours").

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams, / Driving back shadows over louring hills: / Therefore do nimble-pinion’d doves” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Hie to high fortune! Honest nurse, farewell. Exeunt” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 19)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)) Love wants instant messages.
- “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)) Juliet's impatience.
- “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse (speech 18)) The Nurse delivers the news.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow.
**Evidence:** “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7))
**Reasoning:** She wishes "Love's heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams" and demands "Is thy news good, or bad?"

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **louring** (adjective) | dark and threatening | *O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **poultice** (noun) | a soft dressing applied to soothe pain | *Are you so hot? marry, come up, I trow; Is this the poultice for my aching bones?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **heralds** (noun) | messengers who announce news | *O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **circumstance** (noun) | details; the full particulars | *Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that; Say either, and I'll stay the circumstance: Let me be satisfied, is't good or bad?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bestride** (verb) | stand or walk astride | *Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **gossamer** (noun) | fine spider threads floating in the air | *Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ornament** (noun) | decoration | *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **substance** (noun) | real worth; wealth | *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What is waiting for important news like?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23,

24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. When did Juliet send the Nurse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At nine o'clock.
2. How long has the Nurse been away? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Three hours
3. What does the Nurse complain about? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Her aching bones and back
4. Where must Juliet go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Friar Laurence's cell
5. What does Juliet wish love's heralds were? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Thoughts
6. How does the Nurse finally deliver the news? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: She tells Juliet a husband waits at the Friar's cell
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act II, Scene V” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Juliet waits impatiently for the Nurse, who left at nine and returns at noon. The Nurse delays, complaining of aches, before telling her to go to Friar Laurence's cell, where a husband waits.
8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene V”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “O, she is lame! love’s heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion’d doves draw love, And therefore hath the…” What does “louring” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: louring: dark and threatening.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Nurse delay? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Partly teasing, partly tired, enjoying her power over Juliet.
2. What does “Act II, Scene V” suggest about Juliet waits for the Nurse? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the structure in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet waits for the Nurse? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Love wants instant messages. On structure: The

Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “The clock struck nine when I did send the nurse; In half an hour she promised to return.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet waits impatiently for the Nurse, who left at nine and returns at noon. The Nurse delays, complaining of aches, before telling her to go to Friar Laurence's cell, where a husband waits.
7. How does “Act II, Scene V” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)): Juliet's impatience. On structure: The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse (speech 18)): The Nurse delivers the news. On characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is waiting for important news like?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Love wants instant messages. On imagery: Juliet wishes love's heralds were thoughts that "glide than the sun's beams." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the Nurse a good messenger? Evaluate her role. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Weighing her affection and her unreliability.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)): Juliet's impatience. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Comic delay emphasizes the lovers' urgency.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse (speech 18)): The Nurse delivers the news. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Love wants instant messages. On characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet waits for the Nurse. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)): Juliet's impatience. On structure: The Nurse delays the news to tease Juliet, building comic suspense. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse (speech 18)): The Nurse delivers the news. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Love wants instant messages. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)): Juliet's impatience. On characterization: Juliet's impatience with the slow Nurse is comic and touching. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene V” treats Juliet waits for the Nurse with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Then hie you hence to Friar Laurence’ cell; / There stays a husband to make you a wife” (Act II, Scene V, Nurse (speech 18)): The Nurse delivers the news. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “love’s heralds should be thoughts, / Which ten times faster glide than the sun’s beams” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Love wants instant messages. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet waits for the Nurse? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's impatience shows how the lovers experience time as unbearably slow. Useful evidence: “Is thy news good, or bad? answer to that” (Act II, Scene V, Juliet (speech 7)): Juliet's impatience. Theme link: Juliet counts the hours ("from nine till twelve / Is three long hours"). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz*

1. How long has the Nurse been away?
   A. Ten minutes
   B. One hour
   C. Three hours
   D. A day

2. What does the Nurse complain about?
   A. Romeo's rudeness only
   B. Paris
   C. Tybalt
   D. Her aching bones and back
3. Where must Juliet go?
   A. Church of St. Peter
   B. The orchard
   C. Friar Laurence's cell
   D. Mantua
4. What does Juliet wish love's heralds were?
   A. Horses
   B. Bells
   C. Birds
   D. Thoughts
5. How does the Nurse finally deliver the news?
   A. She whispers to Lady Capulet
   B. She hands her a letter
   C. She sings
   D. She tells Juliet a husband waits at the Friar's cell
6. In the line "O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.", what does "louring" most nearly mean?
   A. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain
   B. dark and threatening
   C. messengers who announce news
   D. details; the full particulars
7. In the line "Are you so hot? marry, come up, I trow; Is this the poultice for my aching bones?", what does "poultice" most nearly mean?
   A. dark and threatening
   B. messengers who announce news
   C. details; the full particulars
   D. a soft dressing applied to soothe pain

**Answer key:** 1. C (Three hours); 2. D (Her aching bones and back); 3. C (Friar Laurence's cell); 4. D (Thoughts); 5. D (She tells Juliet a husband waits at the Friar's cell); 6. B (dark and threatening); 7. D (a soft dressing applied to soothe pain)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet waits for the Nurse? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Scene V develops the idea of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene V suggests about Juliet waits for the Nurse. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet waits for the Nurse responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet waits for the Nurse follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene V and its treatment of Juliet waits for the Nurse. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and structure, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet waits for the Nurse in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet waits for the Nurse. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "heralds" most nearly mean?

   A. fine spider threads floating in the air

   B. messengers who announce news

   C. decoration

   D. real worth; wealth

2. *The clock struck nine when I did send the nurse; In half an hour she promised to return. Perchance she cannot meet him: that's not so. O, she is lame! love's heralds should be thoughts, Which ten times faster glide than the sun's beams, Driving back shadows over louring hills: Therefore do nimble-pinion'd doves draw love, And therefore hath the wind-swift Cupid wings. Now is the sun upon the highmost hill Of this day's journey, and from nine till twelve Is three long hours, yet she is not come. Had she affections and warm youthful blood, She would be as swift in motion as a ball; My words would bandy her to my sweet love, And his to me: But old folks, many feign as they were dead; Unwieldy, slow, heavy and pale as lead. O God, she comes!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene V"?

   A. Juliet waits for the Nurse

   B. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

   C. The Prologue's sonnet and the ending foretold

   D. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

**SAT key:** 1. B (messengers who announce news); 2. A (Juliet waits for the Nurse)

# Lesson 15: Act II, Scene VI

**Focus:** the secret wedding

Teacher only · spoilers

Friar Laurence warns Romeo that violent delights have violent ends and urges moderate love. Juliet arrives; the lovers exchange expressions of joy, and the Friar leads them off to be married.

**Background:** Marriage required vows before a priest; secret marriages were valid but scandalous.

**Significance:** The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What is the difference between intense love and lasting love? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....*
**Prompt:** What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: bestride — stand or walk astride; gossamer — fine spider threads floating in the air; ornament — decoration; substance — real worth; wealth; ghostly — resembling or characteristic of a phantom.*
**Words:** bestride: stand or walk astride · gossamer: fine spider threads floating in the air · ornament: decoration · substance: real worth; wealth · ghostly: resembling or characteristic of a phantom

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Marriage required vows before a priest; secret marriages were valid but scandalous. The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths. Foreshadowing: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends." Imagery: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss." Characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot / Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: / A lover" (Act II, Scene VI, speech (speech 3)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)). The Friar's warning. That is foreshadowing at work: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends."*

> *These violent delights have violent ends* (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)). The Friar's warning. That is foreshadowing at work: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends."

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Moderation as the key to lasting love. Look at the craft: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss." Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: The Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. (Moderation as the key to lasting love.)*

> *Therefore love moderately; long love doth so* (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Moderation as the key to lasting love. Look at the craft: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss."
**Ask:** How does this line connect to time and haste?
**Expected answer:** The Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. (Moderation as the key to lasting love.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for foreshadowing, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene VI develops the idea of the secret wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. When the text says “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)), it shows this directly. Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for foreshadowing, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene VI develops the idea of the secret wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. When the text says “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)), it shows this directly. Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What is the difference between intense love and lasting love? Why does Shakespeare keep the wedding itself offstage?*
**Anchor question:** What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?
**Facilitation:** Why does Shakespeare keep the wedding itself offstage?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. (“These violent delights have violent ends”, Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the secret wedding? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. (“These violent delights have violent ends”, Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the secret wedding. Key takeaway: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Foreshadowing:** The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends."
- **Imagery:** Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss."
- **Characterization:** Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **time and haste:** the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot / Will ne’er wear out the everlasting flint: / A lover” (Act II, Scene VI, speech (speech 3)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “So smile the heavens upon this holy act, / That after hours with sorrow chide us” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 1)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)) The Friar's warning.
- “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)) Moderation as the key to lasting love.
- “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet (speech 8)) Juliet's love exceeds counting.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

> **Claim:** The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction.
> **Evidence:** “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3))
> **Reasoning:** Before the ceremony the Friar says "These violent delights have violent ends" and urges "love moderately; long love doth so," a counsel the lovers cannot follow.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bestride** (verb) | stand or walk astride | *Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **gossamer** (noun) | fine spider threads floating in the air | *Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ornament** (noun) | decoration | *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **substance** (noun) | real worth; wealth | *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *Good even to my ghostly confessor.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bandying** (noun) | exchanging blows or words | *Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **peppered** (adjective) | finished; done for | *I am peppered, I warrant, for this world.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **discords** (noun) | harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels | *Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Romeo say he does not care about if he can call Juliet his? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Love-devouring death may do what he dare.
2. What does the Friar warn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Violent delights have violent ends
3. How does the Friar describe Juliet's step? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: So light a foot
4. What does the Friar advise? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Love moderately
5. Where does the wedding take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Offstage
6. What does Juliet say she cannot sum up? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Half her wealth
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Friar Laurence warns Romeo that violent delights have violent ends and urges moderate love. Juliet arrives; the lovers exchange expressions of joy, and the Friar leads them off to be married.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity." What does "bestride" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: bestride: stand or walk astride.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Friar compare the lovers' joy to fire and powder? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Both explode and are consumed in the moment they meet.
2. What does "Act II, Scene VI" suggest about the secret wedding? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths.
3. Find one example of foreshadowing in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about the secret wedding? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: "These violent delights have violent ends" (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): The Friar's warning. On imagery: Fire and powder: the lovers' joy will "consume" "as they kiss." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Friar Laurence warns Romeo that violent delights have violent ends and urges moderate love. Juliet arrives; the lovers exchange expressions of joy, and the Friar leads them off to be married.
7. How does “Act II, Scene VI” build on “Act II, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet (speech 8)): Juliet's love exceeds counting. On characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is the difference between intense love and lasting love?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): The Friar's warning. On characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the Friar responsible for what follows? Use this scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of his warnings and actions.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The warnings before the wedding foreshadow the deaths.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3,

CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet (speech 8)): Juliet's love exceeds counting. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): The Friar's warning. On characterization: Juliet's love is beyond words: "I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the secret wedding. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet (speech 8)): Juliet's love exceeds counting. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): The Friar's warning. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar

Laurence (speech 3)): Moderation as the key to lasting love. On foreshadowing: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene VI” treats the secret wedding with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth” (Act II, Scene VI, Juliet (speech 8)): Juliet's love exceeds counting. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “These violent delights have violent ends” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): The Friar's warning. On foreshadowing: The Friar warns "These violent delights have violent ends." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the secret wedding? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The wedding scene is shadowed by warnings of destruction. Useful evidence: “Therefore love moderately; long love doth so” (Act II, Scene VI, Friar Laurence (speech 3)): Moderation as the key to lasting love. Theme link: the Friar again urges moderation even as he marries them within a day of meeting. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does the Friar warn?
   A. Love conquers all
   B. Marry in haste
   C. Violent delights have violent ends
   D. Time is short
2. How does the Friar describe Juliet's step?
   A. Slow

B. Uncertain

C. So light a foot

D. Heavy

3. What does the Friar advise?

A. Wait a year

B. Love moderately

C. Tell the parents

D. Elope to Mantua

4. Where does the wedding take place?

A. Offstage

B. On stage at the Capulet house

C. At the feast

D. In the street

5. What does Juliet say she cannot sum up?

A. Her debts

B. Half her wealth

C. Her fear

D. Her prayers

6. In the line "Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.", what does "bestride" most nearly mean?

A. stand or walk astride

B. decoration

C. real worth; wealth

D. fine spider threads floating in the air

7. In the line "Here comes the lady: O, so light a foot Will ne'er wear out the everlasting flint: A lover may bestride the gossamer That idles in the wanton summer air, And yet not fall; so light is vanity.", what does "gossamer" most nearly mean?

A. real worth; wealth

B. fine spider threads floating in the air

C. stand or walk astride

D. decoration

**Answer key:** 1. C (Violent delights have violent ends); 2. C (So light a foot); 3. B (Love moderately); 4. A (Offstage); 5. B (Half her wealth); 6. A (stand or walk astride); 7. B (fine spider threads floating in the air)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Scene VI," how does Shakespeare show the secret wedding? Write a paragraph that states

your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act II, Scene VI, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the secret wedding? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act II, Scene VI develops the idea of the secret wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the secret wedding. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene VI suggests about the secret wedding. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act II, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of the secret wedding. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the secret wedding responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the secret wedding follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene VI and its treatment of the secret wedding. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's foreshadowing and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene VI as evidence for a larger claim about the secret wedding in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene VI as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the secret wedding. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ornament” most nearly mean?

   A. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

   B. exchanging blows or words

   C. decoration

   D. finished; done for

2. *Conceit, more rich in matter than in words, Brags of his substance, not of ornament: They are but beggars that can count their worth; But my true love is grown to such excess I cannot sum up sum of half my wealth.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene VI”?

   A. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

   B. Juliet's feigned obedience

   C. Juliet drinks the potion

   D. The secret wedding

**SAT key:** 1. C (decoration); 2. D (The secret wedding)

# Lesson 16: Act III, Scene I

**Focus:** Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

**Content note (street violence, death of a friend):** Mercutio is fatally wounded and Romeo kills Tybalt on stage. Focus on choices and the honour code, not the swordplay.
**Student preview:** This scene shows two deaths in a street fight.
**Suggested language:** "What choices led to these deaths?"

Teacher only · spoilers

In the hot afternoon Tybalt seeks Romeo. Romeo, newly married to Tybalt's cousin, refuses to fight. Mercutio fights Tybalt; Romeo steps between them and Tybalt wounds Mercutio under Romeo's arm. Mercutio dies cursing both houses. Romeo kills Tybalt and flees. The Prince banishes Romeo.

**Background:** Duels and honour codes required a man to answer insults; refusing could be seen as cowardice. Banishment was a common punishment.

**Significance:** The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*When is it right to fight for a friend? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to violence and the feud because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows two deaths in a street fight.*
**Prompt:** When is it right to fight for a friend?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to violence and the feud because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: bandying — exchanging blows or words; peppered — finished; done for; discords — harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels; minstrels — wandering musicians; appertaining — belonging; appropriate.*
**Words:** bandying: exchanging blows or words · peppered: finished; done for · discords: harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels · minstrels: wandering musicians · appertaining: belonging; appropriate

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Duels and honour codes required a man to answer insults; refusing could be seen as cowardice. Banishment was a common punishment. The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins. Plot: The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished. Characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Irony: Romeo's attempt to stop the fight lets Tybalt's thrust reach Mercutio. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "I pray thee, good Mercutio, let's retire: / The day is hot, the Capulets abroad, / And, if we meet, we shall" (Act III, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "A plague o' both your houses" (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)). Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. That is plot at work: The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished.*

> *A plague o' both your houses* (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "A plague o' both your houses" (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)). Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. That is plot at work: The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo sees himself as fortune's plaything. Expected link: fate and choice: students should weigh his choice to fight against bad luck. Ask: How does this line connect to violence and the feud? Expected: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. (Romeo blames fortune.)*

> *O, I am fortune's fool* (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 47))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Romeo sees himself as fortune's plaything. Expected link: fate and choice: students should weigh his choice to fight against bad luck.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to violence and the feud?
**Expected answer:** Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. (Romeo blames fortune.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. When the text says “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)), it shows this directly. He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. When the text says “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)), it shows this directly. He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: When is it right to fight for a friend? Ask: who is to blame for Mercutio's death? For Tybalt's?*
**Anchor question:** When is it right to fight for a friend?
**Facilitation:** Ask: who is to blame for Mercutio's death? For Tybalt's?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. (“O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate”, Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. (“O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate”, Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Key takeaway: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Plot:** The turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished.
- **Characterization:** Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury.
- **Irony:** Romeo's attempt to stop the fight lets Tybalt's thrust reach Mercutio.

### Themes and how they develop

- **violence and the feud:** Mercutio curses both houses as he dies.

### Symbols and motifs

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “I pray thee, good Mercutio, let’s retire: / The day is hot, the Capulets abroad, / And, if we meet, we shall” (Act III, Scene I, Benvolio (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “This day’s black fate on more days doth depend; / This but begins the woe others” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 41)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)) Mercutio's dying curse on the feud.
- “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)) Romeo blames love for softening him.
- “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 47)) Romeo blames fortune.

### Model claim-evidence-reasoning

**Claim:** Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune.
**Evidence:** “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39))
**Reasoning:** He says Juliet's beauty "hath made me effeminate," kills Tybalt, then cries "O, I am fortune's fool," while Mercutio's "A plague o' both your houses" blames the feud itself.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bandying** (noun) | exchanging blows or words | *Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **peppered** (adjective) | finished; done for | *I am peppered, I warrant, for this world.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **discords** (noun) | harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels | *Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **minstrels** (noun) | wandering musicians | *Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **appertaining** (adjective) | belonging; appropriate | *Tybalt, the reason that I have to love thee Doth much excuse the appertaining rage To such a greeting: villain am I none; Therefore farewell; I see thou know'st me not.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **aspired** (verb) | risen up to | *That gallant spirit hath aspired the clouds, Which too untimely here did scorn the earth.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **slander** (noun) | a false and damaging statement | *This gentleman, the prince's near ally, My very friend, hath got his mortal hurt In my behalf; my reputation stain'd With Tybalt's slander—Tybalt, that an hour Hath been my kinsman!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **grievances** (noun) | complaints | *We talk here in the public haunt of men: Either withdraw unto some private place, And reason coldly of your grievances, Or else depart; here all eyes gaze on us.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *This gentleman, the prince's near ally, My very friend, hath got his mortal hurt In my behalf; my reputation stain'd With Tybalt's slander—Tybalt, that an hour Hath been my kinsman!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. When is it right to fight for a friend?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Mercutio call his wound? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A scratch, but enough; 'ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man.'
2. Why does Romeo refuse to fight Tybalt? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage
3. How is Mercutio wounded? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Under Romeo's arm
4. What does Mercutio curse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Both houses
5. What is Romeo's punishment? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Banishment
6. What does Romeo call himself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Fortune's fool
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: In the hot afternoon Tybalt seeks Romeo. Romeo, newly married to Tybalt's cousin, refuses to fight. Mercutio fights Tybalt; Romeo steps between them and Tybalt wounds Mercutio under Romeo's arm. Mercutio dies cursing both houses. Romeo kills Tybalt and flees. The Prince banishes Romeo.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!" What does "bandying" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: bandying: exchanging blows or words.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Prince banish rather than execute Romeo? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Tybalt killed Mercutio first; Romeo's act ended what the law would have.
2. What does "Act III, Scene I" suggest about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins.
3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: "A plague o' both your houses" (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. On characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "No, 'tis not so deep as a well, nor so wide as a church-door; but 'tis enough, 'twill serve: ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man.", why might Shakespeare have

chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: In the hot afternoon Tybalt seeks Romeo. Romeo, newly married to Tybalt's cousin, refuses to fight. Mercutio fights Tybalt; Romeo steps between them and Tybalt wounds Mercutio under Romeo's arm. Mercutio dies cursing both houses. Romeo kills Tybalt and flees. The Prince banishes Romeo.
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 47)): Romeo blames fortune. On characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When is it right to fight for a friend?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. On irony: Romeo's attempt to stop the fight lets Tybalt's thrust reach Mercutio. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Romeo a murderer, an avenger or a victim? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A reasoned argument using the scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The turning point: comedy dies with Mercutio and tragedy begins.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 47)): Romeo blames fortune. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. On characterization: Romeo tries peace ("I do protest, I never injured thee") then turns to fury. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 47)): Romeo blames fortune. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)): Romeo blames love for softening him. On plot: The

turning point: Mercutio is killed under Romeo's arm; Romeo kills Tybalt and is banished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats Mercutio's death and Tybalt's with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O, I am fortune’s fool” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 47)): Romeo blames fortune. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “A plague o’ both your houses” (Act III, Scene I, Mercutio (speech 32)): Mercutio's dying curse on the feud. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's turn to violence is driven by grief and a code of honour, though he blames fortune. Useful evidence: “O sweet Juliet, / Thy beauty hath made me effeminate” (Act III, Scene I, Romeo (speech 39)): Romeo blames love for softening him. Theme link: Mercutio curses both houses as he dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Why does Romeo refuse to fight Tybalt?
   A. The Prince is watching
   B. He is afraid
   C. He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage
   D. He is wounded
2. How is Mercutio wounded?
   A. In a fair fight
   B. By the Prince's guards

C. Under Romeo's arm

D. By accident from Benvolio

3. What does Mercutio curse?

A. Romeo alone

B. The Prince

C. Tybalt alone

D. Both houses

4. What is Romeo's punishment?

A. Death

B. Prison

C. Banishment

D. Fine

5. What does Romeo call himself?

A. A Capulet

B. Fortune's fool

C. A coward

D. A hero

6. In the line “Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath Forbidden bandying in Verona streets: Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!”, what does “bandying” most nearly mean?

A. wandering musicians

B. finished; done for

C. exchanging blows or words

D. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

7. In the line “I am peppered, I warrant, for this world.”, what does “peppered” most nearly mean?

A. exchanging blows or words

B. finished; done for

C. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

D. wandering musicians

**Answer key:** 1. C (He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage); 2. C (Under Romeo's arm); 3. D (Both houses); 4. C (Banishment); 5. B (Fortune's fool); 6. C (exchanging blows or words); 7. B (finished; done for)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses plot in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Mercutio's death and Tybalt's in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Mercutio's death and Tybalt's. Position

your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Consort! what, dost thou make us minstrels? an thou make minstrels of us, look to hear nothing but discords: here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "discords" most nearly mean?

   A. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

   B. complaints

   C. a false and damaging statement

   D. a male relative

2. *No, 'tis not so deep as a well, nor so wide as a church-door; but 'tis enough, 'twill serve: ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man. I am peppered, I warrant, for this world. A plague o' both your houses! 'Zounds, a dog, a rat, a mouse, a cat, to scratch a man to death! a braggart, a rogue, a villain, that fights by the book of arithmetic! Why the devil came you between us? I was hurt under your arm.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene I"?

   A. The secret wedding

   B. Love at first sight at the Capulet feast

   C. Mercutio's death and Tybalt's

   D. The second Chorus

**SAT key:** 1. A (harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels); 2. C (Mercutio's death and Tybalt's)

# Lesson 17: Act III, Scene II

**Focus:** Juliet hears the news

Teacher only · spoilers

Juliet impatiently waits for night and Romeo. The Nurse arrives lamenting; Juliet thinks Romeo is dead, then learns Tybalt is dead and Romeo banished. She briefly condemns Romeo, then defends him. The Nurse promises to bring Romeo to her.

**Background:** Epithalamium (wedding-night poem) traditions shape Juliet's speech.

**Significance:** Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do you react when someone you love does something wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and desire because....*
**Prompt:** How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to love and desire because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: cockatrice — a mythical serpent that could kill with a look; runaways — wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses; rearward — rear guard; something following behind; widowed — left without a husband; mangled — badly wounded or mutilated.*
**Words:** cockatrice: a mythical serpent that could kill with a look · runaways: wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses · rearward: rear guard; something following behind · widowed: left without a husband · mangled: badly wounded or mutilated

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Epithalamium (wedding-night poem) traditions shape Juliet's speech. Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo. Dramatic irony: Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death. Diction / vocabulary: Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene. Imagery: "Come, night; come, Romeo; come, thou day in night." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "would whip you to the west, / And bring in cloudy night immediately. / Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, / That runaways' eyes may" (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)). Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. That is dramatic irony at work: Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death.*

> *Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds* (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)). Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. That is dramatic irony at work: Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet joins opposites (beautiful and tyrant) because she cannot reconcile Romeo's face with his act. Expected link: love and the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to love and desire? Expected: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." (Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.)*

> *Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical* (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Juliet joins opposites (beautiful and tyrant) because she cannot reconcile Romeo's face with his act. Expected link: love and the feud.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to love and desire?
**Expected answer:** Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." (Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet hears the news. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. When the text says “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)), it shows this directly. After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet hears the news. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. When the text says “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)), it shows this directly. After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How do you react when someone you love does something wrong? Compare Juliet's oxymorons here with Romeo's in Act I, Scene I. What has changed?*
**Anchor question:** How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?
**Facilitation:** Compare Juliet's oxymorons here with Romeo's in Act I, Scene I. What has changed?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. (“Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical”, Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet hears the news? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. (“Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical”, Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes Juliet hears the news. Key takeaway: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Dramatic irony:** Juliet longs for night and Romeo just as the Nurse arrives with news of Tybalt's death.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene.
- **Imagery:** "Come, night; come, Romeo; come, thou day in night."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **love and desire:** Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain."

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “would whip you to the west, / And bring in cloudy night immediately. / Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, / That runaways’ eyes may” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “shall die, / Take him and cut him out in little stars, / And he will make the face of heaven so fine / That” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)) Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night.
- “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)) Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act.
- “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 19)) Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband.
**Evidence:** “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15))
**Reasoning:** After calling Romeo "Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!" she reasons "That villain cousin would have kill'd my husband," taking Romeo's side.

### Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **cockatrice** (noun) | a mythical serpent that could kill with a look | *And that bare vowel "I" shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer "I."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **runaways** (noun) | wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses | *Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, That runaways' eyes may wink, and Romeo Leap to these arms, untalk'd of and unseen.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **rearward** (noun) | rear guard; something following behind | *But with a rearward following Tybalt's death, "Romeo is banished," to speak that word, Is father, mother, Tybalt, Romeo, Juliet, All slain, all dead.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **widowed** (adjective) | left without a husband | *Take up those cords: poor ropes, you are beguiled, Both you and I; for Romeo is exiled: He made you for a highway to my bed; But I, a maid, die maiden-widowed.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mangled** (adjective) | badly wounded or mutilated | *Ah, poor my lord, what tongue shall smooth thy name, When I, thy three-hours wife, have mangled it?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beguiled** (verb) | cheated; tricked | *Take up those cords: poor ropes, you are beguiled, Both you and I; for Romeo is exiled: He made you for a highway to my bed; But I, a maid, die maiden-widowed.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **darting** (verb) | moving suddenly and quickly | *And that bare vowel "I" shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer "I."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **blubbering** (verb) | weeping noisily | *Even so lies she, Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### Discussion questions

1. How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

### Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does the Nurse promise Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: To find Romeo and bring him to comfort her.
2. What does Juliet wish for at the start? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Night to come quickly
3. What does the Nurse bring? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Cords (a rope ladder)
4. Whom does Juliet first think is dead? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo
5. What phrase does Juliet use for Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Beautiful tyrant
6. What is worse to Juliet than Tybalt's death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo's banishment
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Juliet impatiently waits for night and Romeo. The Nurse arrives lamenting; Juliet thinks Romeo is dead, then learns Tybalt is dead and Romeo banished. She briefly condemns Romeo, then defends him. The Nurse promises to bring Romeo to her.
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “And that bare vowel “I” shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer “I.”” What does “cockatrice” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: cockatrice: a mythical serpent that could kill with a look.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Juliet's speech use so many oxymorons? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: She cannot reconcile Romeo's beauty with his violence.
2. What does “Act III, Scene II” suggest about Juliet hears the news? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet hears the news? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. On diction / vocabulary: Juliet's oxymorons ("Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical!") echo Romeo's in the first scene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “What devil art thou, that dost torment me thus?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet impatiently waits for night and Romeo. The Nurse arrives lamenting; Juliet thinks Romeo is dead, then learns Tybalt is dead and Romeo banished. She briefly condemns Romeo, then defends him. The Nurse promises to bring Romeo to her.
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 19)): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do you react when someone you love does something wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. On imagery: "Come, night; come, Romeo; come, thou day in night." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Juliet right to defend Romeo? Evaluate her reasoning. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Weighing family loyalty against marriage.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Juliet's loyalty shifts decisively to Romeo.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look

for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 19)): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet hears the news. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 19)): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet

(speech 15)): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats Juliet hears the news with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “That villain cousin would have kill’d my husband” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 19)): Juliet's loyalty shifts to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Gallop apace, you fiery-footed steeds” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet urges the sun's horses to bring night. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet hears the news? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's response to Tybalt's death shows her loyalty has moved from family to husband. Useful evidence: “Beautiful tyrant! fiend angelical” (Act III, Scene II, Juliet (speech 15)): Oxymorons express shock at Romeo's act. Theme link: Juliet chooses husband over cousin: "My husband lives, that Tybalt would have slain." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Juliet wish for at the start?
   A. Night to come quickly
   B. Tybalt to visit
   C. The sun to stay
   D. Paris to arrive
2. What does the Nurse bring?
   A. Flowers

   B. A potion
   C. Cords (a rope ladder)
   D. A letter

3. Whom does Juliet first think is dead?
   A. Her father
   B. Romeo
   C. Tybalt
   D. Mercutio

4. What phrase does Juliet use for Romeo?
   A. Beautiful tyrant
   B. Foul Montague
   C. Noble knight
   D. My lord

5. What is worse to Juliet than Tybalt's death?
   A. The plague
   B. The Nurse's tears
   C. Romeo's banishment
   D. Her father's anger

6. In the line “And that bare vowel “I” shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer “I.””, what does “cockatrice” most nearly mean?
   A. rear guard; something following behind
   B. wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses
   C. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look
   D. left without a husband

7. In the line “Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night, That runaways’ eyes may wink, and Romeo Leap to these arms, untalk’d of and unseen.”, what does “runaways” most nearly mean?
   A. rear guard; something following behind
   B. left without a husband
   C. a mythical serpent that could kill with a look
   D. wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses

**Answer key:** 1. A (Night to come quickly); 2. C (Cords (a rope ladder)); 3. B (Romeo); 4. A (Beautiful tyrant); 5. C (Romeo's banishment); 6. C (a mythical serpent that could kill with a look); 7. D (wanderers, possibly the fleeing sun's horses)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet hears the news? Write a paragraph that states

your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet hears the news? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet hears the news. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Juliet hears the news. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about Juliet hears the news. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet hears the news. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet hears the news responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet hears the news follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of Juliet hears the news. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet hears the news in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet hears the news. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But with a rearward following Tybalt's death, "Romeo is banished," to speak that word, Is father, mother, Tybalt, Romeo, Juliet, All slain, all dead.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "rearward" most nearly mean?

   A. rear guard; something following behind

   B. weeping noisily

   C. cheated; tricked

   D. moving suddenly and quickly

2. *What devil art thou, that dost torment me thus? This torture should be roar'd in dismal hell. Hath Romeo slain himself? say thou but "I," And that bare vowel "I" shall poison more Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice: I am not I, if there be such an I; Or those eyes shut, that make thee answer "I." If he be slain, say "I"; or if not, no: Brief sounds determine of my weal or woe.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene II"?

   A. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

   B. Juliet hears the news

   C. The balcony scene

   D. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

**SAT key:** 1. A (rear guard; something following behind); 2. B (Juliet hears the news)

# Lesson 18: Act III, Scene III

**Focus:** Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

**Content note (suicide (attempted)):** Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself and the Friar stops him. Use the safe-messaging script; focus on the Friar's reasons for hope and on who Romeo could turn to.
**Student preview:** In this scene a character tries to take his own life and is stopped. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "What does the Friar say to give Romeo reasons to live?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Romeo hides in the Friar's cell, despairing at banishment. The Nurse arrives; Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself; the Friar stops him and lays out a plan: spend the night with Juliet, flee to Mantua, and wait until the marriage can be announced.

**Background:** Banishment meant losing home, livelihood and family; for an aristocrat, it was social death.

**Significance:** The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What helps someone in despair? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because.... Content note before we start: In this scene a character tries to take his own life and is stopped. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** What helps someone in despair?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: blubbering — weeping noisily; anatomy — the body; purgatory — a place of suffering before heaven; profess — to declare openly; revived — came back to life; returned.*
**Words:** blubbering: weeping noisily · anatomy: the body · purgatory: a place of suffering before heaven · profess: to declare openly · revived: came back to life; returned

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Banishment meant losing home, livelihood and family; for an aristocrat, it was social death. The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste. Characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Diction / vocabulary: "banished" repeated as a death sentence. Structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "O Lord, I could have stay'd here all the night / To hear good counsel: O, what learning is! / My lord, I'll" (Act III, Scene III, Nurse (speech 33)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death" (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)). Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. That is characterization at work: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him.*

> *Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death* (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Ha, banishment! be merciful, say "death" (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)). Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. That is characterization at work: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo means life outside Verona is not life. Expected link: love and desire; youth and age. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: The Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. (For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.)*

> *There is no world without Verona walls* (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Romeo means life outside Verona is not life. Expected link: love and desire; youth and age.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to youth and age?
**Expected answer:** The Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. (For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. When the text says “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)), it shows this directly. He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. When the text says “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)), it shows this directly. He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What helps someone in despair? Is the Friar's scolding fair? What would you say to Romeo?*
**Anchor question:** What helps someone in despair?
**Facilitation:** Is the Friar's scolding fair? What would you say to Romeo?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. (“There is no world without Verona walls”, Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. (“There is no world without Verona walls”, Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Key takeaway: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "banished" repeated as a death sentence.
- **Structure:** The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **youth and age:** the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “O Lord, I could have stay’d here all the night / To hear good counsel: O, what learning is! / My lord, I’ll” (Act III, Scene III, Nurse (speech 33)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Tis torture, and not mercy: heaven is here, / Where Juliet lives; and every cat and dog / And” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 10)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)) Romeo sees banishment as worse than death.
- “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)) For Romeo, exile is the end of the world.
- “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 32)) The Friar shames Romeo.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet.
**Evidence:** “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8))
**Reasoning:** He cries "be merciful, say 'death'" and insists "There is no world without Verona walls," until the Friar demands "Art thou a man?"

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **blubbering** (verb) | weeping noisily | *Even so lies she, Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **anatomy** (noun) | the body | *O, tell me, friar, tell me, In what vile part of this anatomy Doth my name lodge? tell me, that I may sack The hateful mansion.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **purgatory** (noun) | a place of suffering before heaven | *There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **profess** (verb) | to declare openly | *O friar, the damned use that word in hell; Howlings attend it: how hast thou the heart, Being a divine, a ghostly confessor, A sin-absolver, and my friend profess'd, To mangle me with that word "banished"?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **revived** (verb) | came back to life; returned | *How well my comfort is revived by this!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *O friar, the damned use that word in hell; Howlings attend it: how hast thou the heart, Being a divine, a ghostly confessor, A sin-absolver, and my friend profess'd, To mangle me with that word "banished"?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **commend** (verb) | send greetings; recommend | *Go before, nurse: commend me to thy lady; And bid her hasten all the house to bed, Which heavy sorrow makes them apt unto: Romeo is coming.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *As if that name, Shot from the deadly level of a gun, Did murder her; as that name's cursed hand Murder'd her kinsman.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **fearful** (adjective) | full of fear; dreadful | *Romeo, come forth; come forth, thou fearful man: Affliction is enamour'd of thy parts, And thou art wedded to calamity.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What helps someone in despair?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1,

2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does the Friar say philosophy can do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Comfort Romeo in banishment.
2. What does Romeo call banishment? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Death
3. What does Romeo try to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Kill himself
4. Who stops him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Friar
5. Where must Romeo go? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Mantua
6. What should Romeo do tonight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Go to Juliet
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo hides in the Friar's cell, despairing at banishment. The Nurse arrives; Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself; the Friar stops him and lays out a plan: spend the night with Juliet, flee to Mantua, and wait until the marriage can be announced.
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Even so lies she, Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering.” What does “blubbering” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: blubbering: weeping noisily.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Friar list Romeo's blessings? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: To show that he has reasons to live.
2. What does “Act III, Scene III” suggest about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in this scene shape what we understand about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. On diction / vocabulary: "banished"

repeated as a death sentence. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Romeo hides in the Friar's cell, despairing at banishment. The Nurse arrives; Romeo draws a dagger to kill himself; the Friar stops him and lays out a plan: spend the night with Juliet, flee to Mantua, and wait until the marriage can be announced.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. On structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 32)): The Friar shames Romeo. On characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What helps someone in despair?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. On structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the Friar's plan realistic? Evaluate. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Weighing its timing and risks.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The Friar's plan shows his steady counsel and the dangers of haste.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 32)): The Friar shames Romeo. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. On characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. On structure: The Friar's long speech lists Romeo's blessings and lays out a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 32)): The Friar shames Romeo. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. On characterization: Romeo despairs at banishment, threatens suicide; the Friar scolds him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Art thou a man? thy form cries out thou art” (Act III, Scene III, Friar Laurence (speech 32)): The Friar shames Romeo. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “Ha, banishment! be merciful, say “death” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 6)): Romeo sees banishment as worse than death. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's despair shows how completely his identity is bound to Verona and Juliet. Useful evidence: “There is no world without Verona walls” (Act III, Scene III, Romeo (speech 8)): For Romeo, exile is the end of the world. Theme link: the Friar's reason against Romeo's passion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Romeo call banishment?
   A. A holiday
   B. Mercy
   C. Death
   D. Justice

2. What does Romeo try to do?
   A. Kill the Friar
   B. Kill himself
   C. Fight the Prince
   D. Leave Verona at once
3. Who stops him?
   A. Juliet
   B. The Friar
   C. The Nurse
   D. Balthasar
4. Where must Romeo go?
   A. Padua
   B. Mantua
   C. Rome
   D. Venice
5. What should Romeo do tonight?
   A. Confess to Capulet
   B. Leave immediately
   C. Hide in the cell
   D. Go to Juliet
6. In the line "Even so lies she, Blubbering and weeping, weeping and blubbering.", what does "blubbering" most nearly mean?
   A. to declare openly
   B. a place of suffering before heaven
   C. the body
   D. weeping noisily
7. In the line "O, tell me, friar, tell me, In what vile part of this anatomy Doth my name lodge? tell me, that I may sack The hateful mansion.", what does "anatomy" most nearly mean?
   A. to declare openly
   B. a place of suffering before heaven
   C. the body
   D. weeping noisily

**Answer key:** 1. C (Death); 2. B (Kill himself); 3. B (The Friar); 4. B (Mantua); 5. D (Go to Juliet); 6. D (weeping noisily); 7. C (the body)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? Write a

paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “purgatory” most nearly mean?

   A. full of fear; dreadful

   B. a male relative

   C. a place of suffering before heaven

   D. send greetings; recommend

2. *There is no world without Verona walls, But purgatory, torture, hell itself. Hence-banished is banish’d from the world, And world’s exile is death: then banished, Is death mis-term’d: calling death banishment, Thou cutt’st my head off with a golden axe, And smilest upon the stroke that murders me.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene III”?

   A. Wedding preparations

   B. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

   C. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

   D. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

**SAT key:** 1. C (a place of suffering before heaven); 2. B (Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell)

# Lesson 19: Act III, Scene IV

**Focus:** Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

Teacher only · spoilers

Late at night Capulet tells Paris that Juliet will marry him on Thursday, assuming her obedience.

**Background:** Fathers had legal power over daughters; Tybalt's death adds urgency.

**Significance:** Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do adults decide for children? When is it fair? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because....*
**Prompt:** How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: heaviness — sadness; commend — send greetings; recommend; kinsman — a male relative; hilding — a worthless creature; severing — parting.*
**Words:** heaviness: sadness · commend: send greetings; recommend · kinsman: a male relative · hilding: a worthless creature · severing: parting

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Fathers had legal power over daughters; Tybalt's death adds urgency. Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline. Irony: Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo. Characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Plot: The wedding to Paris is set for Thursday. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "times of woe afford no time to woo. / Madam, good night: commend me to your daughter" (Act III, Scene IV, Paris (speech 2)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)). Capulet now assumes obedience. That is irony at work: Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo.*

> *I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me* (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)). Capulet now assumes obedience. That is irony at work: Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Desperate tender" means a bold or risky offer. Expected link: youth and age, and contrast with Act I, Scene II. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. (Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.)*

> *Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child's love* (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** "Desperate tender" means a bold or risky offer. Expected link: youth and age, and contrast with Act I, Scene II.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to youth and age?
**Expected answer:** Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. (Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. When the text says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)), it shows this directly. He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. When the text says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)), it shows this directly. He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How do adults decide for children? When is it fair? Why might Capulet change his mind so quickly after Tybalt's death?*
**Anchor question:** How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?
**Facilitation:** Why might Capulet change his mind so quickly after Tybalt's death?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. ("I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me", Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. ("I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me", Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how irony shapes Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Key takeaway: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Irony:** Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night she spends with Romeo.
- **Characterization:** Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me."
- **Plot:** The wedding to Paris is set for Thursday.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **youth and age:** Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “times of woe afford no time to woo. / Madam, good night: commend me to your daughter” (Act III, Scene IV, Paris (speech 2)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “but for your company, / I would have been a-bed an hour ago” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 1)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)) Capulet now assumes obedience.
- “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)) Capulet offers Juliet impulsively.
- “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 6)) The marriage is fixed in haste.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent.
**Evidence:** “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4))
**Reasoning:** He makes "a desperate tender / Of my child's love" and says "she will be ruled / In all respects by me," fixing a wedding day without her.

### Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **heaviness** (noun) | sadness | *I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew'd up to her heaviness.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **commend** (verb) | send greetings; recommend | *Madam, good night: commend me to your daughter.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *We'll keep no great ado—a friend or two; For, hark you, Tybalt being slain so late, It may be thought we held him carelessly, Being our kinsman, if we revel much: Therefore we'll have some half a dozen friends, And there an end.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **hilding** (noun) | a worthless creature | *Wife, we scarce thought us blest That God had lent us but this only child; But now I see this one is one too much, And that we have a curse in having her: Out on her, hilding!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **severing** (adjective) | parting | *It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night's candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain tops.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **exhales** (verb) | draws out (as vapour) | *Yon light is not day-light, I know it, I: It is some meteor that the sun exhales, To be to thee this night a torch-bearer, And light thee on thy way to Mantua: Therefore stay yet; thou need'st not to be gone.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dispraise** (verb) | find fault with | *Is it more sin to wish me thus forsworn, Or to dispraise my lord with that same tongue Which she hath praised him with above compare So many thousand times?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **procures** (verb) | brings | *What unaccustom'd cause procures her hither?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### Discussion questions

1. How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

### Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What day is it when the scene takes place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Monday.
2. When is the wedding set? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Thursday
3. What does Capulet assume? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Juliet will be ruled by him
4. What is Juliet doing upstairs? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Spending the night with Romeo
5. Why does Capulet keep the wedding small? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Tybalt has just died
6. What does Capulet call his offer? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A desperate tender
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene IV” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Late at night Capulet tells Paris that Juliet will marry him on Thursday, assuming her obedience.
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene IV”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew’d up to her heaviness.” What does “heaviness” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: heaviness: sadness.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Capulet change his mind about waiting? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Grief and urgency after Tybalt's death.
2. What does “Act III, Scene IV” suggest about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet now assumes obedience. On characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Things have fall’n out, sir, so unluckily, That we have had no time to move our daughter: Look you, she loved her kinsman Tybalt dearly, And so did I:—Well, we were born to die.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Late at night Capulet tells Paris that Juliet will marry him on Thursday, assuming her obedience.
7. How does “Act III, Scene IV” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 6)): The marriage is fixed in haste. On characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do adults decide for children? When is it fair?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet now assumes obedience. On plot: The wedding to Paris is set for Thursday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. How does the audience's knowledge shape this scene? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Dramatic irony: Juliet is already married.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Capulet's haste sets the tragedy's timeline.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 6)): The marriage is fixed in haste. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet now assumes obedience. On characterization: Capulet now says "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O’ Thursday let it be” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 6)): The marriage is fixed in haste. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet now assumes obedience. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: “Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child’s love” (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. On irony: Capulet promises Juliet to Paris the night

she spends with Romeo. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act III, Scene IV" treats Capulet sets the wedding to Paris with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: "Well, Wednesday is too soon, / O' Thursday let it be" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 6)): The marriage is fixed in haste. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act III, Scene V" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: "I think she will be ruled / In all respects by me" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet now assumes obedience. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Capulet's decision reverses his earlier respect for Juliet's consent. Useful evidence: "Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender / Of my child's love" (Act III, Scene IV, Capulet (speech 4)): Capulet offers Juliet impulsively. Theme link: Capulet decides for Juliet without asking her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. When is the wedding set?
   A. Friday
   B. Wednesday
   C. Thursday
   D. Next week
2. What does Capulet assume?
   A. Juliet will be ruled by him
   B. Paris will withdraw

C. Juliet loves Romeo

D. Juliet will refuse

3. What is Juliet doing upstairs?

A. Praying

B. Sleeping

C. Writing

D. Spending the night with Romeo

4. Why does Capulet keep the wedding small?

A. Juliet asked

B. Tybalt has just died

C. They are poor

D. Paris is shy

5. What does Capulet call his offer?

A. A bargain

B. A gift

C. A prayer

D. A desperate tender

6. In the line "I will, and know her mind early to-morrow; To-night she is mew'd up to her heaviness.", what does "heaviness" most nearly mean?

A. a male relative

B. a worthless creature

C. sadness

D. send greetings; recommend

7. In the line "Madam, good night: commend me to your daughter.", what does "commend" most nearly mean?

A. a worthless creature

B. send greetings; recommend

C. a male relative

D. sadness

**Answer key:** 1. C (Thursday); 2. A (Juliet will be ruled by him); 3. D (Spending the night with Romeo); 4. B (Tybalt has just died); 5. D (A desperate tender); 6. C (sadness); 7. B (send greetings; recommend)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act III, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene IV suggests about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene IV and its treatment of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Capulet sets the wedding to Paris in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Capulet sets the wedding to Paris. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *We'll keep no great ado—a friend or two; For, hark you, Tybalt being slain so late, It may be thought we held him carelessly, Being our kinsman, if we revel much: Therefore we'll have some half a dozen friends, And there an end.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "kinsman" most nearly mean?

   A. brings

   B. find fault with

   C. draws out (as vapour)

   D. a male relative

2. *Things have fall'n out, sir, so unluckily, That we have had no time to move our daughter: Look you, she loved her kinsman Tybalt dearly, And so did I:—Well, we were born to die. 'Tis very late, she'll not come down to-night: I promise you, but for your company, I would have been a-bed an hour ago.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene IV"?

   A. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

   B. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

   C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

   D. The secret wedding

**SAT key:** 1. D (a male relative); 2. A (Capulet sets the wedding to Paris)

# Lesson 20: Act III, Scene V

**Focus:** parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

**Content note (parental abuse (verbal)):** Capulet threatens to throw Juliet into the streets and calls her names. Some students may recognize this; keep discussion on power and choice in the play's world.
**Student preview:** A father threatens and insults his daughter.
**Suggested language:** "What options does Juliet have, and who could help her?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At dawn the lovers argue whether it is the nightingale or the lark. Romeo leaves. Lady Capulet tells Juliet of the wedding; Juliet refuses. Capulet threatens to throw her out. The Nurse advises marrying Paris; Juliet decides to seek the Friar's help, or die.

**Background:** Fathers could disinherit daughters; marriage was an economic contract.

**Significance:** Juliet becomes isolated.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What does it feel like to be left without support? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to youth and age because.... Content note before we start: A father threatens and insults his daughter.*
**Prompt:** What does it feel like to be left without support?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to youth and age because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: hilding — a worthless creature; severing — parting; exhales — draws out (as vapour); dispraise — find fault with; procures — brings.*
**Words:** hilding: a worthless creature · severing: parting · exhales: draws out (as vapour) · dispraise: find fault with · procures: brings

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Fathers could disinherit daughters; marriage was an economic contract. Juliet becomes isolated. Imagery: The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day. Foreshadowing: Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb." Characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: / It was the nightingale, and not the lark, / That pierced the" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It was the nightingale, and not the lark" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)). Juliet tries to deny the morning. That is imagery at work: The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day.*

> *It was the nightingale, and not the lark* (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It was the nightingale, and not the lark" (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)). Juliet tries to deny the morning. That is imagery at work: The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet's vision of Romeo in a tomb foreshadows the ending. Expected link: death as bridegroom; fate. Ask: How does this line connect to youth and age? Expected: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. (Juliet's premonition.)*

> *Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb* (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Juliet's vision of Romeo in a tomb foreshadows the ending. Expected link: death as bridegroom; fate.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to youth and age?
**Expected answer:** Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. (Juliet's premonition.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the scene for imagery, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene isolates Juliet completely. When the text says “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)), it shows this directly. After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.*

**Task:** Annotate the scene for imagery, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The scene isolates Juliet completely. When the text says “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)), it shows this directly. After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What does it feel like to be left without support? Ask: which betrayal hurts Juliet most: her father's, her mother's or the Nurse's?*

**Anchor question:** What does it feel like to be left without support?

**Facilitation:** Ask: which betrayal hurts Juliet most: her father's, her mother's or the Nurse's?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene isolates Juliet completely. (“Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch”, Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: The scene isolates Juliet completely. (“Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch”, Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Key takeaway: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Imagery:** The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day.
- **Foreshadowing:** Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb."
- **Characterization:** Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **youth and age:** Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: / It was the nightingale, and not the lark, / That pierced the” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “is not the lark, whose notes do beat / The vaulty heaven so high above our heads: / I have more care to stay” (Act III, Scene V, Romeo (speech 4)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)) Juliet tries to deny the morning.
- “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16)) Juliet's premonition.
- “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)) Capulet's fury.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The scene isolates Juliet completely.
**Evidence:** “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49))
**Reasoning:** After she sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb," her father calls her "young baggage! disobedient wretch," her mother refuses to help and the Nurse tells her to marry Paris.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **hilding** (noun) | a worthless creature | *Wife, we scarce thought us blest That God had lent us but this only child; But now I see this one is one too much, And that we have a curse in having her: Out on her, hilding!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **severing** (adjective) | parting | *It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night's candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain tops.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **exhales** (verb) | draws out (as vapour) | *Yon light is not day-light, I know it, I: It is some meteor that the sun exhales, To be to thee this night a torch-bearer, And light thee on thy way to Mantua: Therefore stay yet; thou need'st not to be gone.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dispraise** (verb) | find fault with | *Is it more sin to wish me thus forsworn, Or to dispraise my lord with that same tongue Which she hath praised him with above compare So many thousand times?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **procures** (verb) | brings | *What unaccustom'd cause procures her hither?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conduit** (noun) | a fountain; a pipe of water | *How now! a conduit, girl? what, still in tears?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **pomegranate** (noun) | a fruit tree with many seeds | *Wilt thou be gone? it is not yet near day: It was the nightingale, and not the lark, That pierced the fearful hollow of thine ear; Nightly she sings on yon pomegranate-tree: Believe me, love, it was the nightingale.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **stratagems** (noun) | tricks or schemes | *Alack, alack, that heaven should practise stratagems Upon so soft a subject as myself!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bridegroom** (noun) | a man who has recently been married | *Is she not proud? doth she not count her blest, Unworthy as she is, that we have wrought So worthy a gentleman to be her bridegroom?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **discords** (noun) | harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels | *It is the lark that sings so out of tune, Straining harsh discords and unpleasing sharps.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What does it feel like to be left without support?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Lady Capulet plan for Romeo? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: To send someone to Mantua to poison him.
2. Which bird does Juliet claim is singing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The nightingale
3. What vision does Juliet have of Romeo? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Dead in a tomb
4. What does Capulet threaten? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: To throw her out
5. What does the Nurse advise? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Marry Paris
6. Where does Juliet decide to go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Friar Laurence
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At dawn the lovers argue whether it is the nightingale or the lark. Romeo leaves. Lady Capulet tells Juliet of the wedding; Juliet refuses. Capulet threatens to throw her out. The Nurse advises marrying Paris; Juliet decides to seek the Friar's help, or die.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Wife, we scarce thought us blest That God had lent us but this only child; But now I see this one is one too much, And that we have a curse in having her: Out on her, hilding!" What does "hilding" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: hilding: a worthless creature.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Nurse's advice feel like betrayal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: She urges bigamy and ignores Juliet's love.
2. What does "Act III, Scene V" suggest about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet becomes isolated.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

4. How does the foreshadowing in this scene shape what we understand about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On foreshadowing: Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night’s candles are burnt out, and jocund day…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: At dawn the lovers argue whether it is the nightingale or the lark. Romeo leaves. Lady Capulet tells Juliet of the wedding; Juliet refuses. Capulet threatens to throw her out. The Nurse advises marrying Paris; Juliet decides to seek the Friar's help, or die.
7. How does “Act III, Scene V” build on “Act III, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16)): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)): Capulet's fury. On characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it feel like to be left without support?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Which parent is most to blame here? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Comparison of Capulet and Lady Capulet.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16)): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Juliet becomes isolated.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)): Capulet's fury. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On characterization: Capulet's rage at Juliet's refusal; the Nurse advises her to marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16)): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)): Capulet's fury. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet tries to deny the morning.

Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16)): Juliet's premonition. On imagery: The lark and the nightingale: the lovers argue about whether it is day. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene V” treats parting at dawn and Capulet's rage with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Hang thee, young baggage! disobedient wretch” (Act III, Scene V, Capulet (speech 49)): Capulet's fury. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “It was the nightingale, and not the lark” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 1)): Juliet tries to deny the morning. On foreshadowing: Juliet sees Romeo "As one dead in the bottom of a tomb." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene isolates Juliet completely. Useful evidence: “Methinks I see thee, now thou art below, / As one dead in the bottom of a tomb” (Act III, Scene V, Juliet (speech 16)): Juliet's premonition. Theme link: Juliet is abandoned by father, mother and Nurse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Which bird does Juliet claim is singing?

   A. The crow

B. The lark

C. The nightingale

D. The owl

2. What vision does Juliet have of Romeo?

A. Old

B. Crowned

C. Fighting

D. Dead in a tomb

3. What does Capulet threaten?

A. To throw her out

B. To banish Paris

C. To leave Verona

D. To forgive her

4. What does the Nurse advise?

A. Run away

B. Marry Paris

C. Tell the truth

D. Pray

5. Where does Juliet decide to go?

A. Her mother

B. Friar Laurence

C. The Prince

D. Mantua

6. In the line "Wife, we scarce thought us blest That God had lent us but this only child; But now I see this one is one too much, And that we have a curse in having her: Out on her, hilding!", what does "hilding" most nearly mean?

A. parting

B. draws out (as vapour)

C. a worthless creature

D. find fault with

7. In the line "It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night's candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain tops.", what does "severing" most nearly mean?

A. find fault with

B. draws out (as vapour)

C. parting

D. a worthless creature

**Answer key:** 1. C (The nightingale); 2. D (Dead in a tomb); 3. A (To throw her out); 4. B (Marry Paris); 5. B (Friar Laurence); 6. C (a worthless creature); 7. C (parting)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act III, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene V suggests about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act III, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene V and its treatment of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about parting at dawn and Capulet's rage in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of parting at dawn and Capulet's rage. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Yon light is not day-light, I know it, I: It is some meteor that the sun exhales, To be to thee this night a torch-bearer, And light thee on thy way to Mantua: Therefore stay yet; thou need'st not to be gone.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "exhales" most nearly mean?

   A. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

   B. a man who has recently been married

   C. tricks or schemes

   D. draws out (as vapour)

2. *It was the lark, the herald of the morn, No nightingale: look, love, what envious streaks Do lace the severing clouds in yonder east: Night's candles are burnt out, and jocund day Stands tiptoe on the misty mountain tops. I must be gone and live, or stay and die.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene V"?

   A. The undelivered letter

   B. The secret wedding

   C. Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage

   D. Romeo's despair in the Friar's cell

**SAT key:** 1. D (draws out (as vapour)); 2. C (Parting at dawn and Capulet's rage)

# Lesson 21: Act IV, Scene I

**Focus:** the Friar's desperate plan

**Content note (suicide (threatened)):** Juliet threatens to kill herself rather than marry Paris. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss the Friar's response and the pressure Juliet faces.
**Student preview:** A character speaks of taking her own life. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "Why does Juliet feel she has no other way out?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Paris tells the Friar of the wedding. Juliet arrives and fences verbally with him. Alone with the Friar, she threatens suicide; he gives her a potion that will make her seem dead for forty-two hours and promises to send for Romeo.

**Background:** Herbal drugs and sleeping draughts were common in literature; the plan echoes stories of feigned death.

**Significance:** The plan's complexity sets up its failure.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*When is a risky plan worth trying? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... Content note before we start: A character speaks of taking her own life. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** When is a risky plan worth trying?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: pensive — thoughtful and sad; compass — reach; the limit of one's ability; slander — a false and damaging statement; entreat — ask earnestly; behests — commands.*
**Words:** pensive: thoughtful and sad · compass: reach; the limit of one's ability · slander: a false and damaging statement · entreat: ask earnestly · behests: commands

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Herbal drugs and sleeping draughts were common in literature; the plan echoes stories of feigned death. The plan's complexity sets up its failure. Characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Plot: The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours." Foreshadowing: She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "merry, give consent / To marry Paris: Wednesday is to-morrow: / To-morrow night look that thou lie alone; / Let not thy nurse lie with" (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth" (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)). Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. That is characterization at work: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar.*

> *That is no slander, sir, which is a truth* (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth" (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)). Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. That is characterization at work: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The potion will make her seem dead for 42 hours and then she will wake. Expected link: poison and medicine. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. (The potion's effect.)*

> *Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep* (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The potion will make her seem dead for 42 hours and then she will wake. Expected link: poison and medicine.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to fate and choice?
**Expected answer:** Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. (The potion's effect.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for characterization, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the Friar's desperate plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. When the text says “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)), it shows this directly. She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the Friar's desperate plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. When the text says “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)), it shows this directly. She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: When is a risky plan worth trying? List what could go wrong with the Friar's plan. Which risks does he admit?*
**Anchor question:** When is a risky plan worth trying?
**Facilitation:** List what could go wrong with the Friar's plan. Which risks does he admit?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. (“That is no slander, sir, which is a truth”, Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. (“That is no slander, sir, which is a truth”, Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the Friar's desperate plan. Key takeaway: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar.
- **Plot:** The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours."
- **Foreshadowing:** She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **fate and choice:** Juliet chooses a terrifying plan.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “merry, give consent / To marry Paris: Wednesday is to-morrow: / To-morrow night look that thou lie alone; / Let not thy nurse lie with” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “it so; / And I am nothing slow to slack his haste” (Act IV, Scene I, Paris (speech 2)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)) Juliet's sharp answer to Paris.
- “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)) The potion's effect.
- “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 31)) Juliet's courage.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands.
**Evidence:** “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20))
**Reasoning:** She answers Paris with "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth," then takes the potion's plan ("two and forty hours") crying "Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear!"

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **pensive** (adjective) | thoughtful and sad | *My leisure serves me, pensive daughter, now.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **compass** (noun) | reach; the limit of one's ability | *Ah, Juliet, I already know thy grief; It strains me past the compass of my wits: I hear thou must, and nothing may prorogue it, On Thursday next be married to this county.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **slander** (noun) | a false and damaging statement | *That is no slander, sir, which is a truth; And what I spake, I spake it to my face.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entreat** (verb) | ask earnestly | *My lord, we must entreat the time alone.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **behests** (noun) | commands | *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **gadding** (verb) | wandering about idly | *How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **reclaim** (verb) | bring back to obedience | *Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **wayward** (adjective) | disobedient | *Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. When is a risky plan worth trying?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What will Romeo do when Juliet wakes? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Take her to Mantua.
2. How long will the potion last? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Forty-two hours
3. Where will Juliet be taken? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Capulet vault
4. What will the Friar send? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A letter to Romeo

5. What does Juliet threaten? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: To kill herself
6. Who comes to the cell first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris tells the Friar of the wedding. Juliet arrives and fences verbally with him. Alone with the Friar, she threatens suicide; he gives her a potion that will make her seem dead for forty-two hours and promises to send for Romeo.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "My leisure serves me, pensive daughter, now." What does "pensive" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: pensive: thoughtful and sad.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does the Friar choose such a dangerous plan? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: He fears Juliet's suicide and sees no other way.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene I" suggest about the Friar's desperate plan? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The plan's complexity sets up its failure.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the plot in this scene shape what we understand about the Friar's desperate plan? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: "That is no slander, sir, which is a truth" (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On plot: The Friar's plan: a potion to make her seem dead for "two and forty hours." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Immoderately she weeps for Tybalt's death, And therefore have I little talk'd of love; For Venus smiles not in a house of tears.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Paris tells the Friar of the wedding. Juliet arrives and fences verbally with him. Alone with the Friar, she threatens suicide; he gives her a potion that will make her seem dead for forty-two hours and promises to send for Romeo.
7. How does "Act IV, Scene I" build on "Act III, Scene V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: "Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a

pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 31)): Juliet's courage. On characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When is a risky plan worth trying?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On foreshadowing: She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Should Juliet trust the Friar? Evaluate. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Weighing his past help and his plan's risks.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The plan's complexity sets up its failure.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 31)): Juliet's courage. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then

threatens suicide to the Friar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Friar's desperate plan. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 31)): Juliet's courage. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)): The potion's effect. On characterization: Juliet faces Paris with cool wordplay, then threatens suicide to the Friar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the Friar's desperate plan with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Give me, give me! O, tell not me of fear” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 31)): Juliet's courage. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's

plan demands. Useful evidence: “That is no slander, sir, which is a truth” (Act IV, Scene I, Juliet (speech 20)): Juliet's sharp answer to Paris. On foreshadowing: She would rather be shut in a charnel house than marry Paris. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Friar's desperate plan? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet takes control of her fate with courage the Friar's plan demands. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt continue two and forty hours, / And then awake as from a pleasant sleep” (Act IV, Scene I, Friar Laurence (speech 30)): The potion's effect. Theme link: Juliet chooses a terrifying plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

### *Chapter quiz*

1. How long will the potion last?
    A. Forty-two hours
    B. One day
    C. One hour
    D. Three days
2. Where will Juliet be taken?
    A. The church
    B. The Friar's cell
    C. Mantua
    D. The Capulet vault
3. What will the Friar send?
    A. Money
    B. Guards
    C. Balthasar
    D. A letter to Romeo
4. What does Juliet threaten?
    A. To kill herself
    B. To tell her father
    C. To marry Paris
    D. To run away

5. Who comes to the cell first?
   A. Romeo
   B. Paris
   C. Capulet
   D. The Nurse
6. In the line “My leisure serves me, pensive daughter, now.”, what does “pensive” most nearly mean?
   A. a false and damaging statement
   B. ask earnestly
   C. thoughtful and sad
   D. reach; the limit of one's ability
7. In the line “Ah, Juliet, I already know thy grief; It strains me past the compass of my wits: I hear thou must, and nothing may prorogue it, On Thursday next be married to this county.”, what does “compass” most nearly mean?
   A. ask earnestly
   B. reach; the limit of one's ability
   C. a false and damaging statement
   D. thoughtful and sad

**Answer key:** 1. A (Forty-two hours); 2. D (The Capulet vault); 3. D (A letter to Romeo); 4. A (To kill herself); 5. B (Paris); 6. C (thoughtful and sad); 7. B (reach; the limit of one's ability)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the Friar's desperate plan? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the Friar's desperate plan? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the Friar's desperate plan. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the Friar's desperate plan. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the Friar's desperate plan. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the Friar's desperate plan. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Friar's desperate plan responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Friar's desperate plan follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the Friar's desperate plan. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the Friar's desperate plan in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Friar's desperate plan. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

## *SAT-style questions*

1. *That is no slander, sir, which is a truth; And what I spake, I spake it to my face.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “slander” most nearly mean?

   A. disobedient

   B. bring back to obedience

   C. wandering about idly

   D. a false and damaging statement

2. *Immoderately she weeps for Tybalt's death, And therefore have I little talk'd of love; For Venus smiles not in a house of tears. Now, sir, her father counts it dangerous That she doth give her sorrow so much sway, And in his wisdom hastes our marriage, To stop the inundation of her tears; Which, too much minded by herself alone, May be put from her by society: Now do you know the reason of this haste.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

A. The Friar's desperate plan

B. Juliet waits for the Nurse

C. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

D. The divided world of Verona

**SAT key:** 1. D (a false and damaging statement); 2. A (The Friar's desperate plan)

# Lesson 22: Act IV, Scene II

**Focus:** Juliet's feigned obedience

Teacher only · spoilers

Capulet is busy preparing the wedding. Juliet returns and says she repents; Capulet moves the wedding to Wednesday.

**Background:** Wedding feasts required much preparation.

**Significance:** The time shift endangers the plan.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What happens when plans change suddenly? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....*
**Prompt:** What happens when plans change suddenly?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: one day lost will prove fatal.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: behests — commands; gadding — wandering about idly; reclaim — bring back to obedience; wayward — disobedient; prostrate — lying face down in submission.*
**Words:** behests: commands · gadding: wandering about idly · reclaim: bring back to obedience · wayward: disobedient · prostrate: lying face down in submission

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Wedding feasts required much preparation. The time shift endangers the plan. Irony: Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday. Characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Plot: The wedding change shortens the time for the Friar's letter. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "We shall be short in our provision: / 'Tis now near night" (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Capulet (speech 17)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)). Capulet's greeting. That is irony at work: Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday.*

> *How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding* (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)). Capulet's greeting. That is irony at work: Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet's feigned repentance. Look at the craft: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: One day lost will prove fatal. (Juliet's feigned repentance.)*

> *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition* (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Juliet's feigned repentance. Look at the craft: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to time and haste?
**Expected answer:** One day lost will prove fatal. (Juliet's feigned repentance.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. When the text says "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition" (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)), it shows this directly. She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. When the text says "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition" (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)), it shows this directly. She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What happens when plans change suddenly? Is Juliet's deception justified?*
**Anchor question:** What happens when plans change suddenly?
**Facilitation:** Is Juliet's deception justified?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. ("Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition", Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. ("Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition", Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how irony shapes Juliet's feigned obedience. Key takeaway: one day lost will prove fatal.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Irony:** Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday.
- **Characterization:** Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast.
- **Plot:** The wedding change shortens the time for the Friar's letter.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **time and haste:** one day lost will prove fatal.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “We shall be short in our provision: / ’Tis now near night” (Act IV, Scene II, Lady Capulet (speech 17)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “tell him of this: / I’ll have this knot knit up to-morrow morning” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 11)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)) Capulet's greeting.
- “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)) Juliet's feigned repentance.
- “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 16)) The wedding moved up.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger.
**Evidence:** “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10))
**Reasoning:** She claims to "repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition," and Capulet, delighted, announces "We'll to church to-morrow," a day sooner.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **behests** (noun) | commands | *Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin’d By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **gadding** (verb) | wandering about idly | *How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding?* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **reclaim** (verb) | bring back to obedience | *Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **wayward** (adjective) | disobedient | *Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **prostrate** (adjective) | lying face down in submission | *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | beg; ask earnestly | *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **forefather** (noun) | ancestor | *And madly play with my forefather's joints?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **methinks** (verb) | it seems to me | *I fear it is: and yet, methinks, it should not, For he hath still been tried a holy man.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What happens when plans change suddenly?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who will Capulet tell of the change? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris.
2. What does Juliet claim? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: She repents
3. What does Capulet do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Moves the wedding up
4. Where has Juliet been? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At Friar Laurence's cell
5. How many cooks does Capulet want? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Twenty

6. What does Capulet call Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Headstrong
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Capulet is busy preparing the wedding. Juliet returns and says she repents; Capulet moves the wedding to Wednesday.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!" What does "behests" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: behests: commands.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why is moving the wedding fatal? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: It shortens the time for Romeo to receive the letter.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about Juliet's feigned obedience? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The time shift endangers the plan.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet's feigned obedience? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: "How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding" (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)): Capulet's greeting. On characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon,…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Capulet is busy preparing the wedding. Juliet returns and says she repents; Capulet moves the wedding to Wednesday.
7. How does "Act IV, Scene II" build on "Act IV, Scene I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: "Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition" (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 16)): The wedding moved up. On characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens when plans change suddenly?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does plot appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)): Capulet's greeting. On plot: The wedding change shortens the time for the Friar's letter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Juliet's lie justified? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Weighing deception against her situation.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The time shift endangers the plan.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 16)): The wedding moved up. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)): Capulet's greeting. On characterization: Capulet is overjoyed and busy with the feast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet's feigned obedience. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 16)): The wedding moved up. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 9)): Capulet's greeting. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)): Juliet's feigned repentance. On irony: Juliet pretends to submit; Capulet moves the wedding up to Wednesday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats Juliet's feigned obedience with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “we’ll to church to-morrow” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet (speech 16)): The wedding moved up. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding” (Act IV, Scene II, Capulet

(speech 9)): Capulet's greeting. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet's feigned obedience? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's pretence of obedience accelerates the danger. Useful evidence: “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin / Of disobedient opposition” (Act IV, Scene II, Juliet (speech 10)): Juliet's feigned repentance. Theme link: one day lost will prove fatal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Juliet claim?
    A. She is ill
    B. She loves Paris
    C. She repents
    D. She wants to wait
2. What does Capulet do?
    A. Moves the wedding up
    B. Invites Romeo
    C. Leaves for Mantua
    D. Cancels it
3. Where has Juliet been?
    A. At church
    B. At Friar Laurence's cell
    C. In the orchard
    D. In Mantua
4. How many cooks does Capulet want?
    A. Twenty
    B. Two
    C. One
    D. Ten
5. What does Capulet call Juliet?
    A. Sweet

B. Wise

C. Gentle

D. Headstrong

6. In the line “Where I have learn’d me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin’d By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you!”, what does “behests” most nearly mean?

   A. disobedient

   B. commands

   C. wandering about idly

   D. bring back to obedience

7. In the line “How now, my headstrong! where have you been gadding?”, what does “gadding” most nearly mean?

   A. bring back to obedience

   B. wandering about idly

   C. disobedient

   D. commands

**Answer key:** 1. C (She repents); 2. A (Moves the wedding up); 3. B (At Friar Laurence's cell); 4. A (Twenty); 5. D (Headstrong); 6. B (commands); 7. B (wandering about idly)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet's feigned obedience? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Juliet's feigned obedience. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Juliet's feigned obedience. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about Juliet's feigned obedience. Lay out two plausible interpretations,

weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet's feigned obedience. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet's feigned obedience responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet's feigned obedience follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of Juliet's feigned obedience. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet's feigned obedience in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet's feigned obedience. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Well, I will walk myself To County Paris, to prepare him up Against to-morrow: my heart is wondrous light, Since this same wayward girl is so reclaim'd.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “reclaim” most nearly mean?

   A. it seems to me

   B. beg; ask earnestly

   C. ancestor

   D. bring back to obedience

2. *Where I have learn'd me to repent the sin Of disobedient opposition To you and your behests, and am enjoin'd By holy Laurence to fall prostrate here, And beg your pardon: pardon, I beseech you! Henceforward I am ever ruled by you.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene II"?

A. Capulet sets the wedding to Paris

B. Juliet's feigned obedience

C. Juliet drinks the potion

D. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

**SAT key:** 1. D (bring back to obedience); 2. B (Juliet's feigned obedience)

# Lesson 23: Act IV, Scene III

**Focus:** Juliet drinks the potion

Teacher only · spoilers

Juliet sends her mother and the Nurse away and, alone, imagines all that could go wrong: the potion might be poison, she might wake before Romeo, she might go mad among the bones. She drinks to Romeo.

**Background:** Family vaults held generations of bones; fear of being buried alive was common.

**Significance:** Juliet's courage peaks.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What gives people courage when they are afraid? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to death as bridegroom because....*
**Prompt:** What gives people courage when they are afraid?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to death as bridegroom because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: forefather — ancestor; methinks — it seems to me; mixture — a combination of different things; mangled — badly wounded or mutilated; kinsman — a male relative.*
**Words:** forefather: ancestor · methinks: it seems to me · mixture: a combination of different things · mangled: badly wounded or mutilated · kinsman: a male relative

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Family vaults held generations of bones; fear of being buried alive was common. Juliet's courage peaks. Characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Imagery: Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud." Structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "me now be left alone, / And let the nurse this night sit up with you; / For, I am sure, you have your" (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 3)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)). Doubt of the Friar. That is characterization at work: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks.*

> *What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead* (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister'd to have me dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)). Doubt of the Friar. That is characterization at work: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Juliet sees her action as a scene in a play she must perform alone. Expected link: fate and choice. Ask: How does this line connect to death as bridegroom? Expected: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. (Juliet's solitude.)*

> *My dismal scene I needs must act alone* (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Juliet sees her action as a scene in a play she must perform alone. Expected link: fate and choice.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to death as bridegroom?
**Expected answer:** Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. (Juliet's solitude.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet drinks the potion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. When the text says “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)), it shows this directly. She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet drinks the potion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. When the text says “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)), it shows this directly. She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What gives people courage when they are afraid? What are Juliet's fears? Rank them from most to least rational.*
**Anchor question:** What gives people courage when they are afraid?
**Facilitation:** What are Juliet's fears? Rank them from most to least rational.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. (“My dismal scene I needs must act alone”, Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. (“My dismal scene I needs must act alone”, Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Juliet drinks the potion. Key takeaway: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks.
- **Imagery:** Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud."
- **Structure:** A soliloquy of mounting fear.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **death as bridegroom:** Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “me now be left alone, / And let the nurse this night sit up with you; / For, I am sure, you have your” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 3)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “For I have need of many orisons / To move the heavens to smile upon my state, / Which, well thou know’st, is cross” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 1)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)) Juliet's solitude.
- “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)) Doubt of the Friar.
- “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)) Juliet drinks to Romeo.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes.
**Evidence:** “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5))
**Reasoning:** She knows "My dismal scene I needs must act alone," doubts "What if it be a poison," imagines the tomb, and still says "Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **forefather** (noun) | ancestor | *And madly play with my forefather's joints?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **methinks** (verb) | it seems to me | *I fear it is: and yet, methinks, it should not, For he hath still been tried a holy man.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mixture** (noun) | a combination of different things | *What if this mixture do not work at all?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mangled** (adjective) | badly wounded or mutilated | *And pluck the mangled Tybalt from his shroud?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **kinsman** (noun) | a male relative | *And, in this rage, with some great kinsman's bone, As with a club, dash out my desperate brains?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **fearful** (adjective) | full of fear; dreadful | *How if, when I am laid into the tomb, I wake before the time that Romeo Come to redeem me? there's a fearful point!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **quinces** (noun) | hard yellow fruits used in pastry | *They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bridegroom** (noun) | a man who has recently been married | *Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up; I'll go and chat with Paris: hie, make haste, Make haste; the bridegroom he is come already: Make haste, I say.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What gives people courage when they are afraid?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Why does Juliet keep a dagger? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: In case the potion fails.
2. What does Juliet keep by her? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A dagger
3. What does she fear the potion might be? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Poison
4. Whom does she imagine in the vault? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Tybalt
5. To whom does she drink? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo
6. Is anyone with her? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: No

7. Retell the three most important events of “Act IV, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Juliet sends her mother and the Nurse away and, alone, imagines all that could go wrong: the potion might be poison, she might wake before Romeo, she might go mad among the bones. She drinks to Romeo.
8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “And madly play with my forefather’s joints?” What does “forefather” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: forefather: ancestor.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. How does the soliloquy build tension? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Fears escalate toward madness.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene III” suggest about Juliet drinks the potion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet's courage peaks.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about Juliet drinks the potion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet's solitude. On imagery: Gothic images of bones, Tybalt "festering in his shroud." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Ay, those attires are best: but, gentle nurse, I pray thee, leave me to myself to-night; For I have need of many orisons To move the heavens to smile upon my state, Which, well…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet sends her mother and the Nurse away and, alone, imagines all that could go wrong: the potion might be poison, she might wake before Romeo, she might go mad among the bones. She drinks to Romeo.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Doubt of the Friar. On structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet drinks to Romeo. On characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What gives people courage when they are afraid?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet's solitude. On structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Juliet brave or reckless? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Judgment based on her reasoning.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Doubt of the Friar. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Juliet's courage peaks.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet drinks to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet's solitude. On characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Juliet drinks the potion. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Doubt of the Friar. On structure: A soliloquy of mounting fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet drinks to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet's solitude. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Doubt of the Friar. On characterization: Alone, Juliet imagines every horror of the tomb, then drinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats Juliet drinks the potion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “Romeo, I come! this do I drink to thee” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet drinks to Romeo. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “My dismal scene I needs must act alone” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Juliet's solitude. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Juliet drinks the potion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Juliet's soliloquy shows her courage by staging every fear she overcomes. Useful evidence: “What if it be a poison, which the friar / Subtly hath minister’d to have me dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Juliet (speech 5)): Doubt of the Friar. Theme link: Juliet drinks to Romeo as she enters a deathlike sleep. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Juliet keep by her?
    A. A dagger
    B. A ring
    C. A letter
    D. A rosary
2. What does she fear the potion might be?
    A. Poison
    B. Medicine
    C. Wine
    D. Water
3. Whom does she imagine in the vault?
    A. Tybalt
    B. Romeo
    C. Mercutio
    D. Paris
4. To whom does she drink?
    A. The Friar
    B. Paris
    C. Romeo

D. Her father

5. Is anyone with her?
   A. No
   B. The Nurse
   C. Her mother
   D. The Friar
6. In the line “And madly play with my forefather’s joints?”, what does “forefather” most nearly mean?
   A. a combination of different things
   B. it seems to me
   C. badly wounded or mutilated
   D. ancestor
7. In the line “I fear it is: and yet, methinks, it should not, For he hath still been tried a holy man.”, what does “methinks” most nearly mean?
   A. badly wounded or mutilated
   B. a combination of different things
   C. it seems to me
   D. ancestor

**Answer key:** 1. A (A dagger); 2. A (Poison); 3. A (Tybalt); 4. C (Romeo); 5. A (No); 6. D (ancestor); 7. C (it seems to me)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Juliet drinks the potion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Juliet drinks the potion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of Juliet drinks the potion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Juliet drinks the potion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about Juliet drinks the potion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Juliet drinks the potion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Juliet drinks the potion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Juliet drinks the potion follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of Juliet drinks the potion. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Juliet drinks the potion in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Juliet drinks the potion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *What if this mixture do not work at all?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “mixture” most nearly mean?

   A. a man who has recently been married

   B. a combination of different things

   C. full of fear; dreadful

   D. hard yellow fruits used in pastry

2. *Ay, those attires are best: but, gentle nurse, I pray thee, leave me to myself to-night; For I have need of many orisons To move the heavens to smile upon my state, Which, well thou know'st, is cross and full of sin.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene III"?

A. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

B. Wit, the Nurse and the wedding plan

C. Juliet drinks the potion

D. Juliet waits for the Nurse

**SAT key:** 1. B (a combination of different things); 2. C (Juliet drinks the potion)

# Lesson 24: Act IV, Scene IV

**Focus:** wedding preparations

Teacher only · spoilers

At dawn the Capulet household bustles. Capulet jokes with servants and sends the Nurse to wake Juliet.

**Background:** Servants prepared feasts through the night.

**Significance:** The calm before discovery.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to time and haste because....*
**Prompt:** Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to time and haste because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: quinces — hard yellow fruits used in pastry; bridegroom — a man who has recently been married; crotchets — whims; also quarter notes in music; confusions — disasters; chaos; rosemary — an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals.*
**Words:** quinces: hard yellow fruits used in pastry · bridegroom: a man who has recently been married · crotchets: whims; also quarter notes in music · confusions: disasters; chaos · rosemary: an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Servants prepared feasts through the night. The calm before discovery. Irony: The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead." Characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "you to bed; faith, You'll be sick to-morrow / For this night's watching" (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 4)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)). Household detail. That is irony at work: The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead."*

> *They call for dates and quinces in the pastry* (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)). Household detail. That is irony at work: The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead."

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The audience knows Juliet will not wake, which makes Capulet's joy painful. Expected link: dramatic irony. Ask: How does this line connect to time and haste? Expected: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. (Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.)*

> *Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up* (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The audience knows Juliet will not wake, which makes Capulet's joy painful. Expected link: dramatic irony.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to time and haste?
**Expected answer:** "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. (Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about wedding preparations? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene IV develops the idea of wedding preparations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. When the text says “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)), it shows this directly. The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about wedding preparations? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene IV develops the idea of wedding preparations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. When the text says “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)), it shows this directly. The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy? Why include a comic scene here?*
**Anchor question:** Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?
**Facilitation:** Why include a comic scene here?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about wedding preparations? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. (“Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up”, Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about wedding preparations? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. (“Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up”, Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how irony shapes wedding preparations. Key takeaway: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Irony:** The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead."
- **Characterization:** Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy.
- **Structure:** A short comic scene before tragedy.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **time and haste:** "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow / For this night’s watching” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 4)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: “cot-quean, go, / Get you to bed; faith, You’ll be sick to-morrow / For this night’s watching” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 4)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)) Household detail.
- “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)) Haste again.
- “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)) Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene.
**Evidence:** “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11))
**Reasoning:** The servants hear "Make haste, I say" and Capulet orders "Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up," while the audience knows she lies drugged.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **quinces** (noun) | hard yellow fruits used in pastry | *They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bridegroom** (noun) | a man who has recently been married | *Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up; I'll go and chat with Paris: hie, make haste, Make haste; the bridegroom he is come already: Make haste, I say.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **crotchets** (noun) | whims; also quarter notes in music | *I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **confusions** (noun) | disasters; chaos | *Peace, ho, for shame! confusion's cure lives not In these confusions.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **rosemary** (noun) | an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals | *Dry up your tears, and stick your rosemary On this fair corse; and, as the custom is, In all her best array bear her to church: For though fond nature bids us all lament, Yet nature's tears are reason's merriment.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beguiled** (verb) | cheated; tricked | *Most detestable death, by thee beguiled, By cruel cruel thee quite overthrown!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **solemnity** (noun) | a trait of dignified seriousness | *Uncomfortable time, why camest thou now To murder, murder our solemnity?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **forerun** (verb) | come before; anticipate | *O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with violence and the feud?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What does Capulet send for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Drier logs.
2. What fruit is called for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Dates and quinces
3. Who is sent to wake Juliet? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Nurse
4. What time is it? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Early morning

5. What is Capulet's mood? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Cheerful and busy
6. Who is coming with music? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: At dawn the Capulet household bustles. Capulet jokes with servants and sends the Nurse to wake Juliet.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "They call for dates and quinces in the pastry." What does "quinces" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: quinces: hard yellow fruits used in pastry.

### Inferential / analytical

1. What is ironic about the joy? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Juliet lies seemingly dead upstairs.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene IV" suggest about wedding preparations? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The calm before discovery.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about wedding preparations? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: "They call for dates and quinces in the pastry" (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)): Household detail. On characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Mass, and well said; a merry whoreson, ha!", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: At dawn the Capulet household bustles. Capulet jokes with servants and sends the Nurse to wake Juliet.
7. How does "Act IV, Scene IV" build on "Act IV, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: "Make haste, I say" (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Haste again. On structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. On characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer insert comedy before tragedy?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with violence and the feud? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)): Household detail. On structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Does this scene deepen or delay the tragedy? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation of pacing.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Haste again. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The calm before discovery.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)): Household detail. On characterization: Capulet jokes with servants, busy and happy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of wedding preparations. [DOK 4 ·

thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Haste again. On structure: A short comic scene before tragedy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to youth and age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)): Household detail. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Haste again. On irony: The household bustles with wedding preparations while Juliet lies "dead." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene IV” treats wedding preparations with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Capulet sends the Nurse to Juliet. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry” (Act IV, Scene IV, Nurse (speech 2)): Household detail. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about wedding preparations? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The comic bustle increases the dramatic irony of the next scene. Useful evidence: “Make haste, I say” (Act IV, Scene IV, speech (speech 11)): Haste again. Theme link: "Make haste, make haste" echoes through the house. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What fruit is called for?
    A. Dates and quinces
    B. Oranges
    C. Grapes
    D. Apples and pears
2. Who is sent to wake Juliet?
    A. Peter
    B. Paris
    C. The Nurse
    D. Lady Capulet
3. What time is it?
    A. Midnight
    B. Evening
    C. Early morning
    D. Noon
4. What is Capulet's mood?
    A. Fearful
    B. Sad
    C. Cheerful and busy
    D. Angry
5. Who is coming with music?
    A. The Prince
    B. Romeo

C. Tybalt

D. Paris

6. In the line “They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.”, what does “quinces” most nearly mean?

A. a man who has recently been married

B. disasters; chaos

C. whims; also quarter notes in music

D. hard yellow fruits used in pastry

7. In the line “Go waken Juliet, go and trim her up; I’ll go and chat with Paris: hie, make haste, Make haste; the bridegroom he is come already: Make haste, I say.”, what does “bridegroom” most nearly mean?

A. a man who has recently been married

B. hard yellow fruits used in pastry

C. disasters; chaos

D. whims; also quarter notes in music

**Answer key:** 1. A (Dates and quinces); 2. C (The Nurse); 3. C (Early morning); 4. C (Cheerful and busy); 5. D (Paris); 6. D (hard yellow fruits used in pastry); 7. A (a man who has recently been married)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show wedding preparations? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act IV, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of wedding preparations? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act IV, Scene IV develops the idea of wedding preparations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of wedding preparations. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene IV suggests about wedding preparations. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of wedding preparations. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of wedding preparations responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of wedding preparations follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene IV and its treatment of wedding preparations. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about wedding preparations in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of wedding preparations. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

## *SAT-style questions*

1. *I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "crotchets" most nearly mean?

   A. a trait of dignified seriousness

   B. come before; anticipate

   C. whims; also quarter notes in music

   D. cheated; tricked

2. *Mass, and well said; a merry whoreson, ha! Thou shalt be logger-head. Good faith, 'tis day: The county will be here with music straight, For so he said he would: I hear him near. Music within. Nurse! Wife! What, ho! What, nurse, I say!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene IV"?

   A. Juliet waits for the Nurse

   B. Juliet hears the news

C. The divided world of Verona

D. Wedding preparations

**SAT key:** 1. C (whims; also quarter notes in music); 2. D (Wedding preparations)

# Lesson 25: Act IV, Scene V

**Focus:** the household mourns

Teacher only · spoilers

The Nurse finds Juliet apparently dead. The family and Paris lament. The Friar urges them to carry her to church. Musicians joke with Peter.

**Background:** Funeral rites included rosemary and flowers.

**Significance:** Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do people express grief differently? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to death as bridegroom because....*
**Prompt:** How do people express grief differently?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to death as bridegroom because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: crotchets — whims; also quarter notes in music; confusions — disasters; chaos; rosemary — an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals; beguiled — cheated; tricked; solemnity — a trait of dignified seriousness.*
**Words:** crotchets: whims; also quarter notes in music · confusions: disasters; chaos · rosemary: an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals · beguiled: cheated; tricked · solemnity: a trait of dignified seriousness

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Funeral rites included rosemary and flowers. Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom. Imagery: Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law." Characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "your pennyworths now; / Sleep for a week; for the next night, I warrant, / The County Paris hath set up his rest, / That" (Act IV, Scene V, Nurse (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)). Capulet's lament. That is imagery at work: Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law."*

> *Death lies on her like an untimely frost* (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)). Capulet's lament. That is imagery at work: Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law."

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Every wedding item is used for a funeral instead. Expected link: death as bridegroom. Ask: How does this line connect to death as bridegroom? Expected: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. (Death as bridegroom.)*

> *Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir* (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Every wedding item is used for a funeral instead. Expected link: death as bridegroom.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to death as bridegroom?
**Expected answer:** Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. (Death as bridegroom.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene V develops the idea of the household mourns. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. When the text says "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)), it shows this directly. Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene V develops the idea of the household mourns. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. When the text says "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)), it shows this directly. Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How do people express grief differently? Are the family's grief and the Friar's speech sincere? How should it be staged?*
**Anchor question:** How do people express grief differently?
**Facilitation:** Are the family's grief and the Friar's speech sincere? How should it be staged?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. ("All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral", Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the household mourns? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. ("All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral", Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes the household mourns. Key takeaway: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Imagery:** Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law."
- **Characterization:** The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge.
- **Structure:** The musicians' jokes after the laments.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **death as bridegroom:** Capulet's image makes the motif explicit.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “your pennyworths now; / Sleep for a week; for the next night, I warrant, / The County Paris hath set up his rest, / That” (Act IV, Scene V, Nurse (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “ho, for shame! confusion’s cure lives not / In these confusions. Heaven and yourself / Had part in this fair maid; now heaven hath” (Act IV, Scene V, Friar Laurence (speech 21)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)) Capulet's lament.
- “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15)) Death as bridegroom.
- “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)) Wedding turns to funeral.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action.
**Evidence:** “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22))
**Reasoning:** Capulet says "Death is my son-in-law" and "All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | | In context | |
|---|---|---|---|

| | Definition (in this sentence) | | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **crotchets** (noun) | whims; also quarter notes in music | *I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **confusions** (noun) | disasters; chaos | *Peace, ho, for shame! confusion's cure lives not In these confusions.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **rosemary** (noun) | an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals | *Dry up your tears, and stick your rosemary On this fair corse; and, as the custom is, In all her best array bear her to church: For though fond nature bids us all lament, Yet nature's tears are reason's merriment.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beguiled** (verb) | cheated; tricked | *Most detestable death, by thee beguiled, By cruel cruel thee quite overthrown!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **solemnity** (noun) | a trait of dignified seriousness | *Uncomfortable time, why camest thou now To murder, murder our solemnity?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **forerun** (verb) | come before; anticipate | *O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **compounds** (noun) | mixtures; drugs | *There is thy gold, worse poison to men's souls, Doing more murders in this loathsome world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **presage** (verb) | foretell | *If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How do people express grief differently?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with youth and age?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What herb does the Friar mention? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Rosemary.
2. Who finds Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Nurse
3. What does Capulet call Death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: His son-in-law
4. What does the Friar urge? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Take her to church
5. Who jokes afterward? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The musicians and Peter
6. What turns into funeral items? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Wedding preparations
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The Nurse finds Juliet apparently dead. The family and Paris lament. The Friar urges them to carry her to church. Musicians joke with Peter.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I will carry no crotchets: I'll re you, I'll fa you; do you note me?" What does "crotchets" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: crotchets: whims; also quarter notes in music.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Is the Friar's speech hypocritical? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: He consoles grief he knows is unnecessary.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene V" suggest about the household mourns? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the household mourns? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: "Death lies on her like an untimely frost" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)): Capulet's lament. On characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Despised, distressed, hated, martyr'd, kill'd!", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene V", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The Nurse finds Juliet apparently dead. The family and Paris lament. The Friar urges them to carry her to church. Musicians joke with Peter.

7. How does “Act IV, Scene V” build on “Act IV, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15)): Death as bridegroom. On structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)): Wedding turns to funeral. On characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people express grief differently?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with youth and age? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)): Capulet's lament. On structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Why include comic musicians? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Relief and realism.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15)): Death as bridegroom. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Death becomes Juliet's bridegroom.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)): Wedding turns to funeral. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language

and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)): Capulet's lament. On characterization: The family's laments; the Friar's consoling speech hides his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the household mourns. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15)): Death as bridegroom. On structure: The musicians' jokes after the laments. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)): Wedding turns to funeral. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to time and haste: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death lies on her like an untimely frost” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)): Capulet's lament. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15)): Death as bridegroom. On imagery: Death as Juliet's bridegroom: "Death is my son-in-law." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene V” treats the household mourns with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: “All things that we ordained festival, / Turn from their office to black funeral” (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 22)): Wedding turns to funeral. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act V, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: "Death lies on her like an untimely frost" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 10)): Capulet's lament. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the household mourns? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The scene turns the wedding into a funeral in language and action. Useful evidence: "Death is my son-in-law, Death is my heir" (Act IV, Scene V, Capulet (speech 15)): Death as bridegroom. Theme link: Capulet's image makes the motif explicit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who finds Juliet?
   A. The Friar
   B. Capulet
   C. Paris
   D. The Nurse
2. What does Capulet call Death?
   A. A thief
   B. A friend
   C. His enemy
   D. His son-in-law
3. What does the Friar urge?
   A. Tell Romeo
   B. Take her to church
   C. Wait
   D. Call a doctor
4. Who jokes afterward?
   A. Capulet
   B. Paris
   C. The musicians and Peter

D. Tybalt

5. What turns into funeral items?
   A. Wedding preparations
   B. Letters
   C. Feasts
   D. Swords
6. In the line “I will carry no crotchets: I’ll re you, I’ll fa you; do you note me?”, what does “crotchets” most nearly mean?
   A. disasters; chaos
   B. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals
   C. cheated; tricked
   D. whims; also quarter notes in music
7. In the line “Peace, ho, for shame! confusion’s cure lives not In these confusions.”, what does “confusions” most nearly mean?
   A. disasters; chaos
   B. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals
   C. cheated; tricked
   D. whims; also quarter notes in music

**Answer key:** 1. D (The Nurse); 2. D (His son-in-law); 3. B (Take her to church); 4. C (The musicians and Peter); 5. A (Wedding preparations); 6. D (whims; also quarter notes in music); 7. A (disasters; chaos)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show the household mourns? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act IV, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the household mourns? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act IV, Scene V develops the idea of the household mourns. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the household mourns. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene V suggests about the household mourns. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act IV, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of the household mourns. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the household mourns responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the household mourns follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene V and its treatment of the household mourns. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about the household mourns in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the household mourns. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Dry up your tears, and stick your rosemary On this fair corse; and, as the custom is, In all her best array bear her to church: For though fond nature bids us all lament, Yet nature's tears are reason's merriment.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "rosemary" most nearly mean?

   A. an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals

   B. foretell

   C. mixtures; drugs

   D. come before; anticipate

2. *Despised, distressed, hated, martyr'd, kill'd! Uncomfortable time, why camest thou now To murder, murder our solemnity? O child! O child! my soul, and not my child! Dead art thou! Alack! my child is dead; And with my child my joys are buried.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene V"?

A. Juliet, her mother and the Nurse

B. The street brawl and lovesick Romeo

C. Queen Mab and Romeo's premonition

D. The household mourns

**SAT key:** 1. A (an herb symbolizing remembrance, used at weddings and funerals); 2. D (The household mourns)

# Lesson 26: Act V, Scene I

**Focus:** Romeo hears of Juliet's death

Teacher only · spoilers

In Mantua Romeo dreams happily. Balthasar arrives saying Juliet is dead. Romeo resolves to die beside her and buys poison from a poor apothecary.

**Background:** Selling poison was illegal and punishable by death.

**Significance:** Romeo acts instantly.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What is the danger of acting on first news? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because....*
**Prompt:** What is the danger of acting on first news?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: forerun — come before; anticipate; compounds — mixtures; drugs; presage — foretell; dispatch — kill quickly; cordial — a reviving drink; medicine for the heart.*
**Words:** forerun: come before; anticipate · compounds: mixtures; drugs · presage: foretell · dispatch: kill quickly · cordial: a reviving drink; medicine for the heart

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Selling poison was illegal and punishable by death. Romeo acts instantly. Dramatic irony: Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead. Characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Imagery: The apothecary's shop of poverty. Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; / And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit / Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 1)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Is it even so? then I defy you, stars" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)). Romeo's defiance. That is dramatic irony at work: Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead.*

> *Is it even so? then I defy you, stars* (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Is it even so? then I defy you, stars" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)). Romeo's defiance. That is dramatic irony at work: Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Romeo means he will challenge fate itself. Expected link: fate and choice. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. (Romeo resolves to die.)*

> *Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night* (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Romeo means he will challenge fate itself. Expected link: fate and choice.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to fate and choice?
**Expected answer:** Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. (Romeo resolves to die.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. When the text says "Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)), it shows this directly. He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. When the text says "Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)), it shows this directly. He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What is the danger of acting on first news? Is the apothecary guilty? What does his line about poverty show?*
**Anchor question:** What is the danger of acting on first news?
**Facilitation:** Is the apothecary guilty? What does his line about poverty show?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. ("Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night", Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. ("Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night", Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Key takeaway: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Dramatic irony:** Romeo dreams that Juliet found him dead and revived him; then hears she is dead.
- **Characterization:** Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!"
- **Imagery:** The apothecary's shop of poverty.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **fate and choice:** Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “bosom’s lord sits lightly in his throne; / And all this day an unaccustom’d spirit / Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 1)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars! / Thou know’st my lodging: get me ink and paper, / And hire” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)) Romeo's defiance.
- “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)) Romeo resolves to die.
- “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary (speech 12)) The apothecary's excuse.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

> **Claim:** Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it.
> **Evidence:** “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7))
> **Reasoning:** He cries "then I defy you, stars!" and resolves "Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night," buying poison from a man whose "poverty, but not my will, consents."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **forerun** (verb) | come before; anticipate | *O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **compounds** (noun) | mixtures; drugs | *There is thy gold, worse poison to men's souls, Doing more murders in this loathsome world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **presage** (verb) | foretell | *If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dispatch** (verb) | kill quickly | *Put this in any liquid thing you will, And drink it off; and, if you had the strength Of twenty men, it would dispatch you straight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cordial** (noun) | a reviving drink; medicine for the heart | *Come, cordial and not poison, go with me To Juliet's grave; for there must I use thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | beg; ask earnestly | *I do beseech you, sir, have patience: Your looks are pale and wild, and do import Some misadventure.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **revived** (verb) | came back to life; returned | *I dreamt my lady came and found me dead— Strange dream, that gives a dead man leave to think!— And breathed such life with kisses in my lips, That I revived, and was an emperor.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **fearful** (adjective) | full of fear; dreadful | *I could not send it—here it is again— Nor get a messenger to bring it thee, So fearful were they of infection.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What is the danger of acting on first news?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with time and haste?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What is the apothecary's shop like? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Poor and bare.

2. Who brings the news? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Balthasar
3. What does Romeo buy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Poison
4. Why does the apothecary sell? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Poverty
5. What does Romeo say to the stars? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: I defy you
6. What did Romeo dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Juliet revived him with kisses
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: In Mantua Romeo dreams happily. Balthasar arrives saying Juliet is dead. Romeo resolves to die beside her and buys poison from a poor apothecary.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me." What does "forerun" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: forerun: come before; anticipate.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Romeo call gold worse poison? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Money corrupts more than drugs.
2. What does "Act V, Scene I" suggest about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Romeo acts instantly.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: "Is it even so? then I defy you, stars" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)): Romeo's defiance. On characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: In Mantua Romeo dreams happily. Balthasar arrives saying Juliet is dead. Romeo resolves to die beside her and buys poison from a poor apothecary.
7. How does "Act V, Scene I" build on "Act IV, Scene V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: "Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night" (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)): Romeo resolves to

die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary (speech 12)): The apothecary's excuse. On characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is the danger of acting on first news?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with time and haste? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)): Romeo's defiance. On imagery: The apothecary's shop of poverty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Was Romeo's decision avoidable? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Weighing haste and information.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Romeo acts instantly.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary (speech 12)): The apothecary's excuse. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)): Romeo's defiance. On characterization: Romeo's decision is instant: "Then I defy you, stars!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary (speech 12)): The apothecary's excuse. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to love and desire: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)): Romeo's defiance. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats Romeo hears of Juliet's death with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “My poverty, but not my will, consents” (Act V, Scene I, Apothecary (speech 12)): The apothecary's excuse. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Is it even so? then I defy you, stars” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 3)): Romeo's defiance.

Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Romeo hears of Juliet's death? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Romeo's defiance of fate leads him to fulfil it. Useful evidence: “Well, Juliet, I will lie with thee to-night” (Act V, Scene I, Romeo (speech 7)): Romeo resolves to die. Theme link: Romeo defies the stars, but in doing so fulfils the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who brings the news?
    A. Paris
    B. The Nurse
    C. Balthasar
    D. Friar John
2. What does Romeo buy?
    A. Poison
    B. A letter
    C. A horse
    D. A sword
3. Why does the apothecary sell?
    A. Poverty
    B. Fear
    C. Greed alone
    D. Friendship
4. What does Romeo say to the stars?
    A. I thank you
    B. Guide me
    C. Forgive me
    D. I defy you
5. What did Romeo dream?
    A. Juliet revived him with kisses
    B. He was banished

C. He was king

D. He fought Tybalt

6. In the line “O, this same thought did but forerun my need; And this same needy man must sell it me.”, what does “forerun” most nearly mean?

A. foretell

B. kill quickly

C. mixtures; drugs

D. come before; anticipate

7. In the line “There is thy gold, worse poison to men’s souls, Doing more murders in this loathsome world, Than these poor compounds that thou mayst not sell.”, what does “compounds” most nearly mean?

A. foretell

B. kill quickly

C. come before; anticipate

D. mixtures; drugs

**Answer key:** 1. C (Balthasar); 2. A (Poison); 3. A (Poverty); 4. D (I defy you); 5. A (Juliet revived him with kisses); 6. D (come before; anticipate); 7. D (mixtures; drugs)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Romeo hears of Juliet's death? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Romeo hears of Juliet's death responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Romeo hears of Juliet's death follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Romeo hears of Juliet's death in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Romeo hears of Juliet's death. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "presage" most nearly mean?

   A. foretell

   B. came back to life; returned

   C. full of fear; dreadful

   D. beg; ask earnestly

2. *If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep, My dreams presage some joyful news at hand: My bosom's lord sits lightly in his throne; And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit Lifts me above the ground with cheerful thoughts. I dreamt my lady came and found me dead— Strange dream, that gives a dead man leave to think!*

> *— And breathed such life with kisses in my lips, That I revived, and was an emperor. Ah me! how sweet is love itself possess'd, When but love's shadows are so rich in joy!*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

A. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

B. The balcony scene

C. Juliet drinks the potion

D. Paris's suit and the Capulet invitation

**SAT key:** 1. A (foretell); 2. A (Romeo hears of Juliet's death)

# Lesson 27: Act V, Scene II

**Focus:** the undelivered letter

Teacher only · spoilers

Friar John tells Friar Laurence that he was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Friar Laurence hurries to the tomb.

**Background:** Plague quarantines sealed houses.

**Significance:** Chance undoes the plan.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How do small accidents change big outcomes? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because....*
**Prompt:** How do small accidents change big outcomes?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: accident and plague intervene.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: fearful — full of fear; dreadful; conjurations — solemn appeals; timeless — untimely; premature; conspires — plots; works together; startles — bursts out in alarm.*
**Words:** fearful: full of fear; dreadful · conjurations: solemn appeals · timeless: untimely; premature · conspires: plots; works together · startles: bursts out in alarm

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Plague quarantines sealed houses. Chance undoes the plan. Plot: Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Irony: A plague, not a person, stops the message. Characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Watch for fate and the stars: From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, / The letter was not nice but full of" (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 6)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)). The quarantine. That is plot at work: Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter.*

> *Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors* (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)). The quarantine. That is plot at work: Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The letter returned. Look at the craft: A plague, not a person, stops the message. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: Accident and plague intervene. (The letter returned.)*

> *I could not send it—here it is again* (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The letter returned. Look at the craft: A plague, not a person, stops the message.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to fate and choice?
**Expected answer:** Accident and plague intervene. (The letter returned.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the undelivered letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the undelivered letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. When the text says "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)), it shows this directly. Friar John's house was sealed "Where the infectious pestilence did reign," and he says "I could not send it—here it is again."*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the undelivered letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the undelivered letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. When the text says "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)), it shows this directly. Friar John's house was sealed "Where the infectious pestilence did reign," and he says "I could not send it—here it is again."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How do small accidents change big outcomes? Does chance excuse the Friar?*
**Anchor question:** How do small accidents change big outcomes?
**Facilitation:** Does chance excuse the Friar?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the undelivered letter? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. ("Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors", Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the undelivered letter? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. ("Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors", Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how plot shapes the undelivered letter. Key takeaway: accident and plague intervene.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Plot:** Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter.
- **Irony:** A plague, not a person, stops the message.
- **Characterization:** Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone.

### Themes and how they develop

- **fate and choice:** accident and plague intervene.

### Symbols and motifs

- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: "Unhappy fortune! by my brotherhood, / The letter was not nice but full of" (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 6)).
- **haste and time:** Everything happens too fast: a four-day action, a marriage the day after meeting, a wedding moved up a day; Friar Laurence warns "they stumble that run fast." In this scene: "doors, and would not let us forth; / So that my speed to Mantua there was stay'd" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)) The quarantine.
- "I could not send it—here it is again" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5)) The letter returned.
- "Poor living corse, closed in a dead man's tomb" (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 8)) The Friar's image of Juliet.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control.
**Evidence:** "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3))
**Reasoning:** Friar John's house was sealed "Where the infectious pestilence did reign," and he says "I could not send it —here it is again."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **fearful** (adjective) | full of fear; dreadful | *I could not send it—here it is again— Nor get a messenger to bring it thee, So fearful were they of infection.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conjurations** (noun) | solemn appeals | *I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **timeless** (adjective) | untimely; premature | *Poison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help me after?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conspires** (verb) | plots; works together | *Alas, my liege, my wife is dead to-night; Grief of my son's exile hath stopp'd her breath: What further woe conspires against mine age?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **startles** (verb) | bursts out in alarm | *What fear is this which startles in our ears?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mattock** (noun) | a digging tool like a pickaxe | *Enter Romeo and Balthasar, with a torch, mattock, etc.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **thwarted** (verb) | hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of | *Lady, come from that nest Of death, contagion, and unnatural sleep: A greater power than we can contradict Hath thwarted our intents.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **provoke** (verb) | call forth (emotions, feelings, and responses) | *Wilt thou provoke me? then have at thee, boy!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

*Discussion questions*

1. How do small accidents change big outcomes?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with love and desire?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What will the Friar do with Juliet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Keep her in his cell.
2. Why was the letter not delivered? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Plague quarantine
3. Who was to deliver it? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Friar John
4. Where does the Friar go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The tomb
5. How long until Juliet wakes? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Three hours
6. What tool does he ask for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: An iron crow
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Friar John tells Friar Laurence that he was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Friar Laurence hurries to the tomb.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I could not send it—here it is again— Nor get a messenger to bring it thee, So fearful were they of infection." What does "fearful" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: fearful: full of fear; dreadful.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why is the plague important? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Chance blocks communication.
2. What does "Act V, Scene II" suggest about the undelivered letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Chance undoes the plan.
3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about the undelivered letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: "Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal'd up the doors" (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)): The quarantine. On irony: A plague, not a person, stops the message. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Going to find a bare-foot brother out One of our order, to associate me, Here in this city visiting the sick, And finding him, the searchers of the town, Suspecting that we both…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Friar John tells Friar Laurence that he was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Friar Laurence hurries to the tomb.
7. How does “Act V, Scene II” build on “Act V, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5)): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 8)): The Friar's image of Juliet. On characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do small accidents change big outcomes?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with love and desire? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)): The quarantine. On characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the Friar culpable? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Judgment of his choices.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5)): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chance undoes the plan.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position

with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 8)): The Friar's image of Juliet. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)): The quarantine. On characterization: Friar Laurence's urgency and plan to go to the tomb alone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the undelivered letter. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5)): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 8)): The Friar's image of Juliet. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate and choice: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)): The quarantine. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5)): The letter returned. On plot: Friar John was quarantined and could not deliver the letter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the undelivered letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Poor living corse, closed in a dead man’s tomb” (Act V, Scene II, Friar Laurence (speech 8)): The Friar's image of Juliet. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “Where the infectious pestilence did reign, / Seal’d up the doors” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 3)): The quarantine. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the undelivered letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The tragedy turns on an accident outside anyone's control. Useful evidence: “I could not send it—here it is again” (Act V, Scene II, Friar John (speech 5)): The letter returned. Theme link: accident and plague intervene. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Why was the letter not delivered?
   A. Stolen
   B. Plague quarantine
   C. Forgotten
   D. Lost
2. Who was to deliver it?
   A. Balthasar
   B. The Nurse
   C. Friar John
   D. Peter
3. Where does the Friar go?
   A. The Prince

B. Capulet

C. The tomb

D. Mantua

4. How long until Juliet wakes?

A. Ten minutes

B. Three hours

C. One hour

D. A day

5. What tool does he ask for?

A. A rope

B. A torch only

C. A sword

D. An iron crow

6. In the line "I could not send it—here it is again— Nor get a messenger to bring it thee, So fearful were they of infection.", what does "fearful" most nearly mean?

A. solemn appeals

B. full of fear; dreadful

C. untimely; premature

D. plots; works together

7. In the line "I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here.", what does "conjurations" most nearly mean?

A. plots; works together

B. untimely; premature

C. solemn appeals

D. full of fear; dreadful

**Answer key:** 1. B (Plague quarantine); 2. C (Friar John); 3. C (The tomb); 4. B (Three hours); 5. D (An iron crow); 6. B (full of fear; dreadful); 7. C (solemn appeals)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the undelivered letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the undelivered letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the undelivered letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the undelivered letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the undelivered letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses plot in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the undelivered letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the undelivered letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the undelivered letter follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the undelivered letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the undelivered letter in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the undelivered letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

*SAT-style questions*

1. *Poison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help me after?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "timeless" most nearly mean?

   A. untimely; premature

   B. a digging tool like a pickaxe

   C. hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of

   D. call forth (emotions, feelings, and responses)

2. *Going to find a bare-foot brother out One of our order, to associate me, Here in this city visiting the sick, And finding him, the searchers of the town, Suspecting that we both were in a house Where the infectious pestilence did reign, Seal'd up the doors, and would not let us forth; So that my speed to Mantua there was stay'd.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. The undelivered letter

   B. Friar Laurence agrees to marry them

   C. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

   D. Juliet hears the news

**SAT key:** 1. A (untimely; premature); 2. A (The undelivered letter)

# Lesson 28: Act V, Scene III

**Focus:** the tomb

**Content note (suicide, death):** Romeo dies by poison and Juliet by a dagger; Paris is killed. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss the Prince's verdict and the waste of young lives, not methods.
**Student preview:** The ending shows three deaths, two by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "Who does the Prince say is responsible, and do you agree?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Paris mourns at the tomb; Romeo arrives, kills him, and drinks poison beside Juliet. The Friar arrives as Juliet wakes; she refuses to leave and stabs herself. The watch gathers; the Friar confesses; Montague and Capulet reconcile.

**Background:** Tombs were family vaults; the watch kept order.

**Significance:** The tragedy's resolution.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can tragedy bring peace? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and choice because.... Content note before we start: The ending shows three deaths, two by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** Can tragedy bring peace?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and choice because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: conjurations — solemn appeals; timeless — untimely; premature; conspires — plots; works together; startles — bursts out in alarm; mattock — a digging tool like a pickaxe.*
**Words:** conjurations: solemn appeals · timeless: untimely; premature · conspires: plots; works together · startles: bursts out in alarm · mattock: a digging tool like a pickaxe

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Tombs were family vaults; the watch kept order. The tragedy's resolution. Dramatic irony: Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks. Plot: Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile. Imagery: Light in the tomb: Juliet's beauty "makes / This vault a feasting presence full of light." Watch for light and dark: The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: "Enter Paris, and his Page bearing flowers and a torch" (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Thus with a kiss I die" (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)). Romeo's last words. That is dramatic irony at work: Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks.*

> *Thus with a kiss I die* (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15))

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Thus with a kiss I die" (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)). Romeo's last words. That is dramatic irony at work: Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Prince means the deaths are a punishment for their hate. Expected link: violence and the feud. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and choice? Expected: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." (The Prince blames the feud.)*

> *See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate* (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61))

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The Prince means the deaths are a punishment for their hate. Expected link: violence and the feud.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to fate and choice?
**Expected answer:** The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." (The Prince blames the feud.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the tomb. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. When the text says "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate" (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)), it shows this directly. After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."*
**Task:** Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the tomb. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. When the text says "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate" (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)), it shows this directly. After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Can tragedy bring peace? Does the reconciliation make the deaths meaningful?*
**Anchor question:** Can tragedy bring peace?
**Facilitation:** Does the reconciliation make the deaths meaningful?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. ("See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate", Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tomb? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. ("See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate", Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the tomb. Key takeaway: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Dramatic irony:** Romeo notices Juliet's colour returning yet still drinks.
- **Plot:** Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile.
- **Imagery:** Light in the tomb: Juliet's beauty "makes / This vault a feasting presence full of light."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **fate and choice:** The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd."

**Symbols and motifs**

- **light and dark:** The lovers describe each other as light in darkness (torches, sun, stars, lightning), yet they can meet only at night, and daylight brings danger. In this scene: “Enter Paris, and his Page bearing flowers and a torch” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).
- **fate and the stars:** From "star-cross'd" in the Prologue to Romeo's "I defy you, stars," the lovers feel steered by fortune, while the plot shows human choices and accidents. In this scene: “pry / In what I further shall intend to do, / By heaven, I will tear thee joint by joint / And strew this hungry” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 4)).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)) Romeo's last words.
- “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet (speech 33)) Juliet's death.
- “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)) The Prince blames the feud.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate.
**Evidence:** “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61))
**Reasoning:** After "Thus with a kiss I die" and "O happy dagger!" the Prince tells the fathers "See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **conjurations** (noun) | solemn appeals | *I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **timeless** (adjective) | untimely; premature | *Poison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help me after?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conspires** (verb) | plots; works together | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *Alas, my liege, my wife is dead to-night; Grief of my son's exile hath stopp'd her breath: What further woe conspires against mine age?* | |
| **startles** (verb) | bursts out in alarm | *What fear is this which startles in our ears?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mattock** (noun) | a digging tool like a pickaxe | *Enter Romeo and Balthasar, with a torch, mattock, etc.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **thwarted** (verb) | hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of | *Lady, come from that nest Of death, contagion, and unnatural sleep: A greater power than we can contradict Hath thwarted our intents.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **provoke** (verb) | call forth (emotions, feelings, and responses) | *Wilt thou provoke me? then have at thee, boy!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **interrupt** (verb) | to break in on; to stop | *Give me the light: upon thy life, I charge thee, Whate'er thou hear'st or seest, stand all aloof, And do not interrupt me in my course.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **triumphant** (adjective) | joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success | *I'll bury thee in a triumphant grave; A grave?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **discords** (noun) | harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels | *And I for winking at your discords too Have lost a brace of kinsmen: all are punish'd.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can tragedy bring peace?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and choice?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who has died besides the lovers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris and Lady Montague.
2. Who does Romeo kill at the tomb? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris
3. How does Romeo die? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Poison
4. How does Juliet die? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Romeo's dagger
5. What do the fathers promise? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Golden statues

6. Who confesses? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Friar Laurence
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Paris mourns at the tomb; Romeo arrives, kills him, and drinks poison beside Juliet. The Friar arrives as Juliet wakes; she refuses to leave and stabs herself. The watch gathers; the Friar confesses; Montague and Capulet reconcile.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here." What does "conjurations" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: conjurations: solemn appeals.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Juliet refuse to leave? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: She will not live without Romeo.
2. What does "Act V, Scene III" suggest about the tomb? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The tragedy's resolution.
3. Find one example of irony in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the plot in this scene shape what we understand about the tomb? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: "Thus with a kiss I die" (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)): Romeo's last words. On plot: Paris dies, Romeo dies, Juliet wakes and dies; the Friar confesses and the families reconcile. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "I hear some noise.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene III", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Paris mourns at the tomb; Romeo arrives, kills him, and drinks poison beside Juliet. The Friar arrives as Juliet wakes; she refuses to leave and stabs herself. The watch gathers; the Friar confesses; Montague and Capulet reconcile.
7. How does "Act V, Scene III" build on "Act V, Scene II"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: "O happy dagger … This is thy sheath" (Act V, Scene III, Juliet (speech 33)): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can tragedy bring peace?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate and choice? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)): Romeo's last words. On imagery: Light in the tomb: Juliet's beauty "makes / This vault a feasting presence full of light." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Who is most to blame? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A reasoned judgment.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet (speech 33)): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The tragedy's resolution.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)): Romeo's last words. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tomb. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s ·

CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet (speech 33)): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to violence and the feud: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)): Romeo's last words. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet (speech 33)): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats the tomb with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Romeo and Juliet see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “See, what a scourge is laid upon your hate” (Act V, Scene III, Prince (speech 61)): The Prince blames the feud. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve fate and choice? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “Thus with a kiss I die” (Act V, Scene III, Romeo (speech 15)): Romeo's last words. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tomb? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final scene assigns responsibility to the feud as well as to fate. Useful evidence: “O happy dagger … This is thy sheath” (Act V, Scene III, Juliet (speech 33)): Juliet's death. Theme link: The Prince blames the families: "all are punish'd." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who does Romeo kill at the tomb?
    A. Paris
    B. The Friar
    C. Balthasar
    D. Tybalt
2. How does Romeo die?
    A. Dagger
    B. Poison
    C. Sword
    D. Fall
3. How does Juliet die?
    A. Grief
    B. Romeo's dagger
    C. Poison
    D. A fall
4. What do the fathers promise?
    A. Golden statues
    B. Banishment
    C. A feast
    D. A duel
5. Who confesses?
    A. Friar Laurence
    B. Balthasar
    C. The Nurse
    D. Paris

6. In the line “I do defy thy conjurations, And apprehend thee for a felon here.”, what does “conjurations” most nearly mean?
   A. untimely; premature
   B. bursts out in alarm
   C. solemn appeals
   D. plots; works together
7. In the line “Poison, I see, hath been his timeless end: O churl! drunk all, and left no friendly drop To help me after?”, what does “timeless” most nearly mean?
   A. solemn appeals
   B. bursts out in alarm
   C. plots; works together
   D. untimely; premature

**Answer key:** 1. A (Paris); 2. B (Poison); 3. B (Romeo's dagger); 4. A (Golden statues); 5. A (Friar Laurence); 6. C (solemn appeals); 7. D (untimely; premature)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the tomb? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tomb? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the tomb. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the tomb. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about the tomb. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's

understanding of the tomb. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tomb responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tomb follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of the tomb. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the tomb in Romeo and Juliet. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tomb. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Romeo and Juliet.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Alas, my liege, my wife is dead to-night; Grief of my son’s exile hath stopp’d her breath: What further woe conspires against mine age?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “conspires” most nearly mean?

   A. harsh, clashing sounds; quarrels

   B. plots; works together

   C. to break in on; to stop

   D. joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success

2. *I hear some noise. Lady, come from that nest Of death, contagion, and unnatural sleep: A greater power than we can contradict Hath thwarted our intents. Come, come away. Thy husband in thy bosom there lies dead; And Paris too. Come, I’ll dispose of thee Among a sisterhood of holy nuns: Stay not to question, for the watch is coming; Come, go, good Juliet noise again, I dare no longer stay.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?

   A. Romeo hears of Juliet's death

   B. Juliet waits for the Nurse

C. The tomb

D. Juliet's feigned obedience

**SAT key:** 1. B (plots; works together); 2. C (The tomb)

# Whole-book test

**Romeo and Juliet: whole-book test** · 90 minutes

## Part I: Multiple choice

1. Who is the prince of Verona?
   A. Capulet
   B. Mercutio
   C. Paris
   D. Escalus
2. What form does the Prologue take?
   A. A song in prose
   B. A ballad
   C. A sonnet
   D. A letter
3. Which house do Sampson and Gregory serve?
   A. Paris
   B. Montague
   C. Capulet
   D. The Prince
4. What does Capulet say about Juliet's age?
   A. She is twelve
   B. She is eighteen
   C. She is sixteen
   D. She is not yet fourteen
5. How old is Juliet?
   A. Sixteen
   B. Not yet fourteen
   C. Eighteen
   D. Twelve
6. What are the friends going to?
   A. Mantua
   B. The Capulet feast
   C. A duel
   D. Church
7. What does Romeo compare Juliet to?
   A. A red rose

B. A song

C. A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches

D. The moon

8. What does the Chorus say has died?

A. Old desire

B. Tybalt

C. Romeo's father

D. The feud

9. Where does Romeo hide?

A. In Mantua

B. In the Capulet orchard

C. At home

D. In church

10. What does Romeo call Juliet?

A. A rose

B. The moon

C. The sun

D. A star

11. What is the Friar gathering?

A. Letters

B. Firewood

C. Money

D. Herbs and flowers

12. What has Tybalt sent Romeo?

A. A challenge

B. A gift

C. An apology

D. A warning from the Prince

13. How long has the Nurse been away?

A. Ten minutes

B. One hour

C. Three hours

D. A day

14. What does the Friar warn?

A. Love conquers all

B. Marry in haste

C. Violent delights have violent ends

D. Time is short

15. Why does Romeo refuse to fight Tybalt?
    A. The Prince is watching
    B. He is afraid
    C. He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage
    D. He is wounded
16. What does Juliet wish for at the start?
    A. Night to come quickly
    B. Tybalt to visit
    C. The sun to stay
    D. Paris to arrive
17. What does Romeo call banishment?
    A. A holiday
    B. Mercy
    C. Death
    D. Justice
18. When is the wedding set?
    A. Friday
    B. Wednesday
    C. Thursday
    D. Next week
19. Which bird does Juliet claim is singing?
    A. The crow
    B. The lark
    C. The nightingale
    D. The owl
20. How long will the potion last?
    A. Forty-two hours
    B. One day
    C. One hour
    D. Three days
21. What does Juliet claim?
    A. She is ill
    B. She loves Paris
    C. She repents
    D. She wants to wait
22. What does Juliet keep by her?
    A. A dagger
    B. A ring
    C. A letter

D. A rosary

23. What fruit is called for?
    A. Dates and quinces
    B. Oranges
    C. Grapes
    D. Apples and pears
24. Who finds Juliet?
    A. The Friar
    B. Capulet
    C. Paris
    D. The Nurse
25. Who brings the news?
    A. Paris
    B. The Nurse
    C. Balthasar
    D. Friar John
26. Why was the letter not delivered?
    A. Stolen
    B. Plague quarantine
    C. Forgotten
    D. Lost
27. Who does Romeo kill at the tomb?
    A. Paris
    B. The Friar
    C. Balthasar
    D. Tybalt

## Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how love and desire develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
2. Explain how fate and choice develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
3. Explain how violence and the feud develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.

## Part III: Essay

Choose one of the play's central concerns (love and desire, fate and choice, violence and the feud, youth and age, time and haste) and argue how the ending reframes it.

## Answer key

**Answer key:** 1. D (Escalus); 2. C (A sonnet); 3. C (Capulet); 4. D (She is not yet fourteen); 5. B (Not yet fourteen); 6. B (The Capulet feast); 7. C (A rich jewel in an Ethiop's ear and a light teaching torches); 8. A (Old desire); 9. B (In the Capulet orchard); 10. C (The sun); 11. D (Herbs and flowers); 12. A (A challenge); 13. C (Three hours); 14. C (Violent delights have violent ends); 15. C (He is now Tybalt's kinsman by marriage); 16. A (Night to come quickly); 17. C (Death); 18. C (Thursday); 19. C (The nightingale); 20. A (Forty-two hours); 21. C (She repents); 22. A (A dagger); 23. A (Dates and quinces); 24. D (The Nurse); 25. C (Balthasar); 26. B (Plague quarantine); 27. A (Paris)

# Essay assignments

## Essay: Love and desire

**Middle School** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about love and desire. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops love and desire in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops love and desire across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of love and desire. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of love and desire in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of love and desire, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of love and desire in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on love and desire in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on love and desire in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about love and desire in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and desire in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Fate and choice

**Middle School** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about fate and choice. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate and choice across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and choice. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and choice, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of fate and choice in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and choice in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Violence and the feud

**Middle School** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about violence and the feud. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops violence and the feud across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of violence and the feud. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of violence and the feud, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of violence and the feud in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on violence and the feud in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Youth and age

**Middle School** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about youth and age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops youth and age in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops youth and age across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of youth and age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of youth and age in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of youth and age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of youth and age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on youth and age in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on youth and age in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about youth and age in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on youth and age in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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## Essay: Time and haste

**Middle School** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Romeo and Juliet teaches about time and haste. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops time and haste in Romeo and Juliet. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops time and haste across Romeo and Juliet. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Romeo and Juliet (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of time and haste. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of time and haste in Romeo and Juliet. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Romeo and Juliet (a recurring element,

structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of time and haste, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Romeo and Juliet's treatment of time and haste in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on time and haste in Romeo and Juliet that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on time and haste in Romeo and Juliet. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about time and haste in Romeo and Juliet, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on time and haste in Romeo and Juliet, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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